

TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 20 PAGES

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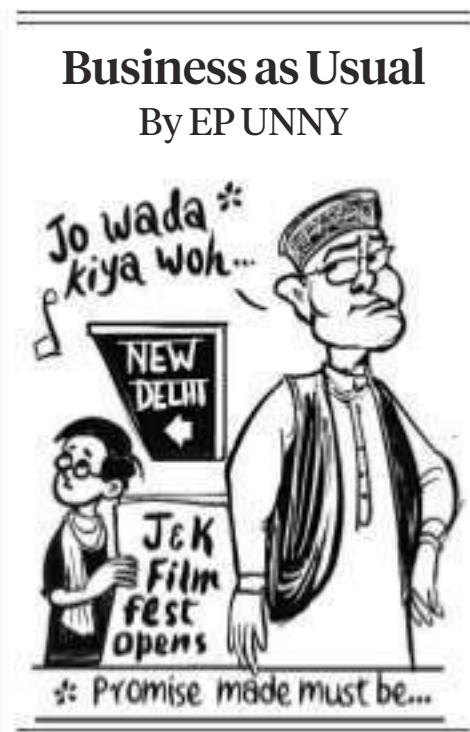
DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

Happening today

● **PM NARENDRA MODI** will visit Vadodara, where he will lay the foundation of and inaugurate projects worth Rs 35,000 crore.

● **DEFENCE MINISTER** Rajnath Singh will begin a three-day trip to Sri Lanka to boost bilateral defence and military ties.

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Manipuri musician beaten to death for ‘objecting to noise’ outside Delhi home

Jimmy Leivon & Sakshi Chand
Imphal, New Delhi, September 7

MANIPURI MUSICIAN Chongtham Vikram Singh was beaten to death late Sunday night, allegedly by a group of men outside his South Delhi home following an argument over the accused making a ruckus. Singh, 55, is survived by his wife and a son.

According to family sources, the incident occurred around 11.30 pm on Sunday when Singh stepped out of his home in Kilokari village and asked the men — according to the police, most are delivery executives — not to make noise. The family said the confrontation quickly turned violent and Singh sustained serious injuries in the assault.

His son, Yaiphaba, took him to Holy Family Hospital in Okhla for treatment, but he succumbed early Monday morning. The hospital report cited haemorrhagic shock caused by blunt force trauma as the cause of death.

Vineet Kumar, the South-east Delhi Deputy Commis-



Chongtham Vikram Singh, 55, lived in Kilokari village

sioner of Police, said, “I, along with other senior officers, have met the family and other community members and assured prompt and lawful action. All seven accused have been arrested, and a minor has been apprehended. Further investigation is underway.”

Singh, lead guitarist of Manipur’s legendary rock band Phoenix in the early 1980s, was regarded as a pioneer of the state’s rock music scene. He started his music career as a lead guitarist of a band called Ultra Vires. After his stint with Phoenix, he joined a famous local band called Eastern Dark. Later, he left Manipur and continued his career as a music

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Top court rejects Aravalli panel plea for more time, CJI invokes retirement date

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 7

REFUSING TO give the high-powered committee six more months to submit its report on the Aravalli Hills, Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on Monday indicated that the request for an extension seemed to suggest it was waiting for him to retire.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, asked the committee to submit its report by November 30 this year. The committee’s request for a six-month extension meant that the report would not be submitted before February-end next year. CJI Kant demits office on February 9, 2027.

“They should straightaway have said give date after my

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No privatisation, but space economy has to grow: ISRO chief’s message to staff

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, September 7

THE CHAIRMAN of Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), V Narayanan, on Monday allayed apprehensions of the space agency being privatised, saying that it is working with the private sector to expand the country’s space economy. He said, “My colleagues have some genuine concerns and it is our responsibility to clarify. ISRO is not being privatised, it is a government organisation and we are working with government investment. The space ecosystem has to grow and the space economy has to grow. And this way is towards that.”

Narayanan said that ISRO currently has 56 satellites in space while the requirement is

TOLL 7, INCLUDING 5 STUDENTS

Hostel collapse: Civic body, DU responsible too, says HC

Orders MCD to inspect all buildings housing PGs and hostels, submit report

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 7

THE DELHI High Court on Monday said responsibility for the building collapse at Satya Niketan in South Delhi, which killed seven people, could extend beyond the PG owner to Delhi University and civic authorities, while flagging the “absolutely inadequate” number of hostels available to students.

The court was dealing with a public interest litigation (PIL) seeking an independent probe into Sunday’s incident.

Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya remarked that the shortage of university and government hostels was forcing students into potentially unsafe PGs and hostels, and questioned whether authorities had done enough to regulate such accommodation.

“Please impress upon the government for providing the facility of a hostel to the students. PGs are not only very dangerous, they are causing threat to life and security to the students. This is because of the absolutely inadequate number of hostels available to students,” the Chief Justice said.

“...Fifty young students who are at the threshold of entering their lives, seven of them reportedly have died, few have been rescued, rest are lying under the debris perhaps. There can’t be anything more sad than this. This is your responsibility,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Satya Niketan, where the building collapsed, is a hub of PG facilities for students. PRAVEEN KHANNA

5 DU students, 5 children no more: Nightmare of grief for next of kin



AMONG THOSE KILLED: Pawan Yadav and Yuvraj Soni, who were students of Delhi University’s Motilal Nehru College; Akshat Singh, who studied at the PGDAV College

Tabshir Shams, Drishti Jain & Jayprakash S Naidu
New Delhi, Raipur, September 7

NINETEEN-YEAR-OLD Priyanshi sat outside the AIIMS Trauma Centre on Monday,

wearing the same clothes that she had been wearing the night before. Her eyes were swollen from crying. Her mother sat with her, and three members of her family stood nearby.

Priyanshi had spent much of Sunday evening going from

hospital to hospital looking for her brother Pawan Yadav — Safdarjung, then Ram Manohar Lohia, then the Army’s RR Hospital — before returning to AIIMS, where she had spent the rest of the night on a bench in

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115 seats, Rs 38,000-cr projects: CM Yogi hits road in SP-Cong strongholds ahead of 2027 polls

● **Yogi Adityanath’s whirlwind UP tour**

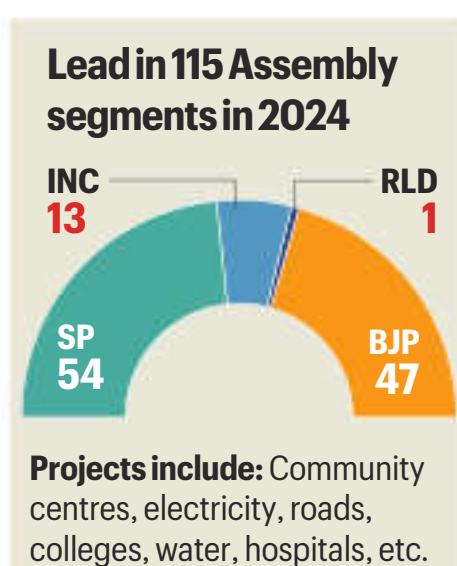
Rae Bareilly district
Projects launched: **₹879 cr**
Assembly segments covered: Bachhrawan, Harchandpur, Rae Bareilly
MP: **Rahul Gandhi** (INC)
Gorakhpur district
Projects launched: **₹4,387 cr**
Assembly segments covered: Pipraich, Gorakhpur Urban, Khajani, Chillupar, Gorakhpur Rural and others.

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, September 7

WITH UTTAR Pradesh slated for the Assembly elections in February 2027, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath has intensified his public outreach, criss-crossing the regions across the state. Since May, Adityanath has

MP: **Ravi Kishan** (BJP)
MP: **Kamlesh Paswan** (BJP)
Mainpuri district
Projects launched: **₹682 cr**
Assembly segments covered: Karhal, Mainpuri
Mainpuri MP: **Dimple Yadav** (SP)
Ayodhya district
Projects launched: **₹810 cr**
Assembly segments covered: Rudauli, Bikapur
MP: **Awadhesh Prasad** (SP)

toured more than 44 of UP’s 75 districts in order to inaugurate or lay foundation stones of various projects meant for 115 Assembly constituencies, of which the Opposition Samajwadi Party (SP)-Congress alliance had led in about 58% segments in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. In the parliamentary elections, the



BJP’s tally in the state plunged from 62 of 80 seats to 33 while the SP and the Congress bagged 37 and six seats respectively.

These projects worth a total of over Rs 38,000 crore include various development and infrastructure projects such as roads, schools, hospitals, power

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LABOUR PROTESTS IN APRIL

Noida protest NSA: Allahabad HC says note ‘displeasure’ in DM’s service records

Orders Rs 5-lakh compensation for accused from salaries of DM, other officers

Drishti Jain
New Delhi, September 7

DESCRIBING AS “worthy of derision” the decision by the District Magistrate of Gautam Buddha Nagar to invoke the National Security Act (NSA) against Aakriti Chaudhary for her alleged role in the Noida labour protests of April, the Allahabad High Court has ordered that its “displeasure” with the official and other officers involved be “noted in their service records”.

The order, issued by a bench of Justices Atul Sreedharan and Achal Sachdev, also held the District Magistrate, IAS officer Medha Roopam, “guilty of violating her oath of allegiance, making this a fit case for the imposition of compensation to the petitioner”.

The court granted Rs 5 lakh as compensation to the petitioner, to be “recovered from the salary of the District Magistrate...who has passed this order of detention without application of mind and from all such other officers who may have been responsible, right down to the SHO of the Police



NSA was invoked against Aakriti Chaudhary, 25, in May

Station, who had prepared the initial report warranting the detention of the petitioner under the provisions of the NSA”.

The detailed order was released Monday after the High Court, on September 2, quashed the detention of Chaudhary, a law student and Delhi University graduate from Durgapur in West Bengal, describing the invocation of the stringent NSA in her case as “arbitrary and vague”.

The High Court was hearing the habeas corpus plea of Chaudhary, who was initially picked up on April 11. Subsequently, the UP government invoked the NSA on May 13. She has since been in custody in Kasna jail in Gautam Buddha Nagar.

While Chaudhary had sought compensation of Rs 50 lakh, the High Court found it “sufficient” to grant Rs 5 lakh, since she would remain in jail as an undertrial prisoner till she secures bail in all the criminal cases registered against her

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

BRICS meet: Focus on talks with China over tech import, investment curbs

Ravi Dutta Mishra & Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, September 7

AHEAD OF the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12-13, which Chinese President Xi Jinping is expected to attend with a sizeable business delegation, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry has reached out to consult with Indian industry groups. Indications are that the high-level talks with Chinese counterparts, on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit, could see the Indian side flag concerns over investment restrictions faced by companies in China and Customs roadblocks on import of high-tech items from the country, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

A government official said the China desk of the Commerce and Industry Ministry has been working on several restrictions on key tech-related items imposed by Chinese Customs, which was hurting Indian manufacturing. The In-

E. EXPLAINED
The thaw: FDI to border trade

India-China trade relations have seen a significant thaw in recent times -- from easing of restrictions on foreign direct investments from land-bordering countries, to reopening of India-China border trade via Nathu La, and resumption of direct flights.

dian automobile industry had already been finding workarounds due to delays in exports of rare earth magnets from China. It is likely that the Indian side will push for some measure of reciprocity in easing procedural bottlenecks and restrictions on sourcing norms.

A senior executive in the renewable energy sector with

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● ‘MUSEUMS ARE NO LONGER IN THE BUSINESS OF INFORMATION. WE ARE IN THE BUSINESS OF INSPIRATION’

‘Objects from all over India (at Yuge Yugeen museum), we need to ensure they sing’

Divya A
New Delhi, September 7

AFTER LEADING the renovation of New York’s MET Museum in 2025, and a museum-graphic overhaul at the Louvre in Paris, architect and designer Kulapat Yantrasast is spearheading the transformation of the iconic North Block and South Block buildings in the heart of New Delhi into the Yuge Yugeen Bharat Museum, billed to be the largest museum in the world.

The Thailand-born and Los Angeles-based Yantrasast, who is in his late 50s, speaks about

marrying the grandness of the buildings with the largeness of India, to invoke not just the past but to inspire generations to come.

In an exclusive interview with *The Indian Express* during his recent trip to New Delhi, Yantrasast, who heads the consortium selected by the Ministry of Culture to design the museum after a public tender last year, also speaks about the role of museums in the age of the Internet, and about involving artists from all parts of the country to make every visitor feel at home.

Excerpts:

When you first got the project, what did you think about what needs to be done and how you would be able to do it?

The most important part to me was making it (the museum) feel accessible and welcome. When you walk into the building, you see the rotunda, the motifs, the courtyard, and you are in awe of this grandness. So the grandness will stay, but on a human level, we want people to feel that there is something that engages them.

The Ministry of Culture is bringing artisans and craftsmen from all over India to work on the



KULAPAT YANTRASAST, PRINCIPAL DESIGNER, YUGE YUGREEN BHARAT MUSEUM

interiors of the building — be it the furniture, woodwork, stone,

metal — as much as possible. We want all the voices of artisans

from around India to be in the building. Even if you come from Tamil Nadu, you find something that reminds you of home. We are trying to make sure all of India is represented and involved in the project.

What do you think of the role of museums in today’s Internet age? Can they just be there to offer historical knowledge?

With projects like this all over the world — the Louvre, the MET, the Getty in Los Angeles, and many museums in Saudi — what is interesting is how technology is now very important.

What is the ‘inspiration’ you are hoping for Yuge Yugeen to provide?

The presence of art objects, storytelling, beauty, everything that a screen cannot give you, that’s what we are (looking at). So when we move in objects from all over India, we need to make sure the objects sing. Whether it’s textiles, costumes, adornments, architecture, very difficult stories about coins and currencies, or even languages — somehow we need to find a way to make this object really inspiring and sing. How we do that within a building is the

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Centre deleting anti-BJP votes under SIR guise: Telangana CM

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, September 7

Alleging that the Union government was deleting anti-BJP votes under the guise of SIR, Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy, in an usual appeal, called on Left parties to join hands with the Congress in the fight against PM Narendra Modi.

Praising the Left for fighting for the rights of the poor, the CM said Prime Minister Modi's defeat would be the victory of Communists.

Reddy called Prime Minister Modi the most "dangerous person" for the country and accused the BJP of adopting new tactics to win elections.

Speaking at a memorial meeting of Communist leader Sarampalli Malla Reddy in Hyderabad, the CM said that there was a conspiracy to delete one crore votes in Telangana.

"Election Commission is functioning at the behest of the BJP, removing anti-BJP votes booth-wise," he said.

Reddy had earlier warned that names of lakhs of voters in the state were going to be deleted during the SIR.

The CM questioned Opposition Bharat Rashtira Samithi's (BRS) silence over the issue.

The CM said the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) was adopting new tactics to win the election after failing to win the trust of the people. "The Union government is deleting anti-BJP votes under the guise of SIR. People from Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and minorities are the main targets," he said.

Reddy accused the BJP of replicating the "West Bengal strategy" in Telangana by systematically removing anti-BJP votes in

every polling booth.

"The BJP is conspiring to delete one crore votes in Telangana. Private agencies are also engaged in conducting surveys and deleting votes," he alleged.

The CM accused the BJP of exploiting the Elections Commission to execute its political agenda".

Appealing to the Communist parties to support the Congress's fight against the alleged vote theft, the CM asserted PM Modi's defeat would be the victory of Communists.

"We should be united and fight against Modi. Elections and fundamental rights of the poor are two different aspects," the CM said as he commended the Communists who, he said, have long been fighting for the rights of the poor. "The 'Red Flag' gives the poor a sense of reassurance and confidence," he said.

The CM said that the Congress has addressed every issue raised by the Communists. "Communists fought for the rights of the landless poor to receive minimum wages. It was the Congress that enacted the Minimum Wages Act. The Left parties fought for the principle of 'land to the tiller' and the Congress government distributed 24.56 lakh acres of assigned land," he said.

"As much as 10 lakh acres are currently owned by Adivasis. This represents the Congress's solution to the struggles waged by Communists. The Congress provided employment through the Employment Guarantee Act and enacted the Food Security Act," he added.

The CM remembered the services rendered by Sarampalli Malla Reddy who dedicated his life to the cause of farmers.

Yuge Yugeen museum

fundamental task of this museum.

You have been looking at collections at various museums across the country. How do you assess what to display?

Well, this is not my idea (alone), but also comes from the Ministry of Culture. We are not going to display the work by chronology or by region. We are going to exhibit the art objects based on crucial themes that are relevant to Indian civilization, especially the aspect that it (goes back) 5,000 years and that there are certain themes that continue, be it adornment or architecture, astrology, cosmology, which is about the sense of self in connection to the universe.

What are the challenges in creating a space which has to equally inspire foreigners who are not familiar with Indian culture, as well as the locals and, especially, the youngsters?

Younger people do not know enough of their own roots. Because, of course, we all want to look forward. But this is not looking backward per se, but understanding that you are part of an ongoing evolution from 5,000 years ago. Till today, everything, the food you are eating, the languages you are speaking, the clothes you are putting on, the psychology you are dealing with, the house, everything, really go back thousands of years. And it's maybe the only civilization I know of that has been uninterrupted.

I cannot imagine other such places in the world. We want to bring that eternal spirit of India. But this is not to celebrate the past alone, but use it as a kind of a launch-off point, because the advancement in technology and engineering today in India is rooted in mathematics, the way of thinking. So all of this just did not randomly happen. It is the cultural foundation that supports the success of India as a country today.

CORRECTION & CLARIFICATION

PAGE 6, 07-09-2026

● In the report, "Next on Collegium agenda: Filling up vacancies in Supreme Court", it was inadvertently mentioned that the Supreme Court has one woman judge. The top court currently has two woman judges. The error is regretted.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Hostel collapse

you cannot escape from this responsibility," he told Solicitor General Tushar Mehta appearing on behalf of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

The division bench, also comprising Justice Tejas Karia, sought separate responses from the Delhi government, MCD, DU as well as Delhi Police in 10 days.

The court specifically directed MCD to clearly indicate in its reply as to whether there are any statutory regulations regulating PG/hostels.

It has also instructed DU to indicate as to how many outstanding students are there in colleges affiliated to it and how many hostels are being run either by DU or the government.

"The reported incident is not

only unfortunate but it evokes deep concerns about inadequate housing facilities in the form of hostels run by DU/government, safety and security of students, and not-so-adequate measures deployed by MCD and other authorities to regulate PG/hostels..." the bench recorded in its order.

"...The responsibility, prima facie, in our opinion, for such mishaps do not lie solely on the owner of the PG/hotel, rather responsibility goes to the university authorities as well as municipal corporation of Delhi, which is responsible to ensure that every single development in Delhi, such as construction of building or repair, is carried out in accordance with law.

Nightmare of grief

the waiting area.

On Monday morning, the family was told that Pawan, a student at Delhi University's Motilal Nehru College, had succumbed to his injuries. He was 21 years old, and among the five DU students who were killed after a five-storey building housing a private hostel collapsed in Satya Niketan on Sunday afternoon.

"All of last night, when we were looking frantically for him, no information was given to us. This morning, Pawan's father got a call and was told that he is no more," Priyanshi's friend Anjali said.

A few metres away sat the family of 20-year-old Akshat Singh, a B.Com student at PGDAV College. Akshat died after suffering grievous head injuries. His friends in Delhi could not bring themselves to break

the news to his family in Katni, Madhya Pradesh.

"We told them he had been injured," Mohit, Akshat's friend and batchmate, said. "They arrived in Delhi this morning."

At 2 pm, 15 of Akshat's relatives were gathered outside the AIIMS mortuary — some sat on the sidewalk, others stood quietly in small clusters.

"We thought we would have to stay for some days until he recovered," Sonu, Akshat's uncle, said. "I did not know we would be basking him back in a steel coffin." Sonu put bottles of water and a few packets of biscuits inside the vehicle — the family's sustenance for the 15-hour journey back to Katni.

Also in front of the AIIMS Trauma Centre, a woman cried uncontrollably as a relative held her tightly. This was Pushpa Jai, whose 18-year-old son Arpit was

"It is not difficult to think that such mishaps are the result of inadequate measures deployed by MCD and other authorities. Had the authority been alive to their responsibilities and duties cast on them statutorily, perhaps such incidents could have been avoided," the order said.

The PIL, filed by Delhi University law student Aniket Kumar Gupta, sought an immediate safety audit of private paying guest and hostel accommodations in Satya Niketan area, which caters mainly to students from DU's South Campus, arguing that the incident points to wider safety concerns in buildings housing thousands of students.

The bench directed the MCD to take up the issue "at the highest executive level" and conduct an inquiry "as to whether the buildings which collapsed were

constructed with valid permissions or not".

"If it is found it was without valid permission, the MCD shall fix the responsibility of the officer/employees concerned for such lapse. The response to be filed by MCD shall also indicate as to what action has been proposed against the erring officials/officers, if any," the court directed MCD.

It also directed the MCD to inspect all buildings housing PG and hostels and prepare a report in a week on whether requisite permission/building byelaws were followed during construction. The court will consider the matter next on September 25.

Addressing Mehta, CJ Upadhyaya remarked, "...You need to double down on your efforts to provide for hostels... the government doesn't run any hostels, DU hardly runs 2-3 hostels..."

killed in the collapse.

Arpit was in second year of the B.Com course at Atma Ram Santan Dharma College, a stone's throw away from Satya Niketan. "I should not have let him come to Delhi," Pushpa wailed. "Had I not allowed him, he would have been with me."

Arpit would have turned 19 on October 11.

Pushpa last saw her son on Saturday. "I hugged him before he boarded the train from Dewas (Madhya Pradesh). I had told him to stay for another day, but his ticket had been booked two months in advance," she said.

Around 2pm Sunday, Arpit's friend called the family with the news of the collapse. Four members of the family drove to Bhopal and took a flight to Delhi, reaching around 7 pm. Arpit's body was identified around 10 am on Monday.

The body of Yuvraj Soni, a second-year student of Motilal Nehru College (Evening), was recovered from the rubble on Sunday evening. Soon after his family arrived in Delhi, Yuvraj's father, Kanhaiya Soni, took ill.

On Monday afternoon, the family was trying to figure out how to take the body back to their home in Durg in Chattisgarh. "A drive in an ambulance might take 15 hours. I don't know whether Yuvraj's father would be able to take the strain," a friend said.

Yuvraj, the only son of his parents, had moved to Delhi a year ago with the dream of becoming a chartered accountant, members of the family in Chhattisgarh said. He was a hardworking student who had cleared the CA Foundation examination in January, a close friend and batchmate said.

A local police officer in Chhattisgarh said Yuvraj's father owns a pharmacy in Raipur. Yuvraj had come home for Raksha Bandhan, and returned to Delhi on August 31. "He had moved into the building only recently," the officer said.

CM Yogi hits the road

Areas Yogi has visited

On August 24, Adityanath visited Rae Bareilly, the Lok Sabha constituency of Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi, to inaugurate completed projects and lay foundation stones of new ones, running into a total of Rs 879 crore, for its three Assembly segments — Bachhrawan, Harchandpur and Rae Bareilly. The Congress led in all these segments in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls. However, in the 2022 Assembly polls, the BJP had won Rae Bareilly while the SP had picked the other two seats.

On July 26, the CM attended an event in Mainpuri to announce projects worth Rs 682 crore in its two Assembly segments — Mainpuri and Karhal.

Karhal is an SP bastion from where party president Akhilesh Yadav, currently the Kannauj MP, had won in the 2022 Assembly elections. His wife Dimple Yadav had taken lead in both Karhal and Mainpuri segments on her way to a resounding win from the Mainpuri Lok Sabha seat in 2024.

In the high-stakes Faizabad (Ayodhya) Lok Sabha constituency, where the BJP suffered a stinging loss at the SP's hand, Adityanath launched development projects for Bikanpur, Rudauli and Dariyabad Assembly segments, where SP MP Awadhesh Prasad had taken decisive leads in 2024.

FULL REPORT ON
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dressed on priority.

The five-member committee, with the DG, Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education as ex-officio chairperson, was set up by the SC on May 25 to re-examine the definition of the Aravalli Hills, following a furor after an earlier bench accepted the 100-metre elevation definition proposed by a committee constituted by the government on the court's orders.

In its May order, the court had asked the committee to submit its "comprehensive report before" August 31 this year. It had asked the committee to examine, among other issues,

"whether the definition of the 'Aravalli Hills and Ranges', restricted exclusively to the 500-metre area between two or more Aravalli Hills, creates a structural paradox wherein the geographical scope of protected territory is significantly narrowed."

On Monday, some of the intervenors submitted there was no effective hearing and those being heard were not getting more than a few seconds.

The CJT pointed out that the court had already said that the committee must undertake a comprehensive consultation process. The matter was listed for hearing on December 2.

mala, is a renowned classical singer from Manipur, once regarded as the "Lata Mangeshkar of the Manipuri film industry". Kamala sang for Matangi Manipur (1972), the first Manipuri feature film, and went on to record numerous other songs, while also contributing to the region's cultural space through talks and workshops. Before she found success in Manipuri cinema, she gained popularity in the state as an approved broadcast singer at All India Radio, Imphal. She is 85,

lives in Imphal and continues to conduct masterclasses in the Manipuri capital with filmmaker and composer Aribam Syam Sharma.

Sunday night's incident came to light after the Sunlight Colony police station received a PCR call about Singh being beaten near his home, where he had been living for several years. Most of the accused, aged between 19 and 36, work as delivery agents in the area, the police said.

Former Manipur Chief Min-

Noida protest NSA

over the protest.

In its order, the court said that "in a case where the police report against the Petitioner were only allegations without there being any credible material against her, the District Magistrate was expected to be vigilant and examine the record threadbare to determine if there was any material in support of the allegations and even thereafter, assess whether the oppressive provisions of the NSA were warranted".

Pointing to the "casual and cavalier exercise of authority by the State through the District Magistrate", the court also made sharp observations against the bureaucracy, stating that such "errant" action may "reduce...Uttar Pradesh to an Orwellian Dystopia".

"It goes without saying that those in the bureaucracy and the police, when they act in a manner which is harmonious with their oath of allegiance, the thankful citizens of this State shall elevate them, and very rightly so, to a position which would be envied by the Gods themselves," the court said.

"However, every time they ignore that solemn oath and act contrary to it, the people of...Uttar Pradesh would view them as an oppressive vestige of the British Empire arousing angst and hatred towards them creating an environment of civil unrest," it said.

"...this Court, while correcting their excesses and/or illegalities, especially those that impinge upon the civil liberties of the citizens without adequate cause or due process (inhering in the procedure established by law), may pass harsh orders to compensate the citizen so wronged, besides recording their despotic conduct. Else, it shan't be long before the errant in the bureaucracy reduce the State of Uttar Pradesh to an Orwellian Dystopia," the court said.

Referring to the case and unanswered WhatsApp messages by the petitioner, the court said that her version that she was taken into custody on April 11 "probabilise as true" and "falsifies the contention of the State

that the Petitioner was in the custody of the State only from April 12".

The court also said the state's counsel "has not been able to show a single message from the WhatsApp chats between the Petitioner and her associates or any video clip which would reveal any incitement from the Petitioner, either evidently or by necessary implication, which would disclose that it was the involvement of the Petitioner and the conspiracy hatched by her that resulted in the violence which erupted from 13.04.2026".

The order noted: "Preventing people from gathering in public spaces or agitating their rights on the grounds of assumed breach of peace, would be throwing the baby out of the bath water."

Chaudhary has been named in 11 FIRs, with charges including attempt to murder, intent to cause death or grievous harm, endangering life or personal safety, and criminal conspiracy. According to Chaudhary's counsel, she has secured bail in five cases, while the bail pleas over the six other FIRs are yet to be heard in the High Court.

On August 20, *The Indian Express* had published the findings of its investigation into 106 arrests and 222 related bail orders linked to the Noida protests, each with substantive allegations ranging from rioting and arson to attempt to murder.

The investigation revealed that relief was granted in as many as 188, or 84%, of the cases, with the sessions courts flagging key gaps in the police's narrative: mere presence at a protest is not evidence to deny bail; lack of specific evidence outweighs gravity of charges; ordinary workers at the protest cannot be equated with those found organising or instigating violence.

This newspaper also detailed the charges against Chaudhary, who was jailed under NSA along with Satyam Verma, a 60-year-old former journalist from Lucknow. It cited court records to show that Chaudhary was accused of being among "proponents of a specific ideology that believes in achieving their objectives through violent means".

Tech import curbs

sourcing exposure in China told *The Indian Express* that Beijing's growing restrictions on the export of critical technologies and raw materials across several sectors have become a high priority for the government ahead of the BRICS Summit.

"China has imposed restrictions on the export of ingot and wafer technology, battery cells and cell technology," the executive said. "For example, in the transmission sector, exports of High Voltage Direct Current (HVDC) and specialised components are also being restricted."

HVDCs are critical for long-distance power transmission with reduced transmission losses, and considered essential for integrating renewable energy sources and grid stability.

The executive said these restrictions could undermine India's efforts to build domestic manufacturing capabilities. "I think it is very critical that the government finds a way to tide over some of these issues because otherwise our entire backward integration, which makes India competitive, will unfortunately be stopped and won't be successful," the executive said, adding that most of these restrictions were imposed over the past 12-15 months.

"China's restrictions on the export of critical technologies and specialised components, including those required for HVDC and advanced transmission systems, underline the strategic vulnerabilities of global supply chains. For India, this is particularly significant as we undertake one of the world's most ambitious transmission build-outs to support growing electricity demand and renewable energy integration," said Pratik Agarwal, managing director, Sterilite Electric and Chairman-Serentica Renewables and

Resonia.

However, official trade data showed that China has stepped up imports from India in recent months. India's exports to China jumped over 28% to \$5.55 billion in April-June this financial year as compared to the same period last year. The export jump to China also helped cushion India's fishery exports hit by US tariffs.

Amid signs of easing trade ties, a top Commerce Ministry official was expected to visit Beijing this week. However, the talks were learnt to have been postponed due to border-related talks between India and China. A query emailed to the Commerce Ministry remained unanswered until press time.

The Indian Express reported on Monday that India and China conducted Corps Commander level talks in Arunachal Pradesh on Sunday.

Trade talks with China

As per the Chinese Embassy in India, Chinese Ambassador to India Xu Feihong met Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal on September 1, and the two sides exchanged views on economic and trade relations and other issues of mutual interest.

"Minister Guo Ce of the Chinese Embassy, Additional Secretary Darpan Jain of Trade Negotiation-Bilateral Division, and Joint Secretary Kapil Chaudhary of Foreign Trade (North East Asia) Division attended the meeting. Ambassador Xu said that under the strategic guidance of the leaders of both countries, China-India relations have maintained a good momentum of improvement and development with the resumption of direct flights and border trade as well as an increase in people-to-people exchanges," the Embassy said.

ister N Biren Singh said he was "deeply concerned by the incident in which Singh was allegedly assaulted near his residence in southeast Delhi".

"His invaluable contribution to music will always be remembered. His untimely passing is a great loss to his family, the music fraternity, and the people of Manipur," he wrote.

Tagging the Delhi Police and CM Rekha Gupta, he added, "With evidence now emerging in connection with the incident, I urge the Delhi Police to take

swift and appropriate action, thoroughly investigate the matter, and ensure that justice is delivered at the earliest."

The killing also drew condemnation from the North East Students Society Delhi University (NESSDU), which sought a prompt and impartial probe.

Biru Chida Sharma, an acquaintance, said, "He taught guitar to children in Delhi and contributed significantly to the people of Manipur... Our demand is clear: our brother must get justice."

Aravalli

retirement," the CJT remarked as soon as the bench took up the matter for hearing. "Tell them to work day and night. Give report within two months. If they are incapable, let them tell us, we will re-constitute the committee," he told Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati who appeared for the committee.

Bhati said the committee was working on the report and assured that it would be submitted in two months.

"It is in the interest of every-

Manipuri musician

teacher in New Delhi.

Vivek Sharma, the lead vocalist of Phoenix, called Singh a "truly irreplaceable person, a dear friend and an elder brother". "Whenever there was a need for accuracy, perfection, and to make things happen behind the scenes, he was the only one. Whether it was in a band or a group, he quietly gave his best without ever seeking recogni-

tion. He was a humble soul with no ego, no animosity, just a peaceful soul who loved music. He was one of those rare people who would do it all, yet receive acknowledgement from almost no one. His contribution was often behind the scenes, but it was always essential," he said.

Singh came from a family with a strong musical legacy. His mother, Chongtham Ka-

Former bureaucrat Ashish Joshi moves court for FIR copy after nine hours of police questioning

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 7

DAYS AFTER former civil servant Ashish Joshi was questioned for nearly nine hours by the Delhi Police Special Cell over his social media posts, he moved an application before a magistrate court on Monday seeking a copy of the FIR based on which he was detained and interrogated.

Chief Judicial Magistrate Mridul Gupta of Patiala House Courts is due to take up the application on Tuesday.

According to Joshi's lawyer, Aadil Singh Boparai, the FIR copy had not yet been supplied as of 2 pm on Monday.

Joshi, a former Controller of Communications in the Department of Telecommunications, was picked up from Chanakypuri for questioning on September 2 in connection with a case purportedly registered in August.

Police had said that Joshi was questioned regarding the case that was registered by the Special Cell's Counter Intelligence (CI) unit under Section 192 of the BNS, which deals with provocation with the intent, or knowledge, that it is likely to cause a riot.

According to Joshi's application before the court, he was returning from his morning walk from the vicinity of Nehru Park at 8.45 am on September 2 when two persons, who said they were Special Cell officials, had "acosted" him and "compelled him to accompany them for...interrogation/investigation with regard to an alleged tweet..."

This was done, however,



Ashish Joshi

without furnishing him with a copy of the FIR, according to Joshi.

Joshi stated in his application that despite repeated requests during the interrogation for a copy of the FIR, it was not provided. Subsequently, he made a representation to the Deputy Commissioner of Police, Special Cell, on September 3, seeking a copy.

"The continued and unexplained denial of a copy of the FIR... despite specific and repeated requests... is contrary to the settled position of law and has caused serious prejudice, uncertainty and hardship to (Joshi) who remains wholly unaware of the precise nature of the allegations, if any, against him," Joshi has stated.

The Indian Express reported that Joshi claimed that he had been summoned in connection with his August 26 post on X on the West Bengal elections, but that a substantial part of the questioning was about an earlier post in which he had referred to a purported disagreement between the Union Home Minister and Home Secretary.

Workshop for H1N1, dengue prevention

New Delhi: The Delhi government on Monday held a workshop for councillors and public representatives on prevention and management of seasonal influenza H1N1 and dengue, with Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh calling for greater community participation to check the spread of the dis-

eases. The workshop, held at the Delhi Secretariat, focused on symptoms, prevention, early detection and management of the two seasonal diseases, while stressing the role of elected representatives in taking health awareness messages to every ward, neighbourhood and household. PTI



Society for Computer Technology & Research's
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Accredited by NAAC (A+) & NBA [All eligible UG Programs]

Date: 08-09-2026

Advertisement inviting applications for admission to First Year B.Tech. under Institutional Quota and against vacant seats after CAP Rounds (ACAP) for A.Y. 2026-27. Applications are invited from the eligible and aspiring candidates for admission to the following B.Tech. courses under the Institutional Quota and against vacant seats, if any, after CAP rounds, as per State CET Cell norms.

Sr	Name of Course	Institutional Quota Seats
1	Computer Engineering	36
2	Electronics & Telecommunication Engineering	36
3	Information Technology	27
4	Artificial Intelligence & Data Science	9
5	Electronics & Computer Engineering	9

Last Date for Online Application: 08 September 2026, subject to change in accordance with the schedule/guidelines issued by the State CET Cell from time to time. For more details i.e., Vacant seats after CAP rounds, Application form, Schedule, etc., please visit our Institute website <https://admission.pict.edu/>

Principal

PUBLIC NOTICE

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL, NEW DELHI BENCH (BENCH IV) AT NEW DELHI C.P. (CAA) 41/ ND/2026 Connected with CA. (CAA) - 18/ ND/2026 IN THE MATTER OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 AND IN THE MATTER OF SECTIONS 230 TO 232 AND OTHER APPLICABLE PROVISIONS OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013 AND IN THE MATTER OF SCHEME OF AMALGAMATION BETWEEN LANDMARK HI TECH DEVELOPMENT PRIVATE LIMITED AND UPPAL-CHADHA HI-TECH DEVELOPERS PRIVATE LIMITED AND THEIR RESPECTIVE SHAREHOLDERS

In the matter of, Landmark Hi Tech Development Private Limited Registered office: Mezzanine Floor, M-4, New Delhi, South Extension Part - II, South Delhi, Delhi, India, 110049

...Petitioner Company No. 1/ Transferor Company AND
Uppal-Chadha Hi- Tech Developers Private Limited
Registered office: First Floor, M-4, South Extension Part-II, New Delhi South Ex-II, South Delhi, New Delhi, Delhi, India, 110049

...Petitioner Company No. 2/ Transferee Company

NOTICE OF PETITION

NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN that a joint second motion petition bearing C.P. (CAA) 41/ND/2026 ("Petition") under Sections 230 to 232 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, seeking approval of the Scheme of Amalgamation of Landmark Hi Tech Development Private Limited and Uppal-Chadha Hi-Tech Developers Private Limited (collectively, the "Petitioner Companies") and their respective shareholders ("Scheme"), was filed by the Petitioner Companies before the New Delhi Bench (Court IV) of the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal ("NCLT") and was heard by the Hon'ble NCLT on August 11, 2026. In terms of the order dated August 11, 2026 passed by the Hon'ble NCLT, the Petition is listed for hearing on September 15, 2026.

Any person desirous of supporting or opposing the Petition may send a notice of his/her intention, signed by him/her or his/her advocate and setting out his/her name and address, to Petitioner Company No. 1, i.e., Landmark Hi Tech Development Private Limited, at its registered office at Mezzanine Floor, M-4, New Delhi, South Extension Part-II, South Delhi, Delhi, India - 110049, and Petitioner Company No. 2, i.e., Uppal-Chadha Hi-Tech Developers Private Limited, at its registered office at First Floor, M-4, New Delhi, South Extension Part-II, South Delhi, Delhi, India - 110049, with a copy by email to secretarial@waveinfotech.com, and/or file the same before the Hon'ble NCLT, so as to reach the Petitioner Companies and/or be filed before the Hon'ble NCLT not later than two days before the date on which the Petition is listed for hearing (i.e., not later than September 13, 2026). In the event that any person seeks to oppose the Petition, a copy of the Petition shall be furnished by the undersigned to such person, upon request, free of cost

BRIEFLY

66-year-old held for raping 20-yr-old woman

A 66-YEAR-OLD contractor was apprehended for allegedly raping a 20-year-old woman at a factory in North Delhi, police said. According to the woman, who is also the complainant in the case, she had been working at the factory for about a month and was staying there. The incident took place around 11 pm on September 1, police said. During inquiry, the police also learnt that a co-worker had recorded a video of the alleged incident. A case has been registered and further investigation is underway, police said. PTI

Teen stabbed to death; co-worker, juvenile held

A 19-YEAR-OLD man was stabbed to death following a dispute over an alleged abusive comment made on social media for a co-worker in northeast Delhi, police said. Two persons, including a juvenile, have been held, they said. The incident took place on Sunday night. Police were informed by JPC Hospital that a man, who had sustained a stab injury, was declared dead. The deceased was identified as Sahil, a native of UP's Amroha, who worked at a factory in Chauhan Bangar, police said. He was allegedly stabbed by his co-worker, also named Sahil (21). PTI

Neighbour held for killing man, dumping body

A YOUTH, who allegedly strangled his neighbour in a "revenge attack" after the victim allegedly locked him and his girlfriend inside a room and got them "assaulted", was arrested, police said on Monday. The accused, identified as Bhupender Pal alias Nanhe, was arrested in UP's Kasganj. Police said Pal allegedly transported the body in his tempo and dumped it in Dwarka Sector 8. PTI



Hon'ble Prime Minister

Shri Narendra Modi

will Inaugurate and Lay the Foundation Stone of Development Projects Worth More than ₹35,200 crore

Date: 8 September 2026 | Time: 10:30 AM

Venue: Maharaja Sayajirao University Pavilion Ground, Vadodara

'Swachhata Se Swagat'

Gujarat to Welcome Prime Minister with the Spirit of Cleanliness

INAUGURATION

Drinking Water Supply for 1.10 Lakh Citizens of East Vadodara
Access to drinking water will improve health and overall quality of life

New 150 MLD Water Intake Facility at Ajwa
Planned keeping Vadodara's future water requirements in mind

270 New Housing Units at Khanpur-Sevasi
Helping families realise the dream of owning a home

Reconstruction of the Jambusar-Tankari-Devna Road in Bharuch District
Will strengthen basic infrastructure in the region

110 MW Floating Solar Project at Kadana Dam in Mahisagar District
Will further accelerate green growth

Connectivity will improve with the introduction of a new train service between Vadodara and Tanda Road (Madhya Pradesh)

FOUNDATION STONE LAYING

Ring Road Phase 2, 17.56 km
Will make travel smoother and more convenient for citizens

Deepening of the Vishwamitri River
Upon completion of the work, the river's water storage capacity will be increased

New Municipal Corporation Administrative Building
The new building will make civic services simpler and more accessible

Bullet Train Station Above Platform No. 7
Modern infrastructure will give Vadodara greater global recognition

Ajwa Safari Park and Crocodile-Shaped Bridge at Kamati Baug
Will give Vadodara a new and distinctive identity

This holistic development of Vadodara is not merely the progress of a city. It reflects Gujarat's growth momentum and lays a strong foundation for a Viksit Bharat.

Harsh Sanghavi,
Deputy Chief Minister, Gujarat

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NOTICE OF THE 27th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, E-VOTING AND DIVIDEND INFORMATION

1. NOTICE is hereby given that the 27th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the Members of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited ("IRCTC" / "the Company") will be held on **Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 03:00 P.M. (IST) through Video Conferencing ("VC") / Other Audio-Visual Means ("OAVM")** to transact the business as set out in the Notice convening the 27th AGM, in compliance with the applicable provisions of Companies Act, 2013, Rules framed thereunder and Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("SEBI LODR Regulation") read with Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") General Circular dated September 22, 2025 and other relevant Circulars issued by MCA and Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") from time to time (hereinafter collectively referred to as "Circulars").

2. In compliance with applicable provisions of the Companies Act and Rules framed thereunder read with aforesaid Circulars of MCA & SEBI, the Notice of the 27th AGM along with Annual Report 2025-26 has been sent through electronic mode only to those Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company / Alankit Assignments Limited, the Registrar & Share Transfer Agent of Company ("RTA") / Depositories / Depository Participants. The dispatch of the notice along with Annual Report for FY 2025-26 through e-mails has been completed on **Monday, September 07, 2026**. Further, pursuant to Regulation 36(1)(b) of SEBI LODR Regulation, a letter providing the web-link to access the Annual Report, including the exact path, is being sent to those members who have not registered their email address with the Company/RTA/Depositories/ Depository Participants.

3. Detailed instructions to the Members for registration of their email addresses, manner of participating in the 27th AGM through VC/OAVM including manner of e-voting is set out in the Notice of the AGM. Members who hold shares in physical form or who have not registered their e-mail addresses and wish to participate in the AGM or cast their votes through remote e-voting or e-voting during the AGM can log on to the e-voting website www.evoting.nsdl.com by using their credentials. Members are requested to read instructions contained in this regard in the Notice.

4. Notice and Annual Report of the Company are available on the websites of the Company (i.e. www.irctc.com), Stock Exchanges, viz., BSE Limited (i.e. www.bseindia.com) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (i.e. www.nseindia.com) and National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) (i.e. www.evoting.nsdl.com). A member can also request for the physical copy of the Annual Report 2025-26 by sending a requisition at investors@irctc.com.

5. The Company has engaged the service of NSDL as the agency for providing the facilities for participation in the AGM through VC/OAVM facility, voting through remote e-voting and e-voting during the AGM. Members will be able to attend the AGM through VC/OAVM facility at www.evoting.nsdl.com. Members participation through VC/OAVM shall be reckoned for the purpose of quorum under section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013.

6. In terms of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management & Administration) Rule, 2014, Regulation 44 of SEBI LODR Regulation and aforesaid circulars, Members as on **Cut-off Date of Tuesday, September 22, 2026** may cast their vote electronically (e-voting) on the business as set forth in the Notice of the AGM through the voting facility provide by NSDL. Further, the voting rights of the members shall be in proportion to the equity shares held by them in the paid-up equity shares of the Company as on Cut-off date.

7. Members may attend the 27th AGM through one-way live "Webcast" on **Tuesday, September 29, 2026 from 03:00 PM**, onwards till conclusion of the AGM, by using their remote e-voting credentials.

8. The facility for voting shall also be made available during the 27th AGM and Members who have not already cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be able to vote through e-voting system during the 27th AGM. The members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may also attend the 27th AGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again.

9. The members are informed that:

a) The remote e-voting shall commence on **Saturday, September 26, 2026 at 09:00 A.M (IST) and ends on Monday, September 28, 2026 at 05:00 P.M. (IST);**

b) Remote e-voting shall not be allowed beyond **05:00 P.M. (IST) on Monday, September 28, 2026;**

c) Any person whose name appears in the register of Members/beneficial owners as on the **Cut-off Date i.e. Tuesday, September 22, 2026** only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting, and as well as e-voting system during the 27th AGM;

d) Any person who becomes member of the company after dispatch of the notice of meeting and holding shares as on the **Cut-off Date Tuesday, September 22, 2026** may obtain the user id and password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com; and

e) The remote e-voting module will be disabled after the date and time as aforementioned. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by the member, he/she shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.

10. Manner of registering/ updating KYC details / email address:

(i) Members holding physical shares are requested to register/update their email addresses and Electronic Clearing Service ("ECS") mandate with complete Bank details by sending relevant documents to the RTA of the Company i.e. Alankit Assignments Limited, Alankit House, 4E/2 Jhandewalan Extension New Delhi- 110055, or scanned copy on email at kycupdate@alankit.com through their registered mail id;

(ii) Members, holding shares in dematerialized mode are requested to contact their Depository Participant (DP) and register their email address and bank account details in your demat account, as per the process advised by your DP.

11. The Board of Directors of the Company at their meeting held on May 26, 2026 has recommended final dividend of ₹0.50/- per share on the face value of ₹2.00 per share, subject to approval of the Shareholders at the 27th AGM. The Company has fixed **Tuesday, September 22, 2026, as the "Record Date"** for determining entitlement of members for final dividend for the financial year ended March 31, 2026, if approved at the AGM.

Pursuant to the provisions of Income Tax Act, 2025 ("Income Tax Act"), as amended, payment of dividend will be subject to deduction of tax at source (TDS) at applicable rates. In order to enable us to determine the appropriate TDS rate, members are requested to submit the relevant documents in accordance with the provisions of the Act. A detailed notice regarding **"Communication w.r.t. Tax Deducted at Source (TDS) on Final Dividend for the Financial Year 2025-26"** is hosted at the website of the Company, www.irctc.com. For more details, please refer to the Notes to the Notice of 27th AGM.

12. Ms. Balika Sharma (M. No.: 4816 and C. P. No.: 3222), Practicing Company Secretary has been appointed as **"Scrutinizer"** to scrutinize the remote e-voting process and e-voting during the AGM, in a fair and transparent manner.

13. All grievances connected with the facility for voting by electronic means may be addressed to **Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Deputy Vice President, National Securities Depository Limited**, 4th Floor, A Wing, Trade World, Kamala Mills Compound, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400013, India or send an email to evoting@nsdl.com or call toll free no. 022 - 4886 7000.

14. Members are requested to inform changes, if any, pertaining to their name, postal address, email address, telephone / mobile numbers, Permanent Account Number (PAN), mandates, nominations, power of attorney, bank details such as name of the bank, branch details, bank account number, MICR code, IFSC code, etc. to their Depository Participants in case the shares are held by them in demat form and to the RTA in case the share are held by them in physical form.

15. Members are requested to read carefully all the Notes set out in the Notice and in particular, instructions for joining the AGM, manner of casting vote through remote e-voting or through e-voting at the AGM.

By order of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
(Suman Kalra)

Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: New Delhi
Dated: September 7, 2026

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

‘Dangerous and ruinous’: Notices to four buildings near collapse site

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 7

IN THE wake of the building collapse in Satya Niketan on Sunday that claimed seven lives, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has issued vacation notices to four properties surrounding the collapse site, citing “ruinous/dangerous” conditions.

Buildings 81, 82, 13 and 15 were some of the properties that received the notice, which stated that it is dangerous to any person occupying it or passing by such a building. Building 14 was the one that collapsed on Sunday.

Sanjeet Kaur, who has been living in the area for over 10 years, claimed, “All these buildings that were served notices were initially only 2-3 floors. Later they added more floors and rented it out.”

The notice was issued under Section 349 of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 1957, which allows the civic body to order people to leave a building if it is considered unsafe. MCD officials said the provision is invoked only after a survey finds a building dangerous. The property is then demolished by the owner itself or by the MCD at the cost of the owner.

The civic body has suspended five officials, including the South Zone Deputy Commissioner. They have stated that the five-storey building, which housed a private hostel, was not deemed dangerous in their surveys by the zonal commissioners, but the owner was carrying out work in the basement, which allegedly may have led to the collapse.

MCD Mayor Pravesh Wahi said, “... A major decision has been taken by us so that no negligence is tolerated ... Although a magisterial inquiry has been ordered, they [5 officials] have been suspended ... Our Chief Minister and the MCD are fully committed to ensuring that we do not let any loss of life or property occur.”

New safety policy, structural audit for PG hubs on cards

LG Sandhu chairs high-level meeting with CM, Sood to review situation

Sukrita Baruah
New Delhi, September 7

A POTENTIAL new safety policy for buildings used for public purposes, including paying guest (PG) accommodations for students; a structural audit of all buildings in PG hubs within a week; and considering the possibility of using vacant MCD and DDA buildings for student housing — these were among key announcements made by the Delhi government a day after a private hostel near Delhi University’s South Campus collapsed and killed at least seven people on Sunday.

On Monday, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu chaired a meeting with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood, to review the situation following the building collapse in South West Delhi’s Satya Niketan.

The building housing the private hostel, which primarily accommodated students of Delhi University’s South Campus colleges, was reportedly “weak”. It is said that the owner was also allegedly carrying out construction work in the building’s basement, which may have led to the collapse.

In the meeting on Monday, LG Sandhu reportedly directed the Delhi Chief Secretary to ensure structural audit of all buildings in PG hubs — such as Satya Niketan — be carried out.

However, since many students living in PGs adjoining the collapsed building have already been displaced because of some being sealed and others shut as a precautionary measure, the LG directed that inspection drives only be conducted on premises that had



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta arrives at the site of the collapse on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

prima facie violated height and floor restrictions, in order to minimise panic.

Expansion of students’ accommodation

The government has also said that it is exploring the possibilities of expanding student accommodation, beyond the limited hostel facilities offered by colleges. For perspective, DU’s 2024-25 annual report records over 2.45 lakh regular students, many of whom come from outside Delhi, while its financial estimates list 18 university-run hostels.

According to a statement by the LG’s Office, he has directed Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood to “explore alternative student accommodation” through universities, MCD and DDA. It stated that he directed officials to “assess the feasibility of using unutilised and vacant buildings of DDA and MCD, as also DDA housing stock for student accommodation”.

It added that he has also directed that a mid- and long-term plan be prepared to augment hostel accommodations. Following the meeting, Sood said that the government will consider additional relax-

• Key announcements

- Constitution of a committee, which will explore feasibility of using vacant DDA and MCD buildings for student accommodation
- Considering relaxation of FAR restrictions for hostel buildings
- Structural audit of all buildings in PG hubs within a week
- Working towards policy for public use buildings requiring periodical structural audits

ation in Floor Area Ratio (FAR) in the development of hostels, allowing larger and taller hostels to be built to accommodate more students.

“Existing hostels can also be redeveloped by allowing enhanced FAR under the new provisions,” he said.

The LG’s Office also stated that he directed the DDA and the Land and Development Office to extend support to universities with getting NOCs, approvals and increasing FAR to construct new hostels for students.

Meanwhile on Monday, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced that the government

is working towards a new safety policy for buildings used for public purposes in Delhi.

The Chief Minister’s Office (CMO) stated that buildings used for purposes such as housing PGs, nursing homes or schools “would be required to undergo periodic structural audits and obtain building safety certification.”

The CMO also stated that Gupta has urged public representatives such as MPs, MLAs and councillors to gather information about illegal constructions being carried out in their respective areas and report them to the department concerned.

‘Illegal constructions to be razed’

“Illegal constructions would be demolished. A system would be put in place to monitor illegal constructions while they are under way. The Chief Minister’s Office would also monitor such complaints. The Chief Minister has directed officials of all concerned departments to ensure that action is not limited to the incident site, and that all vulnerable buildings and PGs in the surrounding area are thoroughly inspected,” the CMO also stated

ABVP steps up stir, wants MCD Commissioner to step down

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 7

THE AKHIL Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) on Monday stepped up its protest over the collapse of a student paying guest accommodation in South West Delhi’s Satya Niketan, holding demonstrations and sit-ins across several Delhi University (DU) campuses and demanding accountability from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), including the suspension of MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar.

The protests came a day after a five-storey building housing a boys’ PG in Satya Niketan, near DU’s South Campus, collapsed, killing at least seven people and injuring several others. Rescue operations continued on Monday as teams searched the debris for those still feared trapped.

The building, known as Hostel Daze, was a decades-old structure and construction work was reportedly underway in its basement when it collapsed. Preliminary reports have also pointed to unauthorised construction and the absence of a sanctioned building plan and fire NOC.

The incident has put the spotlight on the safety of the large number of students who live in privately operated PGs and rented accommodation in neighbourhoods around DU. The Delhi High Court on Monday also questioned the responsibility of the building owners, MCD and Delhi University, while seeking steps to improve the safety of student accommodation.

Protests across colleges

The ABVP, the student organisation affiliated with the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), had on Sunday night staged a protest outside the MCD headquarters and warned of further action.

On Monday, its activists held demonstrations at Hansraj College, Hindu College, Kirori Mal College, Lakshmi Bai College, Shyam Lal College, Zakir Hu-



ABVP members during a protest on Sunday. FILE/ANI

sain College, Sri Aurobindo College, College of Vocational Studies, Shaheed Bhagat Singh College, Ramjas College, Shivaji College and Sri Venkateswara College, among others.

The organisation has demanded a high-level and impartial probe into the collapse and action against PG operators, building owners and officials found responsible for violations or negligence. It has also sought immediate structural and safety audits of PGs and rented accommodation in and around Delhi University and other student-dominated areas.

Calling the campaign “No More Satya Niketan”, ABVP national general secretary Virendra Singh Solanki said, “Following the tragic incident at Satya Niketan, ABVP karyakartas have remained on the ground, assisting affected students and demanding action against those responsible.”

“Accountability must be fixed for everyone responsible for this tragedy arising from negligence on the part of the MCD administration. Our resolve of ‘No More Satya Niketan’ is clear: no student in Delhi should ever be forced to risk their life by living in an unsafe building,” he said.

ABVP Delhi state secretary Sarthak Sharma said the incident had exposed “serious negligence of the system” and demanded that the Delhi government identify those responsible and implement safety measures in student-dominated areas.

Youth outreach in focus

The mobilisation comes at a

politically significant time on Delhi University campuses, with the Delhi University Students’ Union (DUSU) elections scheduled for September 18. The deadline for filing nominations is September 10, with the final list of candidates to be published on September 11 and counting scheduled for September 19.

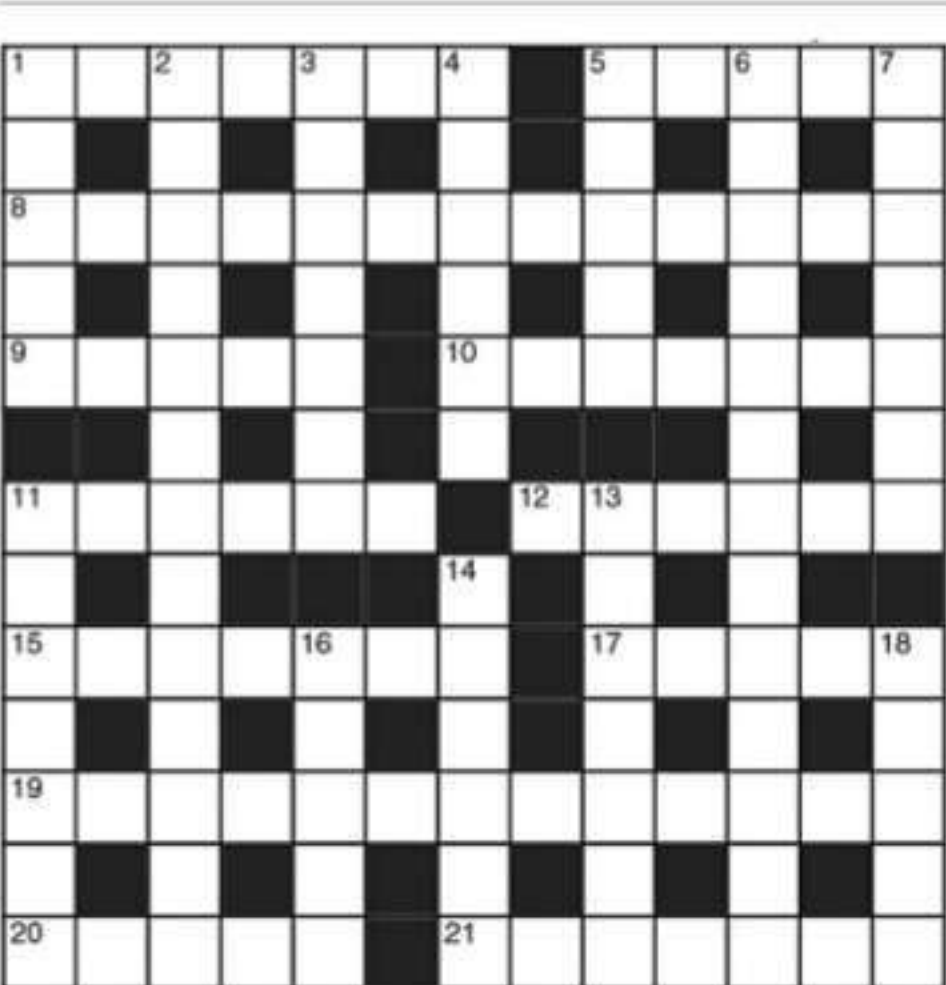
The ABVP has already begun its DUSU campaign, including a “My DU, My Manifesto” initiative inviting students to put forward their concerns and suggestions. The organisation has also constituted an election committee to select its candidates for the central panel.

The protests also come against the backdrop of renewed efforts by the BJP and RSS to engage with younger voters following the Gen Z-led protests in Delhi earlier this year. The Delhi BJP has been working on a youth outreach programme involving its state unit, ministers, BJP’s youth wing and ABVP, with the party acknowledging the need for greater engagement with first-time voters and university students.

The RSS, meanwhile, has itself stepped up its engagement with Gen Z and Gen Alpha. RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat held an interaction with around 2,000 teenagers in Mumbai last month, an outreach that came weeks after the youth-led protests and was seen within the Sangh and BJP ecosystem as an important effort to engage a generation whose political concerns and modes of mobilisation have been different from those of earlier youth constituencies.

Against that backdrop, the Satya Niketan issue gives the ABVP an opportunity to foreground a directly felt campus concern — the safety and affordability of student accommodation — as it mobilises across DU colleges ahead of the DUSU polls. The organisation, however, has framed the protests primarily as a demand for accountability and safer accommodation, rather than as an electoral campaign.

• CROSSWORD



ACROSS

- 1 Professionals get by and even flourish (7)
- 5 He may want to change roles with the winner (5)
- 8 They figure a great deal in population surveys (13)
- 9 Send money or return the watch (5)
- 10 Sketch the escape route? (7)
- 11 To attract a number break a rule (6)
- 12 Yet it isn’t the motorist’s top gear (6)
- 15 Caught young lady going round with a journalist (7)
- 17 Practical joke is quietly offensive (5)
- 19 Defeated by the elements? (7-6)
- 20 Dismal king in love (5)
- 21 Abandons wastelands (7)

DOWN

- 1 A hard question for an artist’s model (5)
- 2 Climbing a low hill but to no great extent (2,1,5,5)
- 3 Dog taken in hand for teaching (7)
- 4 Allowance made at or in a resort (6)
- 5 It’s held by solicitors to be permissible (5)
- 6 Changing to steam trains? He should know (13)
- 7 Honour a relation (7)
- 11 Admitted everybody had debts (7)
- 13 Overburden journalists with work (7)
- 14 Loved to see the dreadnought wrecked (6)
- 16 This is an alternative to returning to her (5)
- 18 Rulers of the pack (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6087 ACROSS: 1 Dally, 8 Position, 9 Irons, 10 Hardback, 11 Smart, 12 Toe, 16 Entire, 17 Racing, 18 Ear, 23 Ideas, 24 Dominion, 25 Sepia, 26 Arteries, 27 Stage DOWN: 2 Acrimony, 3 Landrail, 4 Potato, 5 Hilda, 6 Nizam, 7 Snake, 12 Tee, 13 Err, 14 Acid test, 15 Engaging, 19 Azores, 20 Ideal, 21 Smite, 22 Snark

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

It’s always ____ to quit. - Norman V. Peale (3,5)

MTTAE ANUWLT

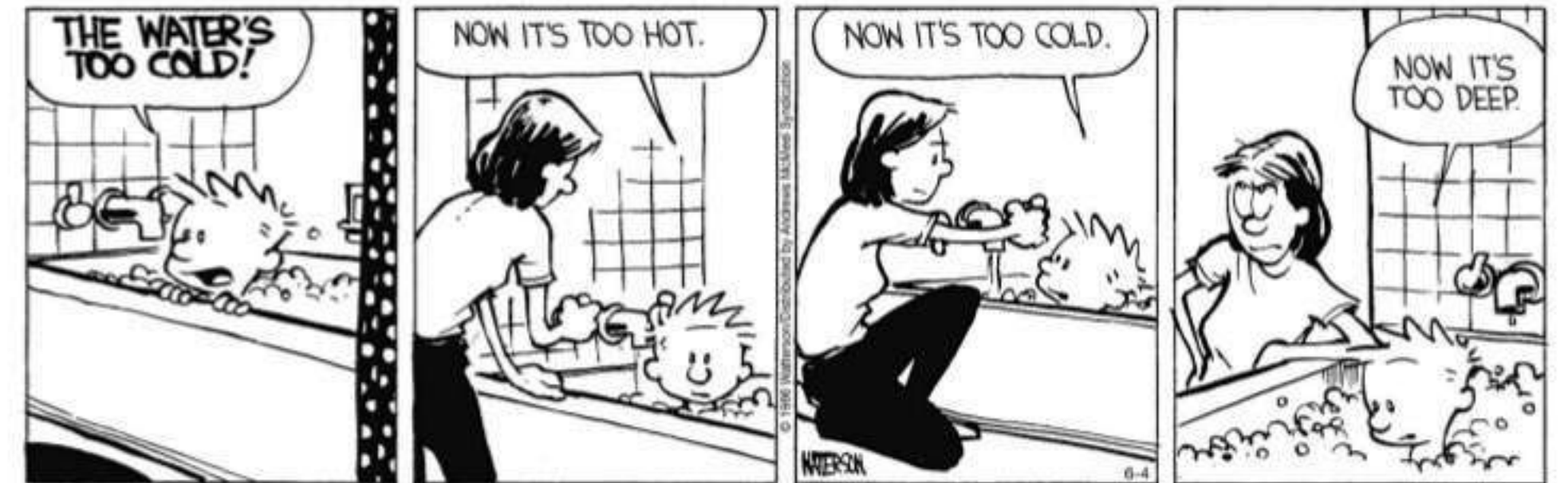
TORSK HLLWOY

ANSWER: Matte, Tork, Wholnt, Wholly

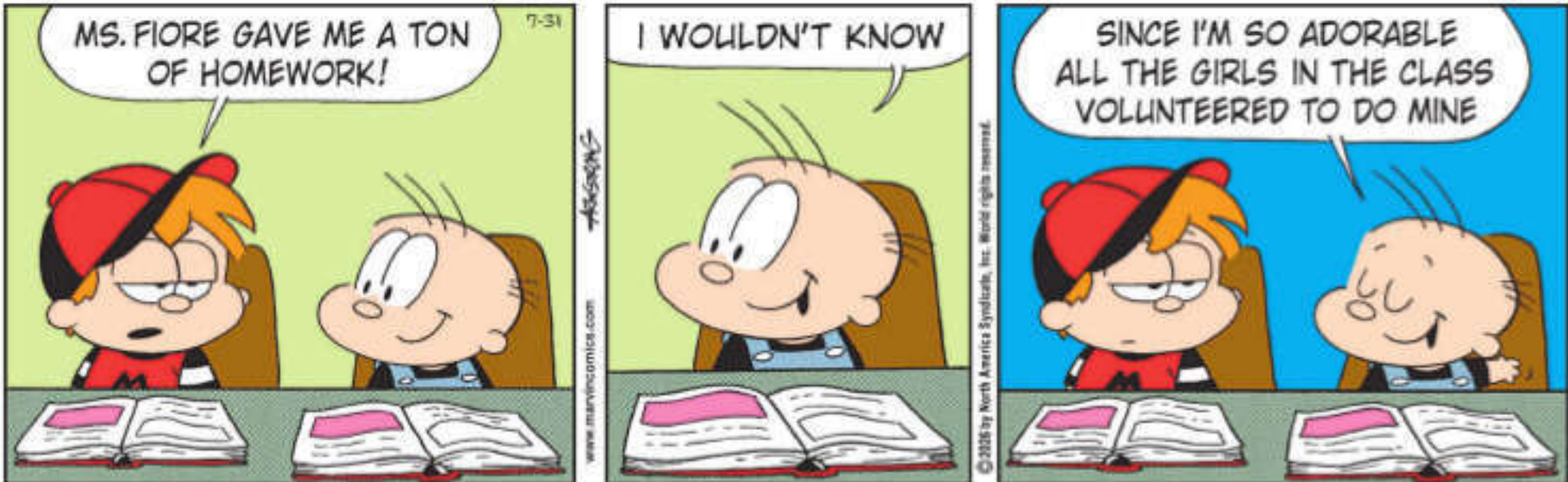
• OVER THE HEDGE



• CALVIN & HOBBS



• MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6435

		8				1		
	1		4		2		3	
		3	9		6	8		
6			2	1				8
1	2				7		5	
9		3		5				1
		7	6		3	4		
	5		7		9		8	
		6				9		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6434

8	4	9	2	1	5	3	7	6
6	5	3	8	9	7	2	1	4
7	2	1	4	3	6	8	9	5
9	1	7	6	2	8	4	5	3
5	3	8	9	4	1	7	6	2
4	6	2	7	5	3	1	8	9
3	7	6	5	8	4	9	2	1
2	8	4	1	6	9	5	3	7
1	9	5	3	7	2	6	4	8

• ROYAL STARS

♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): You are the artisan of the zodiac, and today is a productive day. Enjoy sports events and the company of kids. Hone in a technique and improve your creative skills. Tonight: Socialise.

♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a great day to improve your home or expand it somehow. Or you might explore ideas about a different home. Listen to the advice of someone more experienced. Tonight: Take it easy.

♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today you're filled with optimism and the power of positive thinking. Discussions about home and family will go well. An older friend might benefit you. Tonight: Enthusiastic conversations.

♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is an excellent day for financial decisions. Admittedly, something might look too good to be true. Nevertheless, someone in power might share some wisdom with you. Tonight: Money ideas.

♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is an amazing day because the Moon is in your sign lined up with lucky Jupiter. This is why you feel generous, optimistic and sociable. You will get what you give. Tonight: You're in the zone.

♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a feel-good day for you. The Sun and your ruler Mercury are in your sign boosting your confidence and communication skills. You also might feel competitive. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Conflicting energies are in the air today. Because you might want to be low-key and private. However, it is a great day to talk with friends, groups and organisations. Tonight: Be friendly.

♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): You make a wonderful impression on parents, bosses and VIPs today. They see you as wise, generous and successful. Enjoy this great press. Talk to friends and groups. This is a solid day to make goals for the future. Tonight: You're noticed.

♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): The Sun at the top of your chart makes you look great in the eyes of others. Furthermore, opportunities to travel and expand your world are abundant. Tonight: Explore.

♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Discussions about inheritances and how to divide or share something will go well today. In fact, you'll be laughing all the way to the bank. Meanwhile, travel plans and chances to explore publishing, the media, medicine and the law are excellent. Tonight: Check your finances.

♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): In one way, you have to go more than halfway when dealing with others today. Nevertheless, this is a productive day for you. You can get a lot done. Travel will beckon. Partners and friends will be behind you 100 per cent. Tonight: Cooperate.

♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): We know that this year you have a chance to improve your job or get a better job. With this in mind, today is one of the best days for you to pursue opportunities to do this. Work-related travel will delight some of you. Tonight: Get organised.



TRAFFIC ADVISORY



Welcome

International Heads of State, Dignitaries and Global Delegates

BRICS Summit-2026

11 - 13 Sept., 2026 Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

Diversion Points: 22 **Controlled Roads: 35+** **Elaborate vehicular regulations in force**

To ensure seamless movement for VIP convoys and minimize public inconvenience, dedicated traffic regulations and diversions will be in effect, primarily across the New Delhi District and surrounding corridors



01 ROADS TO AVOID CONTROLLED AREA

Motorists should not plan routes through the following roads for the duration of the Summit. A detailed map is issued alongside the official notice.

Mathura Road	Brig. Hoshiyar Singh Marg
(Subramaniam Bharti Marg	Shanti Path
T-Pt - Lodhi Rd Flyover)	Sher Shah Suri Marg
Tees January Marg	Dr. Zakir Hussain Marg
Janpath	Tilak Marg
Satya Marg	San Martin Marg
Prithvi Raj Road	Rajesh Pilot Marg
Firoze Shah Road	Akbar Road
Ashoka Road	Sardar Patel Marg
Tughlak Road	APJ Abdul Kalam Road
Neela Gumbad	Kautilya Marg
Panchsheel Marg	Bhagwan Das Road
Subramaniam Bharti Marg	Kemal Ataturk Marg
Mother Teresa Crescent	Kartavya Path
Teen Murti Marg	Purana Quila Road
Africa Avenue (Bhikaji Cama	Safdarjung Road
Place - Yashwant Place)	Nyaya Marg
'C' Hexagon	



02 SUGGESTED ROUTES RAILWAY STATIONS

NEW DELHI RAILWAY STATION

Route A: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Boulevard Road → Rani Jhansi Marg → DBG Road → Panchkuian Road → Outer Circle, Connaught Place
Route B: Ashram Chowk → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → JLN Marg
Route C: Vande Matram Marg → Dr. Ambedkar Marg → Panchkuian Road → Outer Circle, Connaught Place



OLD DELHI RAILWAY STATION

Route A: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Ring Road → Hanuman Mandir → S.P. Mukherjee Marg
Route B: Ashram Chowk → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → Ring Road → Hanuman Mandir → S.P. Mukherjee Marg
Route C: Vande Matram Marg → Dr. Ambedkar Marg

→ Rani Jhansi Marg → Rani Jhansi Flyover → Boulevard Road → Lothian Marg

HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN RAILWAY STATION

Route A: AIIMS → Ring Road → Ashram Chowk → Mathura Road
Route B: ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Ring Road → Raj Ghat → Ring Road → Ashram Chowk → Mathura Road



03 SUGGESTED ROUTES AIRPORT

METRO STRONGLY RECOMMENDED: Motorists are advised to travel to Airport Terminals via Metro services in view of traffic regulations.

FROM GURUGRAM

• **T3 / T4 / T2:** NH-48 → Rao Gajraj Singh Marg → Old Delhi Gurugram Road → UER II → Service Road → T3 Terminal Road
 • **T1:** NH-48 → under Mahipalpur Flyover → T-3 Road
 • **T1:** NH-48 → Mahipalpur Flyover → NH-48 → Ulaanbaatar Marg → T-1 Road

FROM DWARKA

• **T3/T4/T2/T1:** Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER II (New Tunnel to T3)

FROM NEW DELHI & SOUTH DELHI

• **T3:** Ring Road → AIIMS Chowk → Moti Bagh Chowk → RTR Marg → Under Shankar Vihar Flyover → Sanjay T-Point → Service Road → NH-48 → Under Mahipalpur Flyover Rangpuri → T-3 Road.
 • **T3 / T4 / T2 / T1:** AIIMS Chowk → Ring Road → Moti Bagh Chowk → RTR Marg → Shankar Vihar Flyover → Ulaanbaatar Marg

FROM WEST DELHI

• **T3/T4/T2/T1:** Punjabi Bagh Chowk → Ring Road → Raja Garden Chowk → Najafgarh Road → Pankha Road → Dabri → Dwarka Road → Road No. 224, Dabri-Gurugram Road → Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER-II → Service Road NH-48 → T3 Terminal Road.

FROM NORTH & EAST DELHI

• **T3 / T4 / T2 / T1:** ISBT Kashmiri Gate → Rani Jhansi Flyover → Rohtak Road → Punjabi Bagh Chowk → Raja Garden Chowk → Najafgarh Road → Pankha Road → Dabri → Dwarka Road → Road No. 224, Dabri-Gurugram Road → Sector-22, Dwarka Road → UER-II → Service Road NH-48 → T3 Terminal Road



04 TRANSPORT SERVICES

• **BUS:** Necessary diversions may be given during VVIP movements.
 • **METRO:** Available for commuters at all stations without disruption.
 • **TSRs / TAXIS:** No roadside parking except designated areas; diversions possible during VVIP movement.

05



DIVERSION POINTS



ALTERNATE ROUTES



OUTSIDE CONTROLLED AREA

01 DR DINESH NANDINI DALMIA CHOWK (W-POINT)	NOT ALLOWED: Mathura Road, Tilak Marg DIVERTED VIA: BSZ Marg → IP Marg - East/South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: BSZ Marg → Delhi Gate - Centre/North/West Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Sikandara Road - New Delhi/CP	07 ROUND ABOUT, RML HOSPITAL	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Mother Teresa Crescent & Talkatora Road DIVERTED VIA: Sheikh Mujibur Rehman Marg - Centre/South/West/North Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Baba Kharak Singh Marg - CP /West/North/Centre/East Delhi	15 LODHI ROAD / MAHARISHI RAMAN MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Maharishi Raman Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/West/ Centre/North/New Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Bhisim Pitamah Marg - South Delhi
02 RAM CHARAN AGGARWAL CHOWK (A-POINT)	NOT ALLOWED: Commercial vehicles beyond this chowk to W-Point DIVERTED VIA: IP Marg - East/South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: DDU Marg - New Delhi/CP DIVERTED VIA: BSZ Marg → Delhi Gate - Centre /North/West Delhi	08 VANDE MATRAM MARG / SIMON BOLLIVAR MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Simon Bollivar Marg DIVERTED VIA: Vande Matram Marg → Dhola Kuan - South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Vande Matram Marg → Karol Bagh - New Delhi/East/North/West/Centre Delhi	16 LODHI ROAD / ARCH BISHOP MACARIUS MARG UNDER LODHI FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Arch Bishop Macarius Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/ West/Centre/North/New Delhi
03 MIR DARD CHOWK	NOT ALLOWED: Maharaja Ranjit Singh Marg DIVERTED VIA: Mir Dard Marg → Abdul Gaffar Marg → DDU Marg - New Delhi/Centre/North/ West Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Mir Dard Marg → Kotla Marg → BSZ Marg/DDU Marg - North/Centre/East/ West/South Delhi	09 DHAULA KUAN FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Sardar Patel Marg DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road (both sides) - South/ New Delhi/East Delhi & Centre/West/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Vande Matram Marg - New Delhi/ North/Centre/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: NH 48/Gurgaon Road - IGI Airport & Gurugram	17 NEELA GUMBAD	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Oberoi Flyover / Dr. Zakir Hussain Marg DIVERTED VIA: Mathura Road → Ashram Chowk - South/East/New Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/West/Centre/ North/New Delhi
04 KASTURBA GANDHI MARG / OUTER CIRCLE CP	NOT ALLOWED: Towards C Hexagon, Outer Circle CP DIVERTED VIA: Outer Circle → All other arterial roads except Janpath - New Delhi/South Delhi	10 MOTI BAGH FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Shanti Path DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road (both sides) - South/ New Delhi/East Delhi & Centre/West/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Rao Tula Ram Marg - South West Delhi, IGI Airport & Gurugram	18 UNDER OBEROI FLYOVER	NOT ALLOWED: Mathura Road DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Flyover through U-turn underpass opp. DPS Mathura Road - South/East/ West/Centre/North/New Delhi PERMITTED: Vehicles bound for Oberoi Hotel and Golf Link
05 JANPATH/ CONNAUGHT PLACE	NOT ALLOWED: Towards C Hexagon from Outer Circle CP DIVERTED VIA: Outer Circle → All other arterial roads except Kasturba Gandhi Marg - New Delhi/ South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Kali Bari, Shaheed Bhagat Singh, Panchkuiyan, Minto & Barakhamba Roads - Centre/North/West/East Delhi	11 ROUND ABOUT, BRIG. HOSHIAR SINGH MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Africa Avenue towards Yashwant Place DIVERTED VIA: Brig. Hoshiar Singh Marg - New Delhi/South/East District DIVERTED VIA: Africa Avenue → Bhikaji Cama Flyover - South/East/Centre/North/West Delhi	19 U-TURN OPPOSITE DPS, MATHURA ROAD	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Bharat Mandapam DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Flyover through U-turn underpass opp. DPS Mathura Road - South/ East/West/Centre/North/New Delhi
06 PATEL CHOWK	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Windsor Place & RBI on Sansad Marg DIVERTED VIA: Ashoka Rd → GPO - New Delhi/ South/West/Centre Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Sansad Marg → CP- Centre/ North/West/East Delhi	12 MADARSA T-POINT	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Aurobindo Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Aurobindo Marg → Safdarjung Fly over - South/New Delhi/West/Centre/North Delhi	20 RING ROAD / BHAIRON ROAD	NOT ALLOWED: Towards Bhairon Marg DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road Sarai Kale Khan - South/East/West/Centre/North/New Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Ring Road Rajghat - Centre/ North/East/West Delhi
		13 LODHI ROAD / AMRITA SHERGIL MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Amrita Shergil Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/West/ Centre/North/New Delhi	21 MANDI HOUSE	NOT ALLOWED: Feroz Shah Road, Bhagwan Das Road, Copernicus Marg DIVERTED VIA: Barakhamba Road - New Delhi/ Centre/North/West/South Delhi DIVERTED VIA: Sikandra Marg - East/North/ West/South/Centre Delhi
		14 LODHI ROAD/ MAX MUELLER MARG	NOT ALLOWED: Max Mueller Marg DIVERTED VIA: Lodhi Road - South/East/West/ Centre/North/New Delhi		



06 IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS & PUBLIC ADVISORY

Priority Corridors & Exemptions

• **Emergency & Medical Vehicles:** Priority, obstruction-free passage maintained 24/7 across Delhi.
 • **Essential Services & Utilities:** Uninterrupted access granted for essential supplies and utility operations in all zones.

Travel Planning & Public Mobility

• **Transit Hubs:** Allow extra travel time when heading to Airports, Railway Stations and ISBTs.
 • **Public Transport & Routes:** Opt for public transport and follow designated alternative routes and diversion points.
 • **Commercial Traffic:** Non-destined commercial vehicles are prohibited from entering Delhi.

Traffic Rules & Parking

• **Designated Parking:** Park only in authorized areas; roadside parking within 200 meters of Controlled Roads is strictly prohibited.
 • **Road Discipline:** Follow the instructions of deployed traffic personnel and obey all traffic rules patiently.

Public Safety & Updates

• **Security Vigilance:** Report any unidentified objects or suspicious activity to the nearest police officer immediately.
 • **Real-Time Information:** Stay updated via official Delhi Police social media channels and traffic portals.



Public cooperation is solicited to ensure smooth transit and safety for all.

DAY AFTER SATYA NIKETAN BUILDING CAME CRASHING DOWN

After collapse kills 7, arrests, suspensions

5 MCD officials suspended as hostel collapse exposes gaps in enforcement



Near the collapse site on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Drishti Jain
New Delhi, September 7

A DAY after a building collapse in South Delhi killed seven people, including five students, the Delhi government moved to suspend five senior officials of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), including the Deputy Commissioner of the South Zone.

According to officials, the action was intended to signal that accountability would extend beyond the building's owners to those responsible for enforcing building and safety regulations.

An office order issued by the MCD Vigilance Department's Deputy Law Officer on September 7 said, "Rakesh Kumar, Deputy Commissioner, South Zone, is hereby placed under suspension with immediate effect as per DMC Services (Control & Appeal) Regulations, 1959." The order said he would be paid a subsistence allowance in accordance with the rules.

Four other MCD officials were also suspended: Superintending Engineer Ranvir Singh, Executive Engineer Lalit Kumar, Assistant Engineer Sunil Chauhan and Junior Engineer Ashish Kumar.

The suspensions have put the MCD's building enforcement system under scrutiny, raising questions about whether officials failed at multiple points to detect and act on potentially dangerous work at the property. "The collapse has exposed possible gaps in field-level inspections and the reporting of building violations," a senior civic official said.

According to MCD officials, the collapsed building — P-14, a property in a resettlement colony with an area of about 55 square yards — consisted of a basement and four floors above ground. It was reportedly constructed in the 1990s. Officials

said on Sunday that the MCD had no record of the property ever being booked for a building violation or sealed.

"We had received no complaints of any work at this property," an MCD official said.

Repair work in an aging building

The initial police investigation, according to sources, has revealed that repair work had been underway for about a week in the basement and on the ground floor. The work was intended to address chronic waterlogging, and workers had been hired for the job, sources said.

Senior MCD officials said that work particularly which deviated the sanctioned building plan needs permission from the civic body.

"The question is therefore not only whether the building was structurally unsafe, but whether the civic enforcement machinery had mechanisms in place to detect and intervene when work was being carried out," another source said.

The field-level gap

Officials also flagged the role of the junior engineer, who is typically the MCD's closest point of contact with buildings in the field.

"A junior engineer is the field-level officer who is the man on the ground," the senior official said. "If he observes and finds any house or building flouting building norms, he has to report it to the A.E., who then prepares a notice."

In the case of P-14, however, officials said there was no record of a booking or sealing action against the property. "That raises questions about whether the building was inspected, whether any violations were detected and, if they were, whether they were properly escalated through the enforcement chain," an official said.

MCD and Delhi Police scrutinise oversight — two additional floors were added to building, hostel was running for nearly a year



Rescue operations continued for the second day in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

On repair work, 3 accused tell police: 'To fix seepage'

The repair work has been linked to the collapse of the building as it weakened the hostel's structure, sources said.

Alok Singh, Sakshi Chand, Pragynesh

New Delhi, September 7

THE REPAIR work in the basement of the five-storey building in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan, which collapsed on Sunday, was being carried out to address waterlogging and seepage issues, the accused told the police following their arrest, *The Indian Express* has learnt. The repair work has been linked to the collapse of the building as it allegedly weakened the structure, sources have said.

Hariram Gupta, 81; his wife Urmila Gupta, 75; and their son Mahesh Gupta, 52, have been arrested over the building collapse, which has claimed at least seven lives.

Urmila and Mahesh were

arrested from Gurgaon where the family lives, while Hariram was apprehended from a relative's house in Rajasthan's Bhiwadi. Later in the day, Hariram and Urmila were sent to 14-day judicial custody and their son was sent to two-day police custody after they were produced at a judge's residence. Police said Hariram is a retired sergeant of the Indian Air Force. Mahesh runs a hardware shop and has two children.

According to police, the property was registered in Urmila Gupta's name, while electricity connections were in the names of Hariram and Mahesh.

Police said the three arrested members of the Gupta family have no previous criminal record.

Police sources said Hariram and Mahesh told investigators

that repair work was being carried out after students complained about seepage caused by waterlogging. "Last year, during the monsoon, the students complained of seepage caused by waterlogging in the basement. The problem occurred again this year. The Gupta family then decided to carry out repairs," an officer said, citing their statements.

According to the source, the accused told police that they had instructed labourers to fill part of the basement with construction material. Work on one side had been completed by Saturday. However, when labourers began filling the other side, the structure collapsed.

Probe deepens

The PG had eight rooms with a total of 16 beds, spread across four floors.

Police suspect that only seven to eight students were inside the building when it collapsed as several had left for a three-day vacation for the Rakhi festival.

Earlier, officials had feared that 30-40 students could be trapped under the rubble. An officer said a student who escaped, along with workers at the PG, is in contact with police and will provide details of the sequence of events. Their statements will be corroborated with those of the accused.

Police are also investigating how the Gupta family leased the property to "Hostel Daze" last year, which runs several similar facilities in the area. The operator has seven facilities in the vicinity, including hostels for both girls and boys.

During the investigation, police found that Hariram had shifted to Gurgaon with his family in 2001. His brother, Hari Charan, also owns property in Satya Niketan but has since moved to the Millennium City. Police identified the building's owner through an electricity bill obtained from the Delhi Power department and subsequently found that the property had been purchased in Urmila's name.

'If we remove this rubble too quickly...': Night at collapse site

Pragynesh

New Delhi, September 7

AT 1 AM on Monday, rescuers faced fresh danger at the site of a collapsed boys' hostel in South Delhi's Satya Niketan. At least five people were believed to be trapped under the rubble, but removing it risked bringing down the adjoining girls' hostel.

Personnel from the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) stood atop the debris, working out how to proceed.

"If we remove this rubble too quickly, this building could fall," said an NDRF official, pointing to debris attached to the adjoining five-floor girls' hostel.

"This is a girl's hostel but it doesn't have any rebar. It has a common wall with this collapsed structure, and was standing mostly on its base. It's difficult to see how one stands without the other," the official added.

The boys' hostel had collapsed about 16 hours earlier. By then, NDRF personnel had pulled out 15 people, five of them dead. But the rescue operation had slowed for more than an hour as teams tried to clear the remaining rubble without destabilising the adjoining building.

They drilled holes into the debris to push in oxygen pipes and search for survivors. "We don't see an end any time soon. It could take one more day to clear everything up," an official said.

Civil Defence volunteers ran around with iron jacks, placing them under the extended first floor of the girls' hostel to support the structure

and allow rubble removal to continue.

About 100 metres away, three students stood watching. "Look at all these buildings. Aren't they waiting to fall? It's not just the building. The shops here, the food they give here. Everything is sub-standard," said Aditya, a third-year student of Delhi University's Dayal Singh (Evening) College who had lived in the locality until last year.

"I was in a similar paying guest (PG) accommodation here, now they are all being cleared. I dodged a bullet," he added.

His friend Jayant Chowdhary, also a third-year student at Dayal Singh (Evening) College, blamed property managers for the condition of Satya Niketan.

"The area is half a century old. You need proper repair work. But they will just white-wash the building every year. New clothes for a sick body make no difference," he said.

At about 3 am, an NDRF official shouted out. Rescuers had found a laptop, charger and small pouch, all held by an unconscious boy. They frantically cleared the debris and pulled him out, but there was no pulse.

By 7 am, the crowd began to swell again.

Later, one more person was pulled out from the rubble who was declared dead in the hospital, taking the toll to 7.

The rescue operation was declared complete after 27 hours on Tuesday. Sniffer dogs Vikky and Rocky conducted a final check. Four nearby buildings were declared dangerous and evacuated as well.

persons associated with the property.

Rent agreement under lens

Students who rented rooms at the "Hostel Daze" PG were required to sign an agreement stating: "The PG authorities are not responsible for any casualties or risk to me."

The rental agreement, accessed by *The Indian Express*, appears to absolve the owners of responsibility for risks to students' lives. It also gives the management the power to ask students to vacate their rooms at its discretion, without citing a legitimate reason.

The agreement requires students to pay a security deposit equivalent to three months of rent. The deposit is stated to be non-refundable, including in circumstances where an emergency forces a student to leave before the agreement expires. The terms of the agreement are now being examined by police to determine whether they violate legal norms.

● SATYA NIKETAN, A STUDENT HUB

'Don't want to live here anymore': Gripped by uncertainty, students pack bags

Reva Thakkar and Mishal Mussaddique

New Delhi, September 7

UNNAYAN BHATI moved out of his home in Uttar Pradesh's Bulandshahr last month as he enrolled in Delhi University's Aryabhata College.

The 18-year-old found temporary accommodation in Satya Niketan, a hub for DU students with South Campus in proximity.

But he wanted to shift. "The rent was too high. The electricity rates were also steep at Rs 15 per unit," he said. He spent an entire month looking for a new home.

He received a call on Sunday from a broker. Around 1:30 pm, he was on his way with the broker to visit a hostel when the

duo heard tremors. A five-storey building, known as 'Hostel Daze', collapsed in front of them. The collapse has claimed at least seven lives.

Both jumped off the scooter promptly. "If we were a bit closer, the building would have crashed on us," said Bhati.

Grateful for the close shave, he on Monday joined an All India Students' Association protest, demanding Rs 1 crore compensation for the building collapse victims. With his parents concerned for his safety following the incident, Bhati plans to go back home for a few days. "I'm, for sure, not going to live in Satya Niketan anymore," he said. But he has already paid Rs 28,000 for one month's rent and security deposit for his current accommodation.

Most students living in and around the area are packing up their bags — some are heading home while others are staying temporarily at a friend's or relative's place.

The buildings right next to Hostel Daze have been vacated while the DU has reached out and offered the students temporary housing. An 18-year-old, hailing from Arunachal Pradesh, who lived in Hostel Daze for a year, told *The Indian Express* that she paid Rs 17,000 a month for a double-sharing room on the fourth floor of the five-storey building. "Rain water used to seep into our room. They promised us a rooftop room, but never shifted us. Even the food was not good... so I left," she said. She said she has been trying to get her security



A student relocating after the building collapse. PRAVEEN KHANNA

ity deposit from the owners since she moved out in June.

Staying in a building opposite to the collapse site now, she

says she does not have the resources to even go back home.

Another student, 19-year-old Isha Biswas, who was witnessing the rescue operation underway at the building collapse site on Monday with her roommates, pointed and said, "That's where I used to live."

She moved out of Hostel Daze as the rent of the room kept increasing. Currently living in a PG in the fourth lane of Shanti Niketan, she does not want to move out of the area as just one year of her course is now left. She plans to talk with the owners of her four-storey PG and hope they address her concerns.

Second-guessing their decision

Kanishka Mourya, a student

of Maitreyi College, chose a PG in Satya Niketan over her college accommodations as the fee for the same at Rs. 1,80,000 for a year, with a Rs 90,000 fixed deposit.

"There is a hostel criterion, first preference is on a merit basis, second on a distance basis, and the seats are limited according to the courses," she said. She is now second-guessing her decision.

Just a day before the building collapse, Priya Chowdhary had moved into the Student Hub PG in Satya Niketan on Saturday. Hailing from Rajasthan, Chowdhary is unsure of her next steps.

Aastha Kumari, a 19-year-old student of Atma Ram Sanatan Dharma College, was in her PG hostel eating her lunch

when the power went out. "It didn't seem unusual as power outages are quite frequent. But then I heard people shouting, so I ran out to see what had happened," she said. "I stayed outside for a while because our warden messaged us on the WhatsApp group to do so."

Kumari lives two lanes away from Hostel Daze.

"It was so traumatising, I saw five people being taken away from the debris," she recalled the moments after the building collapse as chaos ensued. Kumari said she wants to just move away from the area, but she can't afford to. "My parents can't pay another security deposit or the rent that I've already paid for this month. If I don't get it back, I think I'll have to drop out," she said.

This institution will not be browbeaten: CJ in Punjab DA case

Express News Service
Chandigarh, September 7

ON THE day he took oath as Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra Monday asserted that the HC would be guided by rule of law and its oath to Constitution, saying the institution would not be “browbeaten by any kind of tactics”. The oral observations came during the hearing of an application seeking action against officials for alleged willful disobedience and non-compliance with the HC’s August 3 order directing the Punjab government to release pending Dearness Allowance/Dearness Relief (DA/DR) instalments and arrears to its employees and pensioners. “This court would be governed by the rule of law and this institution will not be browbeaten by any kind of tactics. So therefore, we will go strictly as per the law. We have taken the oath of the Constitution and we know how to preserve our oath and defend it...” Chief Justice Mishra said. The Division Bench comprising Chief Justice Mishra and Justice Rohit Kapoor also made it clear that it would not be in-

Day after Cabinet move, Mann skips Chief Justice’s oath event

Express News Service
Chandigarh, September 7

JUSTICE ASHWANI Kumar Mishra took the oath as the Chief Justice of Punjab and Haryana High Court on Monday, a day after the Punjab cabinet passed a resolution demanding his “appointment and administration of oath...be put on hold”. Punjab Governor Gulab Chand Kataria administered the oath of office to Justice Mishra at a ceremony at Lok Bhawan in Chandigarh. While Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini attended the ceremony, Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann did not. Judges of the Punjab and Haryana HC were present at the event. On September 5, the Appointments Division of the Department of Justice under the Union Ministry of Law and Justice issued a formal notification, appointing Justice Mishra as Chief Justice of Punjab and Haryana HC. The notification, issued under Article 217(1) of the Constitution, states that the President was pleased to appoint “Shri Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra, Judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, to be the Chief Justice of the High Court



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini with Punjab & Haryana High Court Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra and others on Monday. ANI

of Punjab and Haryana with effect from the date he assumes charge of his office.” In fact, the Centre asked Justice Mishra on June 1 to perform the duties of Chief Justice of the HC after the appointment of Justice Sheel Nagu, then Chief Justice, as a Supreme Court judge. Born in 1968, Justice Mishra graduated in Economics from Kirori Mal College in Delhi before completing his LLB from Campus Law Centre, University of Delhi. He enrolled as an advocate in 1993, and primarily practised in civil, constitutional and service law. He was designated a Senior Advocate in 2013 and named an Additional Judge of the Allahabad HC in 2014. He

made without obtaining the consent of the state government, thereby bypassing all Constitutional norms and set procedures,” it said in a statement. “The Cabinet resolved that the appointment and administration of oath should be put on hold until Punjab’s views are obtained and duly considered.” “Today, the Punjab Cabinet unanimously passed an important resolution against the continued assault on Punjab’s rights by the Centre and violation of constitutional norms. Appointing the new Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court without obtaining the consent of the State Government is a direct violation of the prescribed procedures (Memorandum of Procedure) and constitutional norms,” Mann wrote on X. The Supreme Court Collegium recommended the appointment of four Chief Justices of HCs, including Justice Mishra, on August 6. On August 12, the Centre sought the views of the CMs and Governors of the four states. While the Memorandum of Procedure does not stipulate a time period for the states to reply, it is learnt that the consent for appointment of a Chief Justice is dealt with immediately.

‘Interference’: SC judge again writes against Rajasthan judge

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, September 7

EVEN AS accusations against former acting Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court, Sanjeev Prakash Sharma, are “being examined at the appropriate level”, a fourth letter by Supreme Court judge Justice Sandeep Mehta levelling fresh allegations against him has come to light. In a fourth letter to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, dated August 30, Justice Mehta claimed he has “further information and material regarding arbitrary, dubious and patently high-handed acts...” of Justice Sharma.

On Monday, a swearing-in ceremony was held at Rajasthan Lok Bhawan, where Governor Haribhau Bagde administered oath of office to Sanjay Kumar Agarwal as Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court, replacing Justice Sharma, who had been acting CJ for nearly a year.

Last Monday, the SC Collegium had recommended Justice Agarwal as Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court – a decision that came within an hour of Justice Sharma going on leave.

In earlier letters to the CJI, dated August 2, 10 and 17 and copied to other Supreme Court Collegium members, Justice Mehta accused Justice Sharma of “misuse of powers” and said he had received “several complaints” that “raise doubts” about Sharma’s “integrity”. He sought Sharma’s transfer to another HC and the appointment of a new Chief Justice.

In the fourth letter Justice Mehta has accused Justice Sharma of interfering in an internal judicial enquiry, breaching confidentiality, and abusing administrative powers. In the letter, Mehta has alleged Justice Sharma “is directly interfering in the administrative functions of the Judges of the High Court.”

Justice Mehta cited a Complaint Committee constituted to inquire into allegations against a Judicial Officer accused of displaying indecent pictures of a fellow female officer on his mobile phone. “...The Committee observed the Acting Chief Justice caused the records of the Committee to be shared with other Officers of the Registry and Judicial Officers, thereby breaching the confidentiality of the enquiry instituted against a Judicial Officer with grave charges,” Justice Mehta claimed.

Justice Mehta also claimed Justice Sharma “created certain posts having escalated pay scales and giving Chief Justice discretionary powers to make appointments against some posts”. He cited the posts of Senior Chauffeur GR-I, placed at L-11 in the Pay Matrix (Rs 37,800-1,19,700), and Chief Chauffeur, placed at L-12 (Rs 44,300-1,40,100).

Justice Mehta said he had “credible information” that “new posts have been created with exorbitant pay scales... without following the due process of law”. Justice Sharma did not respond to queries seeking his response to the latest letter.

AAP govt vs judiciary: How Punjab’s policies, finances faced court scrutiny

Manraj Grewal Sharma
Chandigarh, September 7

PUNJAB CHIEF Minister Bhagwant Mann’s absence from the swearing-in of Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra as the Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court Monday spoke volumes. A day earlier, Mann’s Cabinet passed a resolution demanding that his “appointment and administration of oath should be put on hold until Punjab’s views are obtained and duly considered” by the Centre.

However, the Centre went ahead with its move with Punjab Governor Gulab Chand Kataria administering the oath of office to Justice Mishra at a ceremony at Lok Bhawan in Chandigarh. The ruling AAP is already framing it as another round in the familiar conflict between Punjab and the BJP-led Centre – and between the state’s rights and the Union’s “high-handed” actions. This is likely to dominate the party’s public messaging in the days ahead.

The timing is significant, with Punjab Assembly elections less than six months away. The Mann government has moved a special leave petition in the Supreme Court against a ruling by a division bench headed by then Acting Chief Justice Mishra, directing the state to clear pending dearness allowance (DA) instalments for employees. The high court noted that the state continued spending on advertisements and other discretionary expenses while citing financial constraints over employee dues.

This is not the first time the AAP government has faced judicial pushback. Several of its administrative decisions, policies and recruitment processes have come under judicial scrutiny.

Among the most significant cases involved the Mann government’s land and urban development policies. Its Land Pooling Policy, 2025, aimed at consolidating large tracts of agricultural land for development, was stayed by the HC in August 2025. The court questioned the



Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

lack of mandatory Social and Environmental Impact Assessments and raised concerns over timelines, grievance redressal and rehabilitation of affected landowners. The government later withdrew the policy.

The Punjab Unified Building Rules, 2025, which included the contentious “Stilt+4” (stilt plus four floors) provision, met a similar fate in December 2025. The HC stayed it, citing concerns over densification without adequate infrastructure planning. By April 2026, the government rolled it back too, reverting to the earlier framework.

The government’s Low Impact Green Habitats policy for farmhouses remains under challenge before HC and National Green Tribunal which stayed it December 2025 over proposed construction in ecologically sensitive Shivalik-Kandi belt.

The AAP government’s handling of welfare funds has also faced judicial scrutiny. In July 2026, the HC stayed its proposal to divert funds from the Punjab Building and Other Construction Workers’ Welfare Board corpus to schemes includ-

ing the Mukh Mantri Mawan Dheeyan Satkar Yojana. The issue was not the scheme itself, but whether a statutory cess collected for a specific purpose could legally be diverted to another programme.

The recruitment issue has also been under judicial scanner. Recently, the HC stayed the appointment of pharmacy officers following allegations of an interstate cheating racket in its recruitment exam. It also stayed selections under Punjab State Rural Livelihoods Mission over alleged irregularities in awarding marks and questions about the exam agency’s conduct.

The courts have also been keeping a close watch on Punjab’s law and order situation. Taking suo motu cognisance of gangster Lawrence Bishnoi’s two 2023 TV interviews, including one conducted from inside a Punjab Police facility in Kharar while he was in custody, the HC ordered a probe into alleged connivance by police officers. The court has sought wider prison and police reforms, besides fixing accountability of officials through periodic status reports.

**Maharashtra Airport Development Company Ltd.**
CIN: U45203MH2002SGC136979

TENDER NOTICE
MADC invites Tender for Construction of Balance work scope of Isolation Bay Road, TXY Link Road and Construction work of Cooling Pit with road, Fire Pit Road, CFR Roads, watch towers and CNG work in airside area of Shirdi airport, Village Kakadi, Tal. Kopargao, Dist. Ahilyanagar.
The detailed tender document can be downloaded from the website www.mahatenders.gov.in from 08/09/2026, 01:00 PM.
Sd/-
Vice Chairman & Managing Director, MADC

**मुरादाबाद विकास प्राधिकरण, मुरादाबाद**
“नया मुरादाबाद योजना” के सेक्टर-16 बी में निम्नित भूमि उपयोग एवं कूल्ट मूखण्डों को ई-नीलामी के माध्यम से प्राप्त करने का सुवर्ण अवसर
पंजीकरण प्रारम्भ तिथि: 08.09.2026 (प्रातः 10:00 बजे तक),
समाप्ति तिथि: – 22.09.2026 (रात्रि 11:59 बजे तक)
ई-नीलामी तिथि:– 25.09.2026 समय- प्रातः 11:00 बजे से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक

क्र.सं.	सम्पत्ति श्रेणी	सैक्टर संख्या	सम्पत्ति क्षेत्रफल (वर्गमी.)	सूखण्ड मार्ग की स्थिति	आरक्षित दर (रु.)	सम्पत्ति की अनुमानित कीमत (रु.)	पंजीकरण घनराशि (रु.)	
1	Mixed Land Use	16	MU-01	657	12M	66500.00	4,36,90,500.00	25,00,000.00

पंजीकरण प्रारम्भ तिथि: 09.09.2026 (प्रातः 10:00 बजे तक),
समाप्ति तिथि: – 23.09.2026 (रात्रि 11:59 बजे तक)
ई-नीलामी तिथि:– 26.09.2026 समय-प्रातः 11:00 बजे से दोपहर 01:00 बजे तक

क्र.सं.	सम्पत्ति श्रेणी	सैक्टर संख्या	सम्पत्ति क्षेत्रफल (वर्गमी.)	सूखण्ड मार्ग की स्थिति	आरक्षित दर (रु.)	सम्पत्ति की अनुमानित कीमत (रु.)	पंजीकरण घनराशि (रु.)	
1	Mixed Land Use	16	MU-02	4891	12M	66500.00	32,52,51,500.00	1,00,00,000.00
2	Industrial	16	HS-01	5021	12M/12M	38000.00	19,07,98,000.00	1,00,00,000.00

विशेष सूचनाएं –
(1) इसका व्यक्ति/संस्था को ई-नीलामी में प्रतिभाग करने हेतु प्राधिकरण के ई-नीलामी पोर्टल <https://public.erpudpa.com> पर अनिवार्य रूप से दर्ज करना होगा।
(2) विस्तृत विवरण हेतु पंजीकरण पुस्तिका का अध्ययन करें।
(3) आवेदन करने के पर्यन्त यह मान्य होगा कि आप के द्वारा पंजीकरण पुस्तिका में अंकित समस्त नियम एवं शर्तों को पढ़ व समझ लिया गया है तथा आपको समस्त शर्तें मान्य हैं।
(4) ई-नीलामी प्रक्रिया के सम्बन्ध में किसी भी जानकारी हेतु सम्पत्ति प्रभारी, मुंविभाग, कार्यालय से किसी भी कार्यविधय में प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
सचिव

**डॉ० राममनोहर लोहिया अवध विश्वविद्यालय, अयोध्या (उ०प्र०)**
पत्रांक: लो०अवि०/सा०प्र०/2026/419
दिनांक: 07.09.2026

शुद्धि पत्र
एतद्वारा आदेशानुसार विश्वविद्यालय के निम्नलिखित एवं व्यवस्थित विभागों में विभिन्न पदों पर नियुक्ति हेतु प्रकाशित विज्ञापनों में निम्नलिखित संशोधन किया जाता है :-
1. विश्वविद्यालय के विज्ञापन सं० 01/2026, 02/2026 एवं 03/2026 दिनांक 20 जुलाई 2026 में सूचनाओं के विज्ञापन में विभिन्न पदों पर नियुक्ति हेतु प्रासंगिक विषयों (Relevant Subjects) को पत्रांक के रूप में सम्मिलित करते हुए अंतिम में ग्राह्यताय संशोधन कर दिया गया है।
2. विश्वविद्यालय के विज्ञापन सं० 06/2026 दिनांक 17 अगस्त 2026 द्वारा प्रकाशित विभाग (व्यवस्थापक) के सचिव/नियंत्रण विभागों के रिक्त पदों पर चर्चा हेतु निम्नलिखित में विश्वकोष की अंतिम एवं अनुपम पीसीआईआई द्वारा निम्नलिखित दिनांक 08 अगस्त 2022 के अनुसार संशोधित किया जाता है।
3. विश्वविद्यालय के विज्ञापन सं० 06/2026 दिनांक 17 अगस्त 2026 द्वारा ई-टेंडर/एड ऑफ ऑनलाइन एंटर प्रोसेसिंग एंड टेन्डरिंग (व्यवस्थापक) में निरीक्षण पत्र की अनुपम पीसीआईआई के चयन के अनुसार संशोधित किया जाता है। उपर्युक्त संशोधनों के अतिरिक्त अन्य सभी शर्तें एवं प्रावधान समान रहेंगे। संशोधित अंतिम, अनुपम एवं अनुपम का विस्तृत विवरण विश्वविद्यालय की वेबसाइट www.rmlau.ac.in पर देखा जा सकता है। निम्न आवेदकों द्वारा पूर्व में आवेदन किया जा चुका है, उनके द्वारा विश्वविद्यालय के पोर्टल पर आवश्यक संशोधन किया जा सकता है।
कुलसचिव

**UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.**
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Office of the Superintending Engineer, Electricity Distribution Circle, Chakrata (HQ-Kalsi), Dehradun Website- www.upcl.org, e-mail ID- edc.chakrata@upcl.org, edcchakrata@gmail.com, Phone No.- 9411746161

पत्रांक: 1616 / वि/विभाग/चक्रा / चक्रा/सि/07 दिनांक: 07 / 09 / 2026
E-TENDER NOTICE
The following e-tenders are invited under Electricity Distribution Circle, Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd., Chakrata (HQ-Kalsi), Dehradun, by the undersigned :-
1. E-tender No.- **50/EDCC(K)/2026-27**
2. E-tender No.- **51/EDCC(K)/2026-27**
3. E-tender No.- **52/EDCC(K)/2026-27**
For more details, kindly visit the website www.uktenders.gov.in
Superintending Engineer, EDC, Chakrata

**NATIONAL FERTILIZERS LIMITED**
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
CIN: L74899DL1974GOI007417
Registered Office: Scheme Corporation, Core-III, 7, Institutional Area, Lodhi Road, New Delhi 110003
Website: www.nationalfertilizers.com
Email ID: investor@nfl.co.in, Telephone: 011-24360066, 24361252

ADDENDUM TO 52ND ANNUAL REPORT- COMMENTS OF COMPTROLLER & AUDITOR GENERAL OF INDIA (C&AG)
Annual Report of the Company for the Financial Year 2025-26 was posted on the website of the Company www.nationalfertilizers.com and sent only by electronic mode to those Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Registrar and transfer agent/ Depositories. Addendum to the Annual Report with respect to the Comments of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (C&AG) under Section 143(6)(b) of the Companies Act, 2013 on the Financial Statements (Standalone and Consolidated) of the Company for financial year 2025-26 had also been sent to the members of the Company through e-mail and also available on the website of the Company www.nationalfertilizers.com. The same forms part of the Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26.
For National Fertilizers Limited, Sd/- (Ashok Jha) Company Secretary

PUBLIC NOTICE

**SOBHA**

Whereas, M/s Sobha Limited (“Developer”) having its registered office at Sarjapur, Marathalli, Outer Ring Road (ORR), Devarabisanahalli, Bellandur Post, Bangalore-560 103 and having its regional office at 5th Floor, Rider House, Plot No-136P, Sector-44, Gurugram-122003, Haryana, is in the process of developing a project by the name of Sobha Altus (Mix Land Use 80% Residential and 20% Commercial) under TOD policy dated 09.02.2016 in Sector –106 Village Pawala Khusrupur, Manesar Urban Complex Gurugram on 5.51 Acres land in accordance with the provision of license no. 91 of 2023 dated 21.04.2023 granted by Director General, Town & Country Planning Department, Haryana Chandigarh (“DTCP”).

And whereas several individuals have made booking/entered into purchase agreement for allotment of Unit/Apartment in the said project (“hereinafter referred to as Allottee(s)”).

And whereas the building plans earlier approved for the aforesaid project vide memo no. **2P-1924/JD(RD)/2024/11677 dated 09.04.2024** are now proposed to be revised in accordance with the Haryana Building Code, 2017.

And whereas the office of the Director General Town & Country Planning, Haryana, Chandigarh vide its in-principle approval dated 01.09.2026 has asked the Developer to invite objections from the existing Bonafide Allottee(s) regarding the said amendment/revision in the building plans. Accordingly, the objections are hereby invited from any of the Allottee(s) in the said project on the proposed revision in the building plans. A copy of the earlier approved building plans bearing memo no. **2P-1924/JD(RD)/2024/11677 dated 09.04.2024** and the proposed revised building plans approved in principle by the Director General, Town & Country Planning, Haryana, Chandigarh (“DTCP”) bearing memo no. **2P-1924/JD(RA)/2026/31374 dated 01.09.2026** are available on the website www.sobha.com for perusal.

The aforesaid building plans can also be perused in the site office of the Developer on the address mentioned hereinbelow and also in the office of Senior Town Planner, HSPV Complex, 3rd Floor Department of Town & Country Planning, Sec 14, HUDA Complex, 3rd Floor, Gurugram, Haryana 122001.

Any Bonafide Allottee(s) having any objection/suggestion on the revised building plan may file his/her/its objection in the office of Senior Town Planner, HSPV Complex, 3rd Floor Department of Town & Country Planning, Sec 14, HUDA Complex, 3rd Floor, Gurugram, Haryana 122001 on above address under intimation to the Company within 30 days of publication of this notice, failing which, it shall be assumed that there are no objections to the proposed revision of the building plans.

**M/s Sobha Limited
Sobha Altus, Sector 106,
Village Pawala Khusrupur, Gurugram
Email: crm.altus@sobha.com**

**Date: 08.09.2026
Place: Gurugram**

Nandigram bypoll on October 6

New Delhi: The Election Commission on Monday announced bye-elections to five Assembly seats, including Nandigram in West Bengal, and one Lok Sabha constituency on October 6. The EC announced the by-polls for Madurantakam and Dharapuram in Tamil Nadu; Thattanchavady in Puducherry; and Rejinagar and Nandigram in West Bengal. The EC also announced bye-poll to Nagaon parliamentary constituency in Assam that fell vacant upon resignation of Pradyut Bordoloi. ENS

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
The Deputy Chief Engineer/Const., Northern Railway, Shivaji Bridge, New Delhi, for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-tender under Single Packet System for the following work:-

Name of Work and location	"PWay works including linking of BG track; turnouts, provision of gage joints; SEJs, dismantling of existing track; turnouts; handling of P-way material working in B/N/I/NI period and other allied works in c/w 3rd & 4th Line between Tilak Bridge-Anand Vihar Railway Station.
Completion period of the work	12 (Twelve) Months
Approx. Cost of work	₹965.43 Lakh
Earnest Money to be deposited	₹19,30,900/-
Sale/availability of tender document on Rly. Website	Tender documents will be available on IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 15.09.2026 to 29.09.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs.
Last date/Time of upload of tenders	29.09.2026 upto 15:00 hrs. Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS website w.e.f. 15.09.2026 to 29.09.2026
Date and Time of opening of tender	29.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
No.: 551-ACS-PWAY-3rd-4th Line-CSB	Dated: 07.09.2026 3063/2026

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**India Trade Promotion Organisation**
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Mission Punjab

CONGRESS LEADER Sachin Pilot's visit to the party office on Delhi's Akbar Road on Monday was much discussed in party circles as he came down to Delhi for the first time since being appointed the AICC in-charge for poll-bound Punjab. Incidentally, it was Pilot's birthday and the party's Punjab chief Amrinder Singh Raja Warring turned up to greet him. With Pilot scheduled to visit Punjab soon, the two leaders learnt to have discussed state politics and the ensuing polls. Warring and former CM Charanjit Singh Channi have been caught in an intra-party feud which Pilot is supposed to sort out.

Nabin's Outreach

The Punjabi community settled in Uttarakhand will be in the spotlight during BJP president Nitin Nabin's two-day visit to the state beginning Wednesday. Nabin will attend the 'Punjabi Gaurav Sammelan' in Rudrapur on September 10, where the party will celebrate the rich cultural heritage and traditions of the community and its contribution to the state. Party insiders say the outreach is significant given the fact that both Punjab and Uttarakhand are scheduled to go to polls early next year.

Lunch, Laddoos

Busy with back-to-back meetings and a press conference at the Congress office on Akbar Road, Congress OBC department chairman Anil Jaihind couldn't have lunch on Monday. When party MP from UP's Sitapur, Rakesh Rathore, brought a box of laddoos for Jaihind as a courtesy gift, he was more than happy to eat two pieces to compensate for lunch. Rathore then asked Jaihind to join him for lunch, but the latter expressed his inability, citing a packed schedule of official engagements.

Birla: Women's quota to open new avenues for leadership

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 7

LOK SABHA Speaker Om Birla on Monday said the 33% reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state Assemblies would open new avenues for women's political leadership, and asserted that the day was not far when they would account for more than half of the country's public services.

Birla was speaking after inaugurating a two-day All-India capacity building workshop on "Gender-Responsive Governance", organised by the National Commission for Women in Fardabad. His remarks come against the backdrop of the government's efforts to advance the implementation of the women's reservation law ahead of the 2029 Lok Sabha polls. The government's attempt to amend the law during the Budget Session, through a delimitation-linked constitutional amendment, failed to secure the required two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha.

Birla said sensitivity was a core strength of women's leadership and could help in understanding people's concerns and finding effective solutions. He said advancing women's leadership should be a collective resolve, with efforts aimed at ensuring greater representation of women in leadership positions across spheres of national life.

No liquor sale on Ashtami, no DJs: BJP govt in Bengal draws Puja rules

CM warns against themes 'that may hurt Sanatan sentiments', scraps carnival

Atri Mitra

Kolkata, September 7

FROM SCRAPPING the annual Puja Carnival, introduced by the previous TMC government in 2017, to banning the sale of liquor on Maha Ashtami, the BJP government in West Bengal on Monday announced a slew of measures that will be adopted in this year's Durga Puja in the state.

The BJP government, however, would continue to give assistance of up to Rs 1 lakh to Puja committees, albeit with conditions. Speaking to the media after chairing a preparatory meeting for the festival at Kolkata's Milan Mela grounds, Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari said the first Durga Puja under the BJP government will be marked by a series of large-scale cultural events, drone and fireworks shows.

Stressing the need to maintain discipline and preserve the traditional character of the festival, he asked Puja committees to ensure that their idols, pandals and themes do not hurt religious sentiments or undermine Sanatan traditions.

"Theme-based Pujas, however, will be permitted," he said, while urging organisers to exercise greater caution in selecting their themes. Announcing the scrapping of the Puja Carnival, held every year on the Red Road to celebrate the UNESCO heritage tag for the Durga Puja, the Adhikari said, "The carnival that was being imposed in the name of Durga Puja for the last few years will not be held this year... Instead, the state Tourism and Information and Cultural Affairs departments will jointly organise a major programme at Eden Gardens to mark the beginning of the festive season. The programme will feature a four-hour drone and fireworks show, and an elaborate series of events will be held across the state during the run-up to Durga Puja."

A special event will also be held in Digha after Mahalaya, while cultural programmes will be organised for two days in six cities across the state, Adhikari said, adding that Prime Minister Narendra Modi would be invited to the special Mahalaya event. On Puja grants, Adhikari said those Puja committees that are financially capable and have

CM apologises for 11-arm Durga on official ad

Kolkata: West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Monday apologised for a newspaper advertisement by his government depicting Goddess Durga with 11 arms instead of 10.

"Firstly, as the chief minister, I apologise to all for the erroneous advertisement which came out in the morning. Those who made the advertisement have been given a stern warning. The state government, henceforth, will be careful," Adhikari said.

The ad called for a coordination meeting on Monday to plan for the upcoming Durga Puja, the first after the change of guard in Bengal. However, at the meeting, the Goddess' image on the background hoarding had 10 arms. ENS

a large budget should not avail the government funds. "The government will stand by those Puja committees for which it would be difficult to organise the Puja without government funds..." He, however, said that every puja pandal across the state will get free electricity during the festival, adding that the West Bengal State Electricity Development Corporation and CESC have agreed to it.

"On the day when devotees offer Maha Ashtami *anjali* to Maa Durga, all liquor shops in the state will remain closed. There will be no liquor available in bars either... No liquor will be sold anywhere on that day under any circumstances," he said. In addition, playing DJ music during the Puja and immersion processions has also been banned.

Adhikari also said that the government would not allow roads and national highways to be unnecessarily blocked in the name of organising Pujas. "...Puja will not be allowed by blocking national highways and roads under any circumstances," he said, indicating that organisers would have to ensure that public movement is not disrupted. In Kolkata, 13 major roads, including Red Road and Cathedral Road, will not be closed for the Puja.



West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari at the Puja preparatory meeting, in Kolkata on Monday. PARTHA PAUL

'Bengalis will eat what they always have': State BJP chief amid row

Sweety Kumari & Tanusree Bose

Kolkata, September 7

A DAY after the chief priest of Madhya Pradesh's Bageshwar Dham, Dharendra Krishna Shastri, kicked up a row in West Bengal by appealing to people not to cook or eat fish or meat during Durga Puja festivities, describing those who do so as "pakhandi (fraud)", state BJP president Samik Bhattacharya said no one can prescribe what people should eat or wear.

"On Ashtami (the eighth day of festivities), Bengalis eat luchi, and on Navami, Bengalis eat mutton. So, they will keep eating that," Bhattacharya said, adding, "Whether to give importance or not to any statement, whether Bengalis will give importance to his words or not is entirely a matter for Bengalis to decide. There is no politics involved in this."

The state BJP chief emphasised that Shastri's remarks were his own views. "Right now, campaigns promoting vegetarianism are being held. Many doctors are also saying it. But what you eat at home, will a sadhu determine that? Will a political party decide that? Bengalis will eat what they always have. Will Bengalis not eat fish? Will Ben-



West Bengal BJP president Samik Bhattacharya

galis not eat meat? Even Swami Vivekananda approved of this and who stands above him? The Goddess Kali here consumes mutton. I haven't found anyone greater than Swami Vivekananda yet. If someone suddenly rises above him, that's dangerous. So, there is no question of accepting such ideas. This is his opinion," Bhattacharya said.

The BJP leader said Shastri was a highly respected figure and "enjoys massive popularity" across the country. "He has made an appeal. He has every right to do so. You can make an appeal too. Don't people make appeals to leave drugs? ... If you start eating fatty mutton every day, is that good for your health? Think about it. However, regarding what he said, there is no need for any controversy. As I say, let us remain as

we are. Let me be as I am."

On Sunday, Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari and his entire Cabinet hosted Shastri, popularly known as Bageshwar Baba, for dinner at a state-run guesthouse in Kolkata.

Following Shastri's comments, the Trinamool Congress (TMC) released a statement targeting the BJP and the government. "Bageshwar Baba was given a grand welcome by Suwendu Adhikari. Then, in Bengal, he called for banning non-vegetarian food during Durga Puja. Is this the BJP's plan to take fish and meat off Bengali plates? Is that why restaurants face raids before Puja? Bengal will resist," it said.

State Congress president Subhankar Sarkar accused the BJP of insulting the people of Bengal. "It is evident that they don't have control of Bengal locally; the remote is in Delhi's hands. Who is Dharendra Shastri? Why is he being given such importance? This is nothing but the actual nature of the BJP. It always speaks in this language," he told *The Indian Express*.

"Why should people do that (follow Shastri's appeal)? If the government runs with the intention to appease someone, it is not good for society," said CPI(M) leader Sujana Chakraborty.

Vijay digs into DMK's past, Udhayanidhi questions: 'What about the present'

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 7

CHIEF MINISTER C Joseph Vijay had promised last week that he would answer the Opposition on Monday. He arrived with history.

For much of his reply in the Tamil Nadu Assembly, Vijay travelled backwards — through ED documents, the Sarkaria Commission, the Veeranam project, MISA, M Karunanidhi, M G Ramachandran and even poet Kannadasan — to make an argument he has returned to repeatedly since taking office: that corruption was not incidental to the previous DMK establishment but embedded in its political machinery.

Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin's response later was almost the inverse. Tamil Nadu, he argued, had elected Vijay to govern the present, not to conduct a guided tour of 1970.

The exchange produced tumult inside the House and a larger political question outside it: how long can the corruption history of the DMK remain politically renewable when the party returned to power repeatedly after those controversies — and how long can Vijay rely on exposing that past before voters begin demanding an account primarily of his own government?

Vijay began with another subject that has increasingly shadowed Tamil Nadu politics: the language in which politicians speak about one another. "A river of obscenity and a river of hatred have been flowing through Tamil Nadu," he said, referring to "defamatory and vulgar remarks about women, the double entendres and the triple entendres." Politicians could criticise one another as harshly as they wished, Vijay said, but "there is no need to personally demean our people, our women or anyone else, or to speak in a degrading manner."

The reference was unmistakably connected to recent controversies involving Opposition speeches, though Vijay presented it as "a general appeal to everyone". Citing the Sarkaria Commission's examination of Veeranam project, Vijay referred to allegations surrounding a contract worth over Rs 16 crore awarded to Sathyanarayana Brothers during the DMK government of the 1970s. He said the Commission record referred to an alleged 2.5% commission



CM C Joseph Vijay at the Tamil Nadu Assembly on Monday. PTI

and payments amounting to Rs 29 lakh between 1970 and 1974. He stressed that these were not fresh allegations made by his government. "These are not allegations made by us," Vijay said. "These are allegations contained in that report and in the document sent by the ED." He then moved decades forward to ED material concerning the previous DMK government, quoting allegations that contractors had been compelled to pay between 7.5 and 10% under the description of "party fund". He cited the agency's allegations involving then Municipal Administration and Water Supply Department and former minister V Senthil Balaji's tenure over-seeing TASMAR.

Many of the matters Vijay cited remain disputed, under investigation or before courts. The Sarkaria Commission itself belongs to a political history Tamil Nadu has already voted through several times: after the controversies of the 1970s, the DMK returned to power in 1989, 1996, 2006 and 2021.

Outside the House, Udhayanidhi attacked both the substance and choreography. The Chief Minister, he said, had ignored questions about current law and order and instead "went back to 1970". "He sat for three days, mugged up something written and given to him by somebody, came here and vomited it out," Udhayanidhi said. The stakes explain some of the caution beneath the aggression in Udhayanidhi's reactions too. "All of those are merely allegations. Nothing has been proved. The investigation is continuing," he said of the ED material.

As Monday's Assembly became something more than a fight over who stole what and when, Vijay was trying to make the DMK's past present again. Udhayanidhi was trying to force Vijay back into the present.

'PM travelled to 22 countries in a year': Shah says talks helped India withstand global headwinds

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, September 7

DESPITE THE uncertainty due to recent global conflicts, India has been able to achieve a record 7.8% GDP growth in one quarter, primarily due to sustained dialogue, strategic partnerships and Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) signed with several countries under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said on Monday.

At a ceremony in Goa, where he presented the President's Colour to the state's police, Shah said India's outreach in global diplomacy is expanding steadily with each passing day. "In the past one year, the global diplomatic sphere has been in turmoil due to the war between Ukraine and Russia and the conflict involving Iran in the Gulf region.



Union Home Minister Amit Shah with chief ministers Devendra Fadnis (Maharashtra), Pramod Sawant (Goa) and Bhupendra Patel (Gujarat) at the Western Zonal Council meeting in Panaji, Monday. PTI

In one year, Narendra Modi ji travelled to 22 countries and the heads of state of over 15 countries visited India. When the entire world was in turmoil due to conflicts and economic uncertainty, and was struggling to sustain economic growth, we engaged [with the world] through sustained dialogue and forged strategic partnerships and,

thereby, maintained our economic momentum," he said. "Important agreements were signed in several sectors, including in energy, defence, technology, energy, investment and trade."

"It is because of Narendra Modi Ji that India's diplomacy has been able to establish its distinct place in the world today. No matter what the global issue

is...the world looks on to see the Indian PM's perspective on the matter. After a long time, our leader Narendra Modi has brought this respect to India."

Shah said by 2026, India has concluded nine Free Trade Agreements. "These agreements have been established as effective trade arrangements with 38 countries. The agreements with the United Arab Emirates, Austria, Australia, the United Kingdom, Oman, New Zealand and the European Union have given a fresh impetus to India's trade. And this is the reason why our GDP growth rate in the three months of this year [April to June] has been recorded at a record high of 7.8%."

Shah said that India has not only achieved economic growth, but has also contributed to the global community in several ways.

contravention of FWA," he said.

Gowda said the government planned to allot sites in villages that fell within the road/road infrastructure component of the project. "When were the sites which are to be allotted formed? Who granted approval for the formation of these sites?" he asked.

Gowda asked whether the real beneficiaries of allotted sites were land losers or NICE and its investors. "Are the investors in your Cabinet, Mr Chief Minister? The state wants to know," he said in the letter.

Deve Gowda targets govt over infra project sites

Express News Service
Bengaluru, September 7

DAYS AFTER the Karnataka Cabinet gave Nandi Infrastructure Corridor Enterprises (NICE) two months to allot sites to farmers affected by the Bengaluru-Mysuru Infrastructure Corridor Project (BMICP), former prime minister H D Deve Gowda on Monday accused the state government of "subverting the rule of law".

In an open letter to Chief Minister D K Shivakumar, Gowda also accused the govern-

ment of defying Supreme Court rulings and said that a previous proposal to allot sites to those who lost land was rejected.

Responding to the letter, Shivakumar said, "Whatever we do, we do it within the confines of law. We took legal opinion. We are reexamining everything. We will do as per law." If there are violations, legal options are open for everyone to challenge the government decision, the CM said, adding that the government will abide by the agreements NICE signed under previous administrations.

Gowda said the state government's stance in the Karnataka High Court. "In March 2023, in a batch of writ petitions filed before the HC, the government placed on record its rejection of the representation made by NICE for allotting sites to land losers on the ground that sites cannot be formed in lands acquired for road and infrastructure under Framework Agreement. In January 2026, the HC categorically held that compensation cannot be by way of sites formed at interchanges or on lands handed over for roads in

EXPRESS special

Why UP Cong is 'worried' about its 2027 poll prospects

Asad Rehman

New Delhi, September 7

WITH ELECTIONS due in Uttar Pradesh early next year and the task of finalising a seat-sharing arrangement with the SP yet to be formalised, the Congress has another headache: differences between state president Ajay Rai and AICC in-charge Rajendra Pal Gautam.

Sources in the state unit said the two leaders — Rai, a Bhumi-har from Varanasi, and Gautam, a Dalit leader whose politics has largely been centred in Delhi — have very different styles of

functioning, which has led to friction between them. Rai was appointed state president in August 2023, while Gautam took charge as the AICC in-charge in June this year. AICC sources said LoP Rahul Gandhi, Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and party general secretary (organisation) KC Venugopal met Gautam for about an hour on Friday to discuss issues that could affect functioning of the state unit under Rai.

Vadra has been involved in party affairs related to Uttar Pradesh since the Congress started preparing for the 2027 Assembly polls and has participated in key meetings. However, several leaders in the state unit are worried that the friction between Rai and Gautam could affect the party's prospects in the crucial Assembly polls next year. Sources said Rai's unease



Contrasting functioning styles of state chief Ajay Rai and (right) AICC in-charge Rajendra Pal Gautam keep party on tenterhooks

with Gautam has been heightened by the latter's reported push for a change in the state president, with Gautam arguing that a Muslim leader would better fit the Congress's attempt to build a social coalition of Dalits and Muslims. Gautam is learnt to have suggested name of Nadeem Javed, a former MLA from Jaunpur.

"The idea behind Gautam pitching a Muslim is simple. A Dalit in-charge and a Muslim state president would put more pressure on the SP during seat-sharing talks, considering that the SP is banking on Muslim support," a senior Congress MP said.

Leaders in the state unit described the Rai-Gautam combination as a "difficult" one. "Rai's politics is centred around temples and upper-caste communities, while Gautam is a hardcore Ambedkarite who is uncomfortable with mixing politics and religion. So, for them to not get along is natural," said a senior UP Congress leader.

Sources in the party said there had been several instances of Rai and Gautam avoiding each other at party programmes.

Rai, meanwhile, is learnt to be unhappy with Gautam's style of functioning, with state leaders accusing the AICC in-charge of trying to operate like the state president. "The role of the state in-charge, who comes to a state on behalf of the AICC, is that of an observer. But Gautam is trying to become a नेता (leader), which is not going down well with the state leadership or Ajay Rai. Gautam also does not understand the internal dynamics of the party in UP. There are bigger leaders who have been consistently advising the high command — people like Rajeev Shukla, Salman Khurshid and Pramod Tiwari, all of whom are from UP," a party leader said.

Sources in AICC, however, said Gandhi had given Gautam considerable freedom to make organisational changes. Both leaders have denied that there was any friction between them.



SWACHH VAYU SARVEKSHAN 2026

Lucknow air cleanest, Indore's second best among cities with million-plus people

• AIR QUALITY: TOP-RANKING CITIES

	Category	City	Cash award (in Rs)
Category 1 (Million-plus population)	1st	Lucknow	1.50 crore
	2nd	Indore	1 crore
	3rd	Jabalpur	50 lakh
Category 2 (3-10 lakh population)	1st	Rourkela	75 lakh
	2nd	Firozabad and Guntur	50 lakh
	3rd	Amravati	25 lakh
Category 3 (less than 3 lakh population)	1st	Kalinga Nagar	37.5 lakh
	2nd	Angul	25 lakh
	3rd	Talcher	12.5 lakh

Nikhil Ghanekar

New Delhi, September 7

CAPITAL CITY of Uttar Pradesh, Lucknow, won the top prize among million-plus population cities in the Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan 2026, considering its interventions to improve air quality, ranging from the use of electric vehicles in its waste collection fleet, deployment of mechanised sweepers to manage road dust, to management of legacy waste. Indore, India's cleanest city for seven years till 2025, won the second prize, and Jabalpur bagged the third position in the category.

Meanwhile, Chennai, Jamshedpur, Kota, Kolkata and Madurai were placed at the bottom five in this category comprising 47 cities, while Delhi and Mumbai ranked 30th and 37th, respectively. The rankings were declared in Delhi on Monday, and National Green Tribunal (NGT) chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava distributed the awards. For the first time, municipal wards that improved their air quality were also honoured.

Efforts in the waste management sector, road dust control, dust management from construction and demolition waste, reduction in vehicular pollution, and reduction in industrial pollution are some of the key parameters used to assess the

cities for ranking. Improvements in the reduction of particulate matter (PM)10 concentrations are given a weightage of only 2.5%. Cities and towns are divided into population-based categories – million-plus, cities with 3-10 lakh and those with under 3 lakh. A cash prize and mementos are awarded to the top three cities or towns.

In the 3-10 lakh population category, Rourkela topped, followed by Firozabad and Guntur at the joint-second position and Amravati at Number 3. In cities with less than 3 lakh population category, Kalinga Nagar won the first prize, Angul bagged second position, and Talcher was placed third.

Though it won the top prize under the survey in the million-plus cities category, Lucknow is yet to achieve the PM10 annual ambient air quality standard of 60 ug/m3 (micrograms/cubic metre), prescribed under the national standards, as per the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP) portal. However, since the programme was initiated in 2019, its annual PM10 concentrations have declined from 250 ug/m3 in 2017-18 to 137 ug/m3, a 45.2% reduction. Jabalpur's achievements included a waste-to-energy plant, 100 per cent collection of waste and scientific disposal, mechanised sweeping of streets, and promotion of electric vehicles.

Entering woman's house, lifting her clothes not rape attempt: Jharkhand HC

Press Trust of India

Ranchi, September 7

THE JHARKHAND High Court has held that merely entering a woman's house at night and lifting her clothes would not amount to commission of rape or an attempt to commit rape as per the Indian Penal Code.

The high court, while hearing the appeal of a convict in a 26-year-old matter, modified the lower court's decision, making it a case of outraging the modesty of a woman and use of criminal force, from the earlier rape.

Justice Pradeep Kumar Srivastava observed that "a specific overt act sufficiently proximate to commission of rape will not constitute an attempt to commit rape as per the Indian Penal Code".

An overt act is a real, physical step taken to move forward the plan to commit a crime. The judgment was passed on

August 31 and released on Monday. The convict challenged his sentence passed by a Ghatshila Sessions Court on July 25, 2006, sentencing him to undergo four years of rigorous imprisonment.

The high court, while modifying the sentence, ordered that since the appellant had already undergone about eight months of custody during the trial, it would be sufficient to meet the ends of justice.

The convict was arrested by the Chakulia police after an FIR was registered on December 27, 1999. The victim had alleged that the appellant had entered her house on the previous night and tried to lift her clothes to rape her.

The police commenced the investigation and found the appellant guilty of "attempt to commit rape" and presented the chargesheet. Subsequently, the trial court convicted and sentenced him to undergo imprisonment of four years.

DAC approves acquisition proposals worth Rs 1.1 L cr

Armed Forces to get CBRN recce vehicles, advanced light helicopters & Arudhra Radars

Amrita Nayak Dutta

New Delhi, September 7

THE DEFENCE Acquisition Council (DAC), India's key defence body for approving major military procurements, on Monday gave the green signal for acquisitions worth about Rs 1,10,000 crore for the armed forces.

The approved procurements include Chemical, Biological, Radiological and Nuclear (CBRN) Recce Vehicles, High Mobility Vehicles (HMTVs), Advanced Light Helicopters (ALHs), Arudhra Radars, Marine Gas Turbines (MGT) and Ground-Based Multi-Purpose Jammers, among others.

In a brief statement, the Ministry of Defence said that the DAC has accorded the Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) for procuring CBRN Recce Vehicles, High Mobility Vehicles (HMTV), Self-Propelled Mechanical Mine Layers (MML), Advanced Light Helicopters (ALHs), Trawl Tanks and Sarvatra Bridge System for the Indian Army.

Of the total AoNs accorded, approximately 98% of procure-



Of the total Acceptance of Necessity (AoNs) accorded, approximately 98% of procurements will be made in India. FILE

ments will be made from the Indian Industry, the statement added.

Grant of AoNs or an in-principle administrative approval to proposed acquisitions is the first step in the defence procurement process. However, obtaining an AoN does not always lead to a final order.

The Defence Ministry statement noted that the CBRN recce vehicles will be capable of detecting, identifying, monitoring and marking areas contaminated with CBRN agents.

The HMTVs will enhance operational capabilities, logistic support and mobility in challenging terrains, while the MMLs will achieve the desired operational capability in terms of fast and responsive minelaying in difficult terrains.

It added that the indigenous ALHs will execute complex missions across all terrains and

operational situations for the Indian Army and the Indian Air Force, and the Trawl Tanks and Bridge System will be utilised to provide composite crossings to fighting formations during operations in varied terrains.

The procurement of Arudhra Radars, Design & Development and subsequent acquisition of Marine Gas Turbines (MGT) have been cleared for the Indian Navy.

The Arudhra Radar is an indigenous 4D multi-function phased array radar developed by India's DRDO and manufactured by Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL). It has electronic steering in both azimuth and elevation for surveillance, detection and tracking of aerial targets. The system will have target identification based on interrogations from a co-located Identification Friend or Foe system. Its successful trials

have already been conducted by the Indian Air Force.

According to the statement, the Arudhra Radar will replace the existing Air Route Surveillance Radars at various Naval Air Stations. The Marine Gas Turbine, a warship propulsion system, will reduce dependency on foreign vendors.

Indian warships have traditionally been fitted with marine gas turbine generators imported from Russia. However, over the last three years, the Navy has been working to indigenise gas turbine parts and the compressor to reduce dependence on imports of spare parts for their maintenance and has been in talks with Indian firms.

In June this year, the Ministry of Defence on Friday signed a contract with Bharat Forge Limited for the acquisition of 12 sets of 1.25 MW Marine Gas Turbine Generators at a cost of around Rs 425 crore for onboard power generation on Kolkata-class ships of the Indian Navy. These marine gas turbine generators will have a minimum of 60% indigenous content.

The Ministry of Defence statement noted that for the IAF, approval was granted to various proposals to enhance the war-fighting capability of fighters, transports and helicopters. Approval was also accorded for procuring Ground-Based Multi-Purpose Jammer (GBMPJ) and installing Defence Forces Secure Access Card (DEFSAC) System.

EXPRESS special

Before illicit booze killed 12 in MP, excise department's many flip-flops

Anand Mohan J

Bhopal, September 7

AS THE death toll in the Sagar suspected spurious liquor tragedy mounted to 12, the MMP Excise Department issued a series of orders that reveal a striking shift in its threat assessment for Sagar Gold, the liquor brand linked to the deaths, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The orders are learnt to have gone from directing officials to stop its sale, seize suspected stock and send it for forensic testing to saying within hours that "no other action is required". The changing stance of the excise department becomes particularly significant in light of Excise Commissioner Deepak Saxena's admission to *The Indian Express* that the suspension of four officials in the case was based on their inaction after early warnings were raised at least three days before the deaths surfaced.

Twelve died, and several were hospitalised after allegedly consuming illicit liquor in Sagar on Saturday. Police probe has since uncovered a suspected interstate supply chain linked to Lalitpur in UP, with 14 of 30 accused arrested and three FIRs registered on complaints by the victims' families. The tragedy has prompted action against Excise officials, with three officials suspended and another senior officer removed from the Sagar setup. The government has also or-



Several people were hospitalised after allegedly consuming illicit liquor in Madhya Pradesh's Sagar district on Saturday. FILE/PTI

dered an inquiry, while police have widened their probe into the suspected supply network.

The excise department is probing allegations on whether an early warning about a suspected counterfeit-liquor network was missed at multiple levels before the alleged spurious liquor reached consumers in Sagar's Banda area. Officials said that the first warning came through a newspaper report published on September 3. An official communication issued two days later — which *The Indian Express* has accessed — said the government foreign liquor warehouse in Sagar examined two bottles featured in the report after the matter was brought to its attention.

On September 5, the Government Foreign Liquor Warehouse in Sagar is learnt to have submitted its report to the Assistant Excise Commissioner

after a local daily questioned the quality of locally supplied liquor. The excise department was informed that the two bottles of 'Bombay Whiskey' brand "conform to packaging standards" and were fit for consumption. It also allegedly identified the manufacturer, and said the bottles were supplied through the government warehouse to composite liquor shops in Sagar and Damoh.

The report, however, was learnt to have been based on examination of bottles shown in the report rather than a wider field probe — something that Saxena has now acknowledged.

The next day, when the first deaths were reported, the tone of the administration appears to have changed sharply. An order issued by the Assistant Excise Commissioner, Jabalpur, on September 6, directed all liquor shops that had received Sagar

Gold to be thoroughly inspected.

The order specifically directed officials to ensure that Sagar Gold was not sold, and said that any suspected stock found at a liquor shop should be "immediately sealed and seized." It further ordered that the liquor be sent to the Forensic Science Laboratory and that its sale remain completely prohibited until its purity was established. This order was partially revised in hours, with authorities withdrawing stringent directions issued earlier over the sale of Sagar Gold liquor and stating that "no other action is required".

The revised order, issued by Assistant Excise Commissioner Sanjeev Kumar Dubey, says the Jabalpur control room had reported that the presence of Sagar Gold was "negligible". The department amended its earlier order of the same date. "All Assistant District Excise Officers and Excise Sub-Inspectors are directed to conduct routine inspections of the liquor shops under their jurisdiction and take effective action in areas identified for the manufacture of illicit/country liquor. No other action is required," the order read.

Saxena told the *Indian Express* that the suspended officials relied on photographs of the bottles, including their paint and other features, to establish their authenticity instead of a field verification.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY



Punjab Agriculture Minister Gurmeet Singh Khuddian with SKM leaders at the Chandigarh-Mohali border on Monday. JASBIR MALHI

PUNJAB

Farmers call off border protest after govt accepts key demands

FARMERS PROTESTING at the Chandigarh-Mohali border for the past seven days called off their stir on Monday after the state government gave a written assurance accepting several of their key demands. Agriculture Minister Gurmeet Singh Khuddian reached the protest site and handed over a signed letter to leaders of the Samyukta Kisan Morcha (SKM). The development came a day after Khudian and Health Minister Dr Balbir Singh held talks with a 25-member SKM delegation at Punjab Bhawan. The written assurance states that the Punjab government will convene a special session of the Vidhan Sabha within a month and pass resolutions on key water-related issues, which will subsequently be forwarded to the Centre. ENS

Boy fails to get admission of choice, ends life

A 17-YEAR-OLD boy who secured 95.7 per cent in Class 12 allegedly died by suicide in Thane on September 4 after he was disappointed over not getting admission to an institute of his choice, police said Monday. An accidental death report in the matter and investigation to find the exact reason is underway. As per police, the boy who resided in the Ghodbunder Road area was upset after he could not get into a Kolkata based engineering institute after ranking 10,474 in the aptitude test. ENS

Bodies of woman and child found, husband suspect

POLICE ON Monday said that a woman and child whose body parts were a day ago in sacks in the Bhavani river in Palakkad have been identified and the murder suspect appears to be her husband, a native of West Bengal. A senior police officer leading the investigation told reporters that family members of the victims are being contacted for a "full identification" of the remains. He further said that the woman's husband, who is missing, is suspected to be the culprit and a team has been dispatched. PTI

Security breach at Omar's Jammu house, trespasser arrested

Arun Sharma

Jammu, September 7

IN WHAT appears to be a security breach, a 21-year-old man allegedly trespassed into the official residence of Jammu and Kashmir CM Omar Abdullah on Friday. The office is located on Jammu's Wazarat Road.

Abdullah was in Delhi at the time, meeting Union Home Minister Amit Shah to discuss a host of issues — restoration of statehood for J&K, finalisation of rules relating to transaction of business between the elected government and the Lt Governor, and rationalisation of reservations.

According to police, the accused is a drug addict and does not have terror links, nor did he venture into the CM's residence with ill intent. Yet, the incident assumes significance in view of the oft-repeated allegations by the ruling National Conference leaders about laxity by security agencies in providing security cover to Omar and his father Dr Farooq Abdullah.

The alleged drug addict hails from Reasi and was apprehended by personnel of the

Special Security Group (SSG), a specialised force meant to protect only the serving chief minister and his immediate family members. After a brief interrogation, he was handed over to the Gujjar Nagar police post.

Officials said that the accused and his friend came to Jammu on September 3 and the same day, he was found roaming in an inebriated state by a police in Gujjar Nagar. The police booked him under sections of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act.

The police called his parents in the evening, but they arrived on September 4 because their home was far off. Since the offence falls in the category of bailable offences, police were set to let him go.

His father was asked to bring a local to stand surety that the boy would report to the police post when called.

When the father went to look for a local contact, the man climbed a hillock adjacent to the police post and from there entered the CM's official residence after scaling its rear wall.

Officials said he was booked on charges of trespass and later released on bail.

• 'RANG-E-CINEMA' — KASHMIR'S FIRST FILM FESTIVAL — WILL SHOWCASE 135 ENTRIES FROM 41 COUNTRIES

Once a favourite shooting destination, Kashmir now bringing cinema back home

Bashaarat Masood

Srinagar, September 7

WHEN CHIEF Minister Omar Abdullah lit the ceremonial lamp to inaugurate Jammu and Kashmir's first International Film Festival — 'Rang-e-Cinema' (the Colours of Cinema) Monday evening, it was more than an opening of a new cultural event. It marked a significant moment in the revival of cinema in a Valley where theatres fell silent and shut their doors after militancy erupted in the early 1990s.

The symbolism was hard to miss. The festival's opening film, a Lebanese movie called 'Dead Dog', was screened at INOX — the Valley's only functional cinema,

opened in Srinagar four years ago. "The four-day festival marks a new chapter in the long-standing relationship between Jammu and Kashmir and the silver screen," Chief Minister Omar Abdullah said in his inaugural address to an audience that included filmmakers Vidhu Vinod Chopra and Ramesh Sippy. "Jammu and Kashmir has always held a special place in the world of cinema, not only because of its spectacular natural beauty but also because its landscapes can become an integral part of a story."

While the lush springs, golden hues of autumn and the white landscape of winter have "always inspired filmmakers to

explore different shades of human emotion, the appeal of Kashmir Valley goes beyond its geographic landscapes, Omar said.

"Kashmir's appeal goes beyond its mountains and scenic landscapes, with its culture, traditions, people, warmth, hospitality and artistic heritage forming an equally important part of its identity," he said. "Music, poetry, handicrafts and oral traditions have kept the region's stories alive for centuries."

Directed by the Beirut-based filmmaker Sarah Francis in 2025, 'Dead Dog' is a 92-minute drama that explores the tense, four-day reunion of an estranged middle-aged couple,



Jammu and Kashmir CM Omar Abdullah during the inauguration of the international film festival in Srinagar on Monday. SHUAIB MASOODI

Aida and Walid, and their dog, Punto.

Filed in a mountain village

near Beirut, the film made its debut at the International Film Festival, Rotterdam, and won

the Saad Eldin Wahba Award for Best Arabic Film at the Cairo International Film Festival (CIFF).

The Kashmir Valley was once a favourite destination for Bollywood and attracted film crews to its beautiful landscapes. However, with the onset of militancy in Kashmir, the cinemas became the first target, leading to movie theatres being shut down across Kashmir. While Neelan cinema briefly opened in Srinagar, it was again shut down as it failed to attract viewers who had to pass through a multi-layered security apparatus. In 2022, the INOX theatre in Srinagar was opened in the high-security Shivpora area.

'Rang-e-Cinema', which will

run from September 7 to September 10, has an eminent jury: cinematographer and director Santosh Sivan, Academy Award-winning Indian sound designer and audio mixer Resul Pookutty, German film curator and journalist Dorothee Wenner, Japanese entrepreneur and documentary filmmaker Keiko Bang, and Himansu Sekhar Khatua, director of the 1997 Odia movie, 'Sunya Swaroopa'.

Over the next three days, 134 more films — shortlisted among more than 1100 submissions — will be screened. Sixty of these films have been produced outside India in 41 countries — including France and Iran.

The government has an-

nounced nine categories with a total prize money of Rs 96 lakh. The Best Film Award will fetch Rs 25 lakh, while the award money for the 'Best Director' and 'Best Debut Director' has been set at Rs 15 lakh each.

'Best Film-J&K Select' would be awarded 10 lakh, while 'Best Actor' male and female would be awarded Rs 8 lakh each. The government has announced Rs 5 lakh each for 'Best Cinematography', 'Best Sound Design' and 'Best Editing'. The movies will be screened at the Sheri Kashmir International Convention Centre (SKICC) in Srinagar, the Gulmarg health resort, INOX Srinagar and the Wave Cinema in Jammu.



Jantar Mantar to Satya Niketan: Join the dots

AT ONE level, the building collapse in South Delhi's Satya Niketan, which claimed the lives of at least seven people and inflicted grievous injuries on several others, is a routine story of a capital's shame to which all are inured. Of yet another builder breaking laws and no one there to check. Of the absence of an emergency exit, extra floors, and unauthorised construction. The investigation into the Saidulajab tragedy in June, which claimed six lives, had revealed similar failings.

But Sunday's tragedy is more than the shame. It is a chapter in the unfolding story since the Jantar Mantar protests. Of the young, the future, being let down by the present. It points to a larger and continuing failure — the inability of governance to keep pace with aspirations. Most victims of Sunday's tragedy — like those in Saidulajab — are reportedly students. Delhi University is a magnet for talent from across the nation, talent that will go on to shape the future, but the university does not have a home for them. So there are hostels, paying guest accommodation and low-cost rental housing — disaster after disaster has shown that these are of poor quality and abysmally inadequate. Property owners cut corners to profit from this demand — basements are altered, additional floors added, and electricity systems pushed beyond capacity. Satya Niketan, developed as a colony for low-income families in the 1970s, underwent a similar transformation as demand for student accommodation grew with the expansion of Delhi University's South Campus. What was once a low-rise neighbourhood became one of the capital's most densely populated student hubs, choked with tangled overhead wires and waterlogged lanes. The Delhi Master Plan 2021 did permit the conversion of residential quarters into student hostels, provided safety protocols — emergency exits, basement use restrictions and height limits — were followed. But four building collapses in Satya Niketan in the last 15 years indicate that short shrift was paid to these caveats.

In Delhi, land is under the control of the Union government. Here, the BJP, which also leads the government at the Centre, can arguably deliver most seamlessly on pledges of the "double engine" sarkar. On Sunday, at an event to mark the centenary celebrations of Shri Ram College of Commerce, Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to his young audience about transformations under his watch since he spoke at the same institution 13 years ago as his party's prospective prime ministerial candidate. "Your seniors could not have such dreams," he said. But today, "you are dreaming these dreams also because today's India has created an ecosystem that supports those dreams". Work needs to begin if the PM's promise to young citizens is to be honoured, and if speeches such as the one at the SRCC on Sunday, are not to take on a hollow ring.

Conscious AI & ethics of a machine that feels

THE MACHINE is intelligent, but is it also conscious? This is the question sparked by the revelation that the AI chatbot Claude Sonnet 4.5 may have something like an internal thought process — a team of researchers found that upon being prompted, the model's internal layers throw up words connected to the eventual output that remain invisible to the user. Anthropic, which has developed Claude, calls this "small collection of internal neural patterns" the "J-space" and has argued that it is comparable to the "workspace" of the human brain — a network of neurons that gathers, integrates and transmits information from different parts of the brain to the rest of the nervous system, making conscious thought possible.

For many, this development gestures to the startling possibility that machines with consciousness may no longer just be the stuff of science fiction. The argument put forth by, among others, AI pioneer Geoffrey Hinton is that the closer the technology gets to mimicking the actual workings of the human brain, the higher the possibility of conscious AI. The ongoing efforts to develop "biological" or "bio-hybrid" computers — where human neurons are mounted on silicon — only bring this eventuality closer. Yet, how the "consciousness" of AI is understood depends also on how consciousness itself is understood. Nearly half a century of research on the subject has yielded over 300 frameworks and theories, one of which is the global workspace theory being used to make the case for Claude's consciousness. Moreover, as neuroscientist Anil K Seth has argued, assertions about the possibility of "conscious" AI are often made based on evidence of its intelligence and the two are very different.

Consciousness, which comes down to subjective experience, would radically change the stakes. AI that is conscious would mean AI that experiences everything that a human does, including hate, jealousy and suffering, transforming it from mere machine into something with a moral underpinning. As more sophisticated models are developed and the frontiers of the technology are pushed into uncharted terrain, the hard task of responding to the questions they raise — including the ethics of consciously developing something that is itself conscious — can no longer be put off.

In satire, a more noble prize

THE OPPOSITE of high-minded hypocrisy isn't always sincerity. At times, it is just some honest satire. Take the Nobel Prize, arguably the most coveted honour across disciplines. A CSR exercise for a Swedish arms manufacturer, despite its infamous acts of omission (Mahatma Gandhi), commission (Henry Kissinger, Bob Dylan) and blindness (Eurocentrism), the prize continues to carry a halo. The Ig Nobel Prize does not carry the pretensions of the famous counterpart it lampoons. And it's better for it.

The awardees for 2026 include psychologists who have shown that rich people are indeed more entitled; physicists who may not help further AI or quantum computing but have designed a "splashless" urinal; the peace prize for a scholar who has shown that friendships based on the pettiness of mutual enmity can be enduring and, for Chemistry, an international team that included Indian researchers for discovering that the "milk" from a species of cockroach contains three times as much energy as cow's milk.

There is a quiet nobility to the Ig Nobel Prize. Perhaps at more than any time since its inception in 1991, the quotidian research it rewards strikes a chord. In an era of war, of boorish leaders and growing inequality, of threats from the Machine and an uncertain climate, a splashless urinal, the evil rich and the productive promise of cockroaches provide a brief chuckle. When inspiration is in short supply, that might just be what people truly prize.

What do we call these student deaths? 'Accident' reeks of both shame & sham

THE STUDENT in India today lives between the violence of the cracking earth and flooding homes. The Cockroach Janta Party protests, led by Gen Z, may have stunned the political establishment, but clearly we have light-years to go before the sanctity of either life or learning can be assured for our students — particularly for those from vulnerable sections of society.

This is not about the *lathis* and water cannons whose threat to these students in Delhi's Jantar Mantar is still raw for us. The disaster that ended lives is the building collapse in Delhi's Satya Niketan on Sunday, killing seven and injuring many more. Close to Delhi University's South Campus, the building mostly housed students, most of whom were home on a Sunday afternoon. Their SoS echoed through the air and through the mobile phones of the dying: "Save us, save us." But the disaster was unforgiving.

These were some of our most vulnerable migrant students who sought a home near the university. Migrants are always vulnerable, more so migrants from the margins of state and society. But the migrancy of the student holds a dream of upward mobility that tinges her vulnerability with the darkest sadness. It screams the failure of a developing postcolonial nation where education and employment are still the only means of upward mobility, often the promise to breathe outside the miasma of poverty.

The building collapse bared the embers of another tragedy from 2024. That July, three UPSC aspirants drowned in the

flooded basement of a coaching institute in Delhi's Old Rajinder Nagar. One survivor told a newspaper that in spite of charging a fee of Rs 2 lakh, the coaching centres lacked safety standards in spaces where the youth studied and spent time. Poor drainage and even electrocution deaths were common in these streets, and Delhi's monsoon caused the basement to flood. Student suicides remain in our memory. But what do we call these deaths? "Accidents" reeks of both shame and sham. How do we remember them? Do we remember them at all?

Flooding water and quaking earth are dark omens. What they possess is not the talismanic significance of ritual and religion, but the forces of neglect and profit. These two nonsensically contradictory realities frame the fate of the Indian student. Particularly those not rich enough to pay their way out of the country or lucky enough to win at the roulette wheel of entrance into elite institutes of technical and professional education.

Higher education, in most countries of the world, is the domain of the state. A few countries, most notably the US, have excellent private institutions that nevertheless cater to only a small, albeit highly influential, percentage of the population. As someone who has been educated at a mix of state and private institutions in India and the US and has taught for the last 21 years at a public university in Canada and private universities in the US and India, I have observed the state-private dynamic



SAIKAT MAJUMDAR

Flooding water and quaking earth are dark omens. What they possess is not the talismanic significance of ritual and religion, but the forces of neglect and profit

from many angles and I come up with the same answer every time: It is only public institutions that can truly educate a nation. Private institutions, if shaped by genuine philanthropy, can at best create tiny islands of excellence, combining the intellectually exclusive with the socially inclusive, and hoping that their identity does not end up the other way around.

But what we did to the K-12 system is what we're now doing to the edifice of higher education. Not only the failure but the orchestrated onslaught on public institutions of higher education around the country led to the claustrophobic dead end that triggered the CJP protests at Jantar Mantar. But while the economy struggles and jobs fail to materialise, the greed of property development continues, and unchecked growth finally chooses as its prey the vulnerable body of the migrant student. That corrosive greed, Delhiites have already learned bitterly this year, does not discriminate between immediate stakeholders in either health or higher education — between those connected to hospitals or to universities.

Meanwhile, the migrant student, the provincial aspirant to educational and professional success, remains just as vulnerable to the greed of the private player, who has now gained destructive prominence due to the dysfunction of the public system. The glaring lacunae left by governmental failure have now been eaten up not only by profiteering private institutions of questionable quality, but by the

● WORDLY WISE

The accomplice to the crime of corruption is frequently our own indifference.

— Bess Myerson

Gloria Steinem framed the motherhood question for us



POOJA PILLAI

EVERY OBITUARY about Gloria Steinem, who died on September 2, has noted two facts. One: Her turn towards feminism at the age of 35 is linked with an abortion she had at 22, the memory of which was sparked at a 1969 "speak-out" where other women shared their own experiences. That day, Steinem wrote, a realisation "clicked" into place: What she had regarded as something deeply personal was, in fact, political because of the number of women who had also struggled with it. Two: From the age of 10 to 17, Steinem was the primary caregiver of her mother, who suffered from addiction and debilitating mental illness.

In the US, reproductive rights, the nucleus around which Steinem's feminist consciousness was formed, have seen major reversals since 2022 when the US Supreme Court struck down the 1973 ruling *Roe v Wade*, which had made abortion a constitutional right. Since then, 20 states have either implemented a total ban or imposed severe restrictions on abortions. The troubling way in which the issue is framed — "pro-choice" vs "pro-life" — obscures what it is really about: A decision about motherhood. What Steinem found in that basement meeting in 1969 was permission to accept not wanting to be a mother. To make such a choice possible, to bring motherhood out from under the rubric of destiny and place it in the realm of options, is the feminist endeavour.

Years later, Steinem wrote that her mother, who had been a journalist before getting married, had dreamed of working in New York City. Can Ruth Nuneviller Steinem's mental breakdown be tied to the thwarting of ambition — of choice? And did it shape her daughter's choices? Steinem herself said that while early caregiving responsibility may have influenced her choice, she had also never felt the urge to have children.

So here's the feminist proposition number one: A woman may choose to not become a mother for many reasons, including that she simply doesn't want to. And feminist proposition number two: Even after she has chosen motherhood, she remains an individual, with agency and her own vulnerabilities. But all too often mothers — expected to absorb everyone else's needs without generating any of their own — are made to disappear into the ideal that is motherhood. The neglect is global, and structural. All through pregnancy a woman's body is monitored with great care, while her mind gets almost no attention. According to WHO estimates, one in five women experiences a mental

health condition during pregnancy or in the year after birth, which makes it almost as common as gestational diabetes, even as it is screened for far less.

Even where the law prioritises a woman's mental health over social expectations of motherhood, the story is the same. Take India's Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act, as amended in 2021. It permits termination up to 24 weeks and explicitly counts grave injury to mental health as a ground. Yet, the 2023 case of the woman, already a mother of two, who had to approach the Supreme Court to allow the termination of her pregnancy, showed its limits. The woman was, at the time, being treated for postpartum depression and had not realised she was pregnant until 20 weeks had passed due to lactational amenorrhea. A two-judge bench allowed the procedure saying that continuing the pregnancy could imperil her mental health. Then a doctor on the AIIMS medical board said that the foetus was around 26 weeks and had a strong chance of survival, so was the heartbeat to be stopped first? Within days, the two judges split. The matter went to a three-judge bench led by the CJI, who held that there was no immediate threat to the woman's life and no foetal abnormality, and that the statutory ceiling had passed. The termination did not happen.

A right that exists in the statute books only to evaporate under pressure is a right that was never institutionally serious. Mental health may have been written into the MTP Act, but the systems that shape the course of motherhood in India continue to fail women.

It is against this background that the extreme cases are made to do work they cannot do. Consider Lindsay Clancy, an American woman charged with killing her three children, whose defence was postpartum psychosis. Her case has generated more public arguments about maternal mental illness than the everyday struggles of women. But building our understanding of maternal mental illness on such cases only makes the subject seem disconnected from its more common manifestations. The solution is not complicated: Perinatal mental health screening as ordinary obstetric care and training health workers at every level to recognise what they are looking at. Finally, it calls for treating a woman's statement about her own mind as evidence to be taken seriously, not dismissed as "mood".

The writer is deputy associate editor, The Indian Express. pooja.pillai@expressindia.com

As a student, I felt invisible to the city's powerful



PRANJYA GROVER

AS A student from Lucknow, I worked towards a dream — a seat at Delhi University. The university is a symbol of possibility for many who couldn't otherwise afford it. Despite the city's reputation, parents nurture their child's dream because of its promise. They eagerly accompany their child to look for a "home away from home". I remember my parents' faces dropping as soon as they entered the clutter and squalor of the Satya Niketan area. For the 17-year-old me, the dirt and congestion didn't matter as much. I had cinched a seat at Jesus and Mary College in the Psychology Department and was over the moon. I had also known that this was all that my family could afford in the South Delhi neighbourhood. All I could imagine was how I could transform this matchbox-sized room into 100 square feet of cool. So I stacked books, put up fairy lights, and filled my walls with posters and keepsakes.

In hindsight, what I was really trying to do was replace the claustrophobia with things that would soften the harshness of returning to a suffocating room with no ventilation or sunlight. It would soften the reality that I was paying upwards of Rs 12,000 in rent (which was about the same as my annual college fees) and sharing a "queen" bed, one tiny toilet, and a small desk, of which the chair collided with the bed the moment you stood up.

My beloved roommate (whose hometown was Kota) and I made the best of the living situation, not because we enjoyed it but because that was our only option. We both took turns falling sick; typhoid was a frequent visitor in the lanes of Satya Niketan. We romanticised the rooms as "cosy". This is the precise vulnerability of a student's life that builders take advantage of. Low-income families don't just pay monetary debts; sometimes, as happened this week in Satya Niketan, the cost is their child's unlivable life.

It has always seemed to me — as a student and now as a citizen — that we are invisible to the city's powerful. Their remarkable capacity and resilience to turn disaster into opportunity work for builders. This is why, when I heard of the building collapse in Satya Niketan, which has already claimed seven lives and injured others, I wasn't surprised. Because the tragedy of a student trapped in rubble, crying for help, is not only a heartbreaking image but also one that speaks of something familiar — a dangerously flawed ecosystem: Of recurrent negligence, collusion of private owners with civic officials at all levels, and the normalcy of damage control that overrides precautionary measures.

I wonder what this tragedy will mean for students who come after me. What it will mean for the students currently residing in that neighbourhood. How do you resume everyday life knowing that the very roof above your head — your supposed home away from home — can collapse any moment? That help is incredibly far, be it their guardians in far-away hometowns or actual on-ground help. At least I have the privilege of distance today. For those who stake their hopes on these systems, the risk, and the price they pay, is their mental and physical health and future.

Satya niketan literally translates to "Home of Truth" — that is a misnomer if there were ever one.

The writer is a counselling psychologist

40 YEARS AGO September 8, 1986



Dead and injured arrive

THE ARRIVAL of the Indian Airlines relief plane at Bombay with 96 passengers and six bodies ended the tragic hijack drama of the Pan Am jumbo at Karachi airport. Bedlam prevailed at the arrival terminal after the Airbus A300 landed. Anxious relatives inquired in vain about passengers who did not figure among those in the plane and whose names were not mentioned in the official list.

PM stands his ground

PRIME MINISTER Rajiv Gandhi said that Pakis-

tan President Gen Ziaul Haq had himself told him in Harare that the Pan Am hijackers spoke in Urdu and Arabic. Gandhi stood by his statement that Pakistan had "badly bungled" in handling the rescue operation of the passengers and crew of the hijacked jetliner.

Reagan's response to Pan Am

THE US administration has said it has not linked the hijacking of Pan Am flight 073 in Karachi "with any specific group or government", but ordered a navy battle group to the central Mediterranean in case President Ronald Reagan should decide to retaliate.

The aircraft carrier USS *John F Kennedy*, which has been in the Spanish port of Benidorm, is expected to sail eastward with escorting warships.

NAM appeals to US, USSR

IN WHAT is being hailed as the most important outcome, leaders of the Non-Aligned Movement have decided at their summit in Harare on a package of measures to help frontline African states in their struggle against apartheid and established a fund under the chairmanship of PM Rajiv Gandhi to undertake suitable projects.

● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Israel's top court must protect police investigators from politicians.
— *Haaretz, Israel*

●

Draft SIR list shows anomalies, absurdities. Independent audit is needed



DESHKAAL
BY RAHUL SHASTRI
AND YOGENDRA YADAV

IT VARIED from an indulgent smile to a wry smirk. We remember the reactions both of us received to our initial estimates of the cumulative damage of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls, if it was carried out across the country. The SIR had led to a deletion of 65 lakh names from the voters' list in Bihar. We calculated that a nationwide SIR could lead to a deletion of up to 10 crore names. No one believed us. We hoped that raising the alarm would act as a check and bring the eventual numbers down, as it did in Bihar. Now that we have nearly the final figures, the total deletions have surpassed our worst fears.

Last week, the Election Commission of India completed the release of the draft SIR voters' list in all the major states. The draft rolls are yet to be released for Nagaland and Tripura. And the SIR is yet to start in Himachal Pradesh and J&K. Yet, the overall trends are now clear (see accompanying table). The actual number of deletions at the draft stage stood at 13 crore 37 lakh. The final impact will be a little lower, as the publication of the draft SIR list is usually followed by more additions than deletions. Taking the likely additions and the remaining states into account, we estimate that eventually the SIR will lead to over 11.5 crore deletions in India's voters' list.

Here is the big picture. At the time of the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, India's electorate was about 98 crore, almost the same as the adult voting-age population of 99 crore at that point. By the time the SIR is formally concluded, the total count of the electorate will drop to around 88 crore against the projected adult population of 103 crore.

This huge discrepancy between the projected census figure of the adult population and the ECI's figure of the electorate leaves only two possibilities. Either the population is massively overestimated: It is under 125 crore rather than over 145 crore as in the official projections. Or we have nearly 15 crore-voting age Indians missing from the voters' list. Either way, we are looking at a scandal.

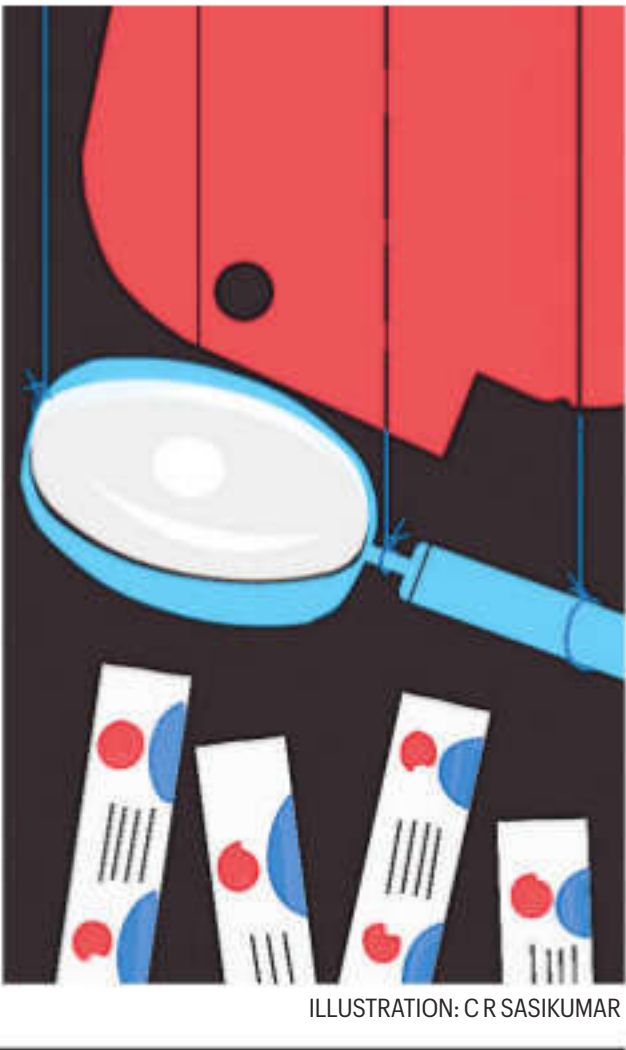
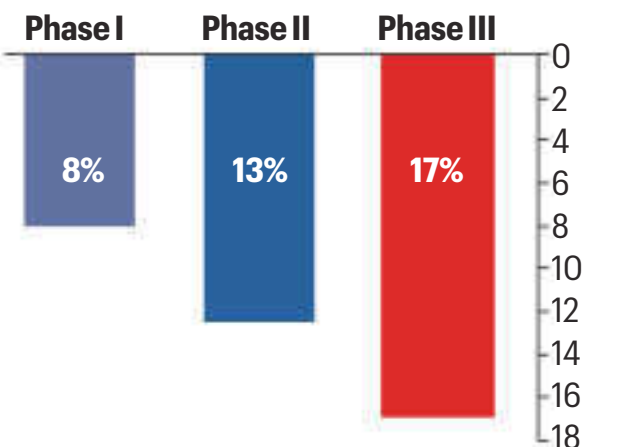
• 3 phases of disenfranchisement

	Adult Popt Pre SIR (Cr.)	Voters Pre SIR (Cr.)	Voters After Draft SIR (Cr.)	Draft SIR Roll Deletions
Overall 3 Phases	95.2	94	80.7	13.3 Cr.
Phase I				
Bihar	8.2	7.9	7.3	65.1 L
Phase II				
Chhattisgarh	2.1	2.1	1.9	27.4 L
Gujarat	5.3	5.1	4.4	73.7 L
Kerala	2.8	2.8	2.5	24.1 L
Madhya Pradesh	6	5.7	5.3	42.7 L
Rajasthan	5.6	5.5	5.1	41.9 L
Tamil Nadu	6	6.4	5.4	97.4 L
Uttar Pradesh	16.1	15.4	12.6	2.9 Cr
West Bengal	7.7	7.7	7.1	58.2 L
Overall Phase II	51.6	50.7	44.2	6.5 Cr.
PHASE III				
Andhra Pradesh	4.1	4.2	3.7	44.9 L
Haryana	2.3	2.1	1.7	33.9 L
Jharkhand	2.8	2.7	2.2	43.6 L
Karnataka	5.2	5.5	4.5	108 L
Maharashtra	9.9	9.8	7.7	2.1 Cr
NCT of Delhi	1.7	1.5	1	47.6 L
Odisha	3.3	3.3	3.1	20.1 L
Punjab	2.4	2.2	1.9	20.7 L
Telangana	2.9	3.4	2.7	73.4 L
Uttarakhand	0.9	0.8	0.7	8.3 L
Overall Phase III	35.5	35.3	29.3	6.1 Cr.

(NOTE: Sources: SIR figures from Election Commission. Population Projections from GoI's Report Of The Technical Group On Population Projections, July 2020. Sikkim, Arunachal, Mizoram, Manipur, Meghalaya, UTs not included as Population Projections not available. Current Total Deletions including these are 13.37 Cr. for Draft Roll. Draft Phase not complete in Tripura and Nagaland)

This is not to assume that all the deletions are wrongful. The existing voters' list carried accumulated errors and spurious names. So, a majority of the deletions may be correct. Yet, even if one-third are wrongful, we are looking at an unacceptable level of voters' list manipulation. Add to this a large-scale under-enfranchisement that the SIR has done nothing to rectify. These are crores of eligible voters who did not feature on the pre-SIR list, those who did but whose names were removed before the SIR, and those young voters whose names should have been added during the SIR but were not. These could explain the difference between the adult population and the electorate.

• Rise in SIR deletions: E/P ratio phase-wise fall



Instead of improving, the extent and the nature of voter deletions has taken a negative turn with each SIR phase. The accompanying chart shows this trend. The first pilot phase was limited to Bihar. A deletion of 65 lakh names — a fall of less than 8 per cent in the elector-population ratio — was enough to cause nationwide outrage. Judicial oversight and bureaucratic cover-up reduced the final deletions to 45 lakh. Everyone's guard was already down by the second phase of 13 states. Bihar elections had taken place. The SIR was here to stay. So a drop of nearly 13 per cent did not raise eyebrows. The national attention, if any, was focused on the brazen and targeted deletion of Muslims in West

Bengal. The third phase, nearing completion, comprises the rest of the country, barring Himachal and J&K. Held after the Supreme Court's *carte blanche* to the ECI, this phase was marked by impunity. The deletions in the draft SIR have shot up over 17 per cent. No one seems to blink an eye.

This phase has witnessed abnormally high deletions in Haryana, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana and, of course, Delhi. Across the three phases, the proportion of voters marked "dead" has stayed constant at around 3 per cent of the total deletions. Most of the deletions are on account of the voter being "absent" or "shifted" — categories that remain undefined so far and have been used arbitrarily by the local electoral officials. Besides those deleted from the draft rolls, another one-fifth are likely to face further scrutiny on account of being "unmapped" or due to "logical discrepancy" (LD). The unusually high proportion of LD in Odisha, Jharkhand and Telangana suggests that there is more to it than just a computer algorithm. Nor is there a standard operating procedure for how such discrepancies are to be treated. Clearly, "logical discrepancy" is not a method. It is arbitrariness by design.

The third phase has also opened a new malpractice: Many states have witnessed abnormal large-scale deletions just before the SIR officially began. This is crucial, because those deleted before the SIR do not even receive an enumeration form. Their deletion stays below the radar and does not count as SIR deletion. Between May 12 when the SIR schedule was announced for the third phase and the day the SIR officially began, there were over 14 lakh such suspicious deletions, of which over 8 lakh took place in Maharashtra. If we look at the entire period since the assembly elections held in February last year, Delhi has witnessed an inexplicable decline of more than 11 lakh voters before the launch of the SIR. So, Delhi's voter list has shrunk from 1.56 crore last year to just 98 lakh after the release of the SIR draft list.

We are not dealing with data anomaly or even absurdity. We are looking at an attempt to remodel the foundations of electoral democracy. Therefore, we need nothing short of a full public audit of the entire SIR operation — design, execution and aftermath. We need an agency independent of the ECI to carry this out. We need it sooner than later. The nation wants to know.

Shastri is a researcher associated with Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. Yadav is member, Swaraj India, and national convenor, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan

Dear Rahul Gandhi, let's smash patriarchy everywhere

JAVED ANAND, FEROZE MITHIBOREWALA, ZAKIA SOMAN, NOORJEHAN SAFIA NIAZ, SHAMSUDDIN TAMBOLI AND BADER SAYEED

WE WRITE to congratulate you on your unprecedented and inspiring address to the gathering of Gen Z women in Pune. Your unequivocal call to smash the patriarchy and dismantle systemic male dominance struck a deep, resonant chord across the country. In calling out *Manusmriti* for reducing women to lifelong dependence — whether as daughters, sisters, wives, or mothers — you articulated a truth that millions of young women have long fought to speak: True freedom cannot coexist in a male-dominated conservative society with institutionalised inequality.

As Muslim reformist voices and progressive thinkers, we urge you to look closely at the struggles being waged by brave Muslim women in their quest for respect, dignity, and equal citizenship under the Constitution of India. Justice and fairness are intrinsic to the spirit of the Quran as well. Patriarchy is an all-encompassing force that respects no border, no caste, and no creed. While the battle against orthodox male dominance continues within Hindu and other communities, an equally relentless struggle is being waged by women and youth within the Indian Muslim community. This critical reality must be recognised by the nation.

Undoubtedly, Indian Muslims are currently facing a deep sense of insecurity due to the rising tide of the politics of fear, hatred, and division. Yet, even as we combat these forces to protect and defend minorities, the issue of gender-just reforms can no longer wait for the "right time" to speak out. For decades, conservative bodies — such as the All India Muslim Personal Law Board (AIMPLB) and other male-dominated organisations — have positioned themselves as the sole custodians of Muslim identity. Time and again, their leadership has opposed fundamental, gender-just reforms, deploying regressive arguments to justify control over women's lives. For these conservative organisations, allegiance to the Constitution begins and ends at Articles 25 and 26, selectively highlighting minority rights and religious freedoms while ignoring the foundational guarantees of equality and human dignity for women.

We anchor our vision of India in Articles 14 through 21 — the constitutional promises of equality before the law, non-discrimination, human dignity, and personal liberty. Young Indian Muslims, especially young women, refuse to be left out in the cold while the rest of the nation marches forward against patriarchal control. Furthermore, the entrenched orthodox forces within the Muslim community provide constant ammunition to Hindutva narratives, which seek to demonise the entire community as inherently backward, anti-reform, and anti-women. This dynamic deepens the isolation of Indian Muslims and accelerates the communalisation of Indian society. The emergence of a vibrant, secular, and progressive Indian Muslim voice is vital for nation-building and for strengthening the democratic fabric of India. Patriarchy within the Muslim community remains a massive roadblock to essential social progress.

In recent decades, grassroots movements, activists and intellectual forums including the Bharatiya Muslim Mahila Andolan (BMMMA), Indian Muslims for Secular Democracy (IMSD) and the Muslim Satyashodhak Mandal — have tirelessly campaigned for systemic change, demanding legal protection against polygamy; absolute end to discriminatory practices like nikah halala and muta marriage; upholding and strengthening protections against instant triple talaq, safeguarding a hard-won victory for women's dignity; equal inheritance rights to guarantee economic independence for all women members in the family; strict adherence to 18 as the uniform legal age of marriage for women and ending child marriage hidden behind supposed personal law exceptions; an absolute ban on female genital mutilation (FGM) to safeguard bodily integrity; unhindered access to sacred spaces, ensuring women can enter and pray in masjids as equal believers; and fair and progressive legal frameworks governing divorce, maintenance and child custody.

All-pervasive and well-entrenched social malignancy is not only "out there" but even within seemingly progressive institutions and organisations. Reforming society requires standing up to patriarchal forces everywhere. Young Muslim women and men are eager to break free from clergy-driven control and contribute to a modern, secular, and egalitarian India. Muslim women must get parity in law with all other women. We appeal to you to use your national platform to engage directly with young Indian Muslims and amplify the reformist voices fighting for gender justice. It is time to recognise the quest for justice and equality rising from within the Muslims and shun the conservative viewpoints. If we are to dismantle patriarchy in India, we must smash it everywhere it exists. We invite you to stand with us in this shared movement for equal rights, shared citizenship, and genuine social reform.

In solidarity and faith in the Constitution.

Anand and Mithiborewala are with Indian Muslims for Secular Democracy; Soman and Niaz are with Bharatiya Muslim Mahila Andolan; Tamboli is with Muslim Satyashodhak Mandal and Sayeed is with Roshni, Chennai

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Steinem's ideas

THE STRUGGLE for equality concerns everyday assumptions within families, workplaces and institutions ('Gloria Steinem taught us that hardest battles are fought inside', *IE*, September 7). Progress requires men and women to examine inherited biases without turning disagreement into a moral contest. Schools should teach consent, dignity and shared responsibility, while employers must enforce fair policies.

M Barathi, Bengaluru

Cooperation on safety

WATER DISPUTES between India and China cannot be managed through suspicion alone ('Two countries and a shared river: Mistrust is not inevitable', *IE*, September 7). Both countries should exchange hydrological data, establish emergency communication channels and permit scientific monitoring of major projects. Downstream communities deserve timely information about flood risks and ecological damage. Even when a comprehensive agreement remains difficult, co-operation on safety and transparency can prevent accidents and reduce misinformation.

K Sakunthala, Coimbatore

Push for restraint

INDIA'S DIPLOMATIC choices require a balance between strategic autonomy and moral consistency ('Moscow-Kyiv to Delhi, connect the dots', *IE*, September 7). Maintaining communication with Russia is understandable, but silence on civilian suffering weakens our credibility. New Delhi should press every partner for restraint, humanitarian access and an early ceasefire, while keeping Parliament and the public informed about its decisions. A principled, transparent policy would protect India's interests without making foreign policy appear indifferent.

S M Jeeva, Chennai



ANAND KRISHNAN

PANDEMICS ARE cruel and the worst time to learn. Lessons are best learnt in the inter-pandemic period, like the current influenza surge. Different parts of India have reported 2-10 times more cases this year than last year. While headlines scream about the reported cases, experts and government officials keep offering reassurances that the influenza strain hasn't changed. Government advisories also ask the public to remain vigilant, but not get alarmed. I do not understand what this means.

The three pillars of managing any outbreak are surveillance, prevention and control. Surveillance means the ability to detect the outbreak early and initiate appropriate action. In the case of influenza, this also includes genomic surveillance to identify the strain/variant responsible for the uptick to gauge its virulence and the population's susceptibility. A well-established virus should not be a serious concern. Even then, preventing an infection entails issuing advisories, especially to high-risk individuals to avoid crowded places and promote the use of masks. This could also include vaccination of high-risk individuals and health workers. Control means ensuring those with an infection receive proper medical care.

The current response appears to be too cautious and bureaucratic. Such situations demand professional communication strategies and experts

What flu surge can teach us about next pandemic

Post-Covid, India has an excellent viral disease surveillance system. A rise in influenza positivity beyond a defined threshold should trigger an alert. Our study among selected hospitals found that the positivity rate among those admitted with severe acute respiratory infection was 16 per cent this year compared to 12 per cent last year. To the best of my knowledge, we do not have alert thresholds. It would be useful to have a publicly available dashboard for this purpose.

The surveillance-to-action link is poor. It falls between the ICMR (it runs laboratory surveillance), NCDC (coordinates the response) and the state health systems (implement the response). The way forward is to establish an integrated command structure with clear authority to coordinate and implement an effective response during disease upsurges and pandemics. We failed to learn this lesson from Covid.

Given the current scale of the surge, the priority should be to prevent avoidable deaths. The government advisory should urge such people to avoid crowded places and wear masks. Governments often fear that such advisories can cause panic. There is a thin line between an appropriate response and one that causes panic. Gov-

ernments across the world struggle to walk that line. They — and the WHO — are sometimes accused of overreacting. However, if our primary concern is to save lives, overreaction is a better response than underreaction. The current response appears to be too cautious and bureaucratic. Such situations demand professional communication strategies and experts.

Influenza vaccine use, even among high-risk groups, is very low for reasons including poorly perceived threat, non-affordability, doubtful effectiveness and the need for annual injections. While one can debate the need for immunisation in regular times, by not considering immunising high-risk groups during a major seasonal surge, we run the risk of being unprepared for the next pandemic. The low use of antivirals, even in peak influenza season, also needs probing — a relook at influenza management guidelines is needed. The private sector and professional bodies need to be on board. Outbreaks, epidemics of different magnitude and pandemics are a part of a continuum. They need a calibrated response. Mini-pandemic situations are an opportunity to refine our response and communication strategies.

The writer is a professor of community medicine at AIIMS, Delhi. Views are personal

China's robot beat Bolt's record. Now the real test

will tell you, as they solemnly file this as "a frontier of US-China rivalry."

To be fair, there was a race: A 100-m sprint where a robot first beat Usain Bolt's record, didn't stop at the finish line, crashed into a padded wall at full speed and needed to be carried off by handlers. And in the boxing ring, most robots heroically landed a swing several inches off their target. One machine raised its leg to kick and fell over first. The conference also featured robots dancing, performing tai chi, playing table tennis, tug of war, floor gymnastics, and all three soccer formats. All this while a deluge of state support and subsidies lure several players into the sector, artificially raising competition as they chip away at each other's market shares.

Unitree Robotics, a company that rose to global fame last year when its robots danced to traditional Chinese folk music at the Spring Festival Gala, timed its stock-market debut immaculately. As the company's robots did more coordinated backflips, its shares rose nearly sixfold on the opening day. Indeed, technical capabilities in the sector are getting better. Only a few years ago, most

But this is the bet the Chinese government is making: As China's population ages and shrinks, such a physical manifestation of AI will add productivity

robots didn't finish a 100-m sprint, and many that did needed a human chaperone, battery swaps and some remote assistance. Evidently the hardware is improving, but the positive returns from large-scale commercial deployment are still some time off.

Robots are not yet nimble or intelligent enough to pull off even the most basic human tasks reliably. Last year, a robot took 17 minutes to pick up nine pieces of trash, a task that any human could easily have done in one-fourth the time, for instance. Training data for almost all tasks is still insufficient. But this is the bet China is making: As its population ages and shrinks, such a physical manifestation of AI will add productivity and contribute to economic growth.

The field of robotics is advancing fast; China is working to indigenise the supply chain but struggles at the intelligence layer, and the prafalls are exactly what you would expect from any hardware industry moving quickly: Expensive and embarrassing. Still, it will attract more talent into the sector, creating a flywheel effect that advances China's capabilities. This will look less like a breakthrough and more like incremental progress on metrics that are useful but also boring, and not amenable to visual entertainment. But until then, for technology enthusiasts, more entertainment is on its way.

Reddy is a researcher at Takshashila Institution, Bengaluru. Views are personal

ISRO: EOS-05 to be placed in elliptical geosynchronous orbit

Johnson T A
Bengaluru, September 7

The EOS-05 Earth observation satellite launched by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) last week will be placed in a slightly elliptical geosynchronous orbit instead of the circular geostationary orbit, scientists said as the satellite went through predetermined manoeuvres to raise its current orbit.

EOS-05 is India's first Earth observation satellite to be put in a geosynchronous orbit, where it will remain stationary relative to the Earth. The satellite in these orbits moves in sync with the Earth's rotation, which enables it to maintain an uninterrupted watch over a particular location on the Earth.

The geostationary orbit is one special subset of geosynchronous orbits in which the satellite not just moves in sync with the Earth's rotation, it moves directly above the Equator. It is a circular orbit. Geosynchronous orbits can be slightly tilted relative to the Equator, and can be circular or elliptical.

While a circular geostationary orbit, at an altitude of 35,786 km, is considered optimum for Earth observation, the EOS-05 will operate in the broader geosynchronous orbit when it becomes operational over the next few days, ISRO sources indicated.

"Each orbit is selected for different purposes. Here we have chosen GSO (geosynchronous orbit)," said an ISRO scientist associated with the satellite programme.



ISRO launched GSVL-F17/EOS-05 mission from Sriharikota last week. ANI VIDEO GRAB

A permanent position for an 'Eye in the Sky' satellite is useful for weather monitoring since it allows continuous observation of a specific area for weather patterns. One of the users of the EOS-05 is expected to be the Indian Navy for strategic data.

The EOS-05 had a near-perfect launch by the GSVL in its heaviest mission so far. After the launch, it was placed in an elliptical orbit around the Earth, from which it is supposed to progressively carry out orbit-raising manoeuvres to reach its intended destination in space. Two such manoeuvres were done on Sunday and Monday. More manoeuvres are planned in the next few days, the space agency said.

'Tariff war is lose-lose situation... you just make it more costly for consumer'

IN NOVEMBER 2020, the then Prime Minister of Luxembourg, **Xavier Bettel**, held the first virtual summit with Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the Covid-19 pandemic. Now, as Deputy PM and Foreign Minister, Bettel, who is on a three-day official visit to India, held talks with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Monday.

In an interview with **Shubhajit Roy**, Bettel, who was the PM of Luxembourg between 2013 and 2023, talks about bilateralities in fintech, AI, tariff wars, immigration and the Russia-Ukraine war. Edited excerpts:

Six years after the virtual summit with PM Modi, how has the relationship evolved?

In six years, Covid is gone; it was difficult. I had a Luxembourgish company which was doing cooling of vaccines at that time. They wanted to open a factory in India, and it was very difficult. Then on the call, PM Modi told me 'I will do this', and the next day it was fixed. I love Indian efficiency. It's because usually when you have administrative questions, it takes weeks. But here, it was done in 24 hours.

Since then, we have done a lot in logistics, also in finance. We have also strengthened ties in education, we have hundreds of Indian students in Luxembourg's universities.

What are the areas of cooperation agreed upon during your conversation with EAM Jaishankar?

AI, logistics, finance, satellites, space. We have a big Indian community in Luxembourg, we

love them. I love Indian food, I love India, and we have successful companies in Luxembourg because of the Indian knowledge.

How does the India-EU Free Trade Agreement impact bilateral economic relationship between Luxembourg and India?

Now it's the framework. We need to put elements in the framework. So that's the reason why I think it is important, since now we have this FTA, to see how we can have new opportunities. Indian companies do not know what are the opportunities in India now. We need to bring them together. I see some... Indian companies which need European licences and see the opportunities to come to Luxembourg. There will be Luxembourgish companies which don't yet know everything they can do in India, and so I need some time show them the opportunities.

After President Donald Trump assumed office, there has been a tendency to be protectionist; there are tariff wars going on right now. How do you view these tariff wars?

I think tariff wars, at the end of the day, are a lose-lose situation. There is no winner because someone needs to pay the tariff, and so you just make it more expensive for the consumer, and especially you know when you see this escalation — you do 50, we do 50, you do 60,



we do 60. At the end of the day, it's in fact the middle class consumer who pays the price. Rich people don't care if it costs 2, 3, or 10% more... It's the middle class and less fortunate people who pay the price of commercial wars; we destroy jobs, we destroy economies. So it's a lose-lose situation... It's a pity that for some it is for protectionism that they think tariffs are the new rules.

You have come here just ahead of the BRICS Summit, which Russian President Vladimir Putin will also attend. What should the Indian government tell him about the war in Ukraine?

That we won't rewrite history. So there is one aggressor that is Russia, that it's a fact... I had a lot of contacts with President Putin and President (Vladimir) Zelenskyy at the beginning of the war. I'm happy that your Prime Minister and your Foreign Minister went to Moscow and to Kyiv because mostly people visit one, not both, and we need someone to talk to them. But at the end of the day,

when we will have to count how many people died, how many were destroyed, it's a shame. And if I would still have contact with President Putin, I would tell him why... He will have to justify to orphans in 15 years why their father died, and he will have to explain to mothers in two years why their son died for nothing. I hope someone will be able to tell him that it is easier to start the war, than to finish the war. That's leadership.

Do you think India's purchase of Russian energy has funded the Russian war machinery?

I don't know the figures now. If it's important, not important. The fact is, we should avoid financing the defence industry and letting money come in. But then you need alternatives. If you have alternatives, I would prefer the alternatives than the Russian ones, to be very honest, as long as this war is on.

But the fact is, with Russia we had history, we had common interests, we shared the continent, we had common goals, and I'm so sad that everything has been destroyed this last year. Especially for me, my grandmother is Russian, and I feel that even today, when I meet Russian people during holidays, they don't know if they should say they are Russians or not, and that makes me sad, because everybody needs to be proud about their roots and history.

An anti-immigration mood has emerged in the US and in some parts of Europe as well. We just saw AfD win the elections in a state in

Sena leader who 'assaulted doctors' in Thane drops plea in SC

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 7

SHIV SENA corporator Ramesh Sukrya Mhatre, facing prosecution for allegedly assaulting doctors and staff at the Shastri Nagar hospital in Kalyan, Thane, withdrew his Supreme Court appeal in the matter on Monday as the court made it clear that those involved in such incidents "do not deserve to roam on the streets even for a minute".

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta said this while allowing the corporator to withdraw his appeal challenging several of the bail conditions imposed by the Bombay High Court and also issuing a notice on a plea by the Maharashtra government seeking cancellation of the bail granted to him and three others.

During the hearing, the bench pointed out that there was yet another incident of a group of people attacking hospital staff — an apparent reference to the alleged assault on the staff of a Palghar hospital over the treatment of a man injured during a Dahi Handi celebration. Police have booked 17 Shiv Sena workers in connection with the incident.

"A message needs to go... not only to these people but to everyone and as a deterrent... These people do not deserve to be out at all... Such people do not deserve to roam freely on the streets even for a minute," the bench said.

72nd NATIONAL FILM AWARDS

Statue of Unity gets ready for red carpet moment on Sept 22

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, September 7

FOR THE first time in more than seven decades, India's National Film Awards ceremony will step out of Delhi, with the 72nd edition set to be held against the imposing backdrop of Gujarat's Statue of Unity (SoU) on September 22.

President Droupadi Murmu will present the awards to 92 winners.

Preparations for the high-profile ceremony are underway at Ekta Nagar in Gujarat's Narmada district, where authorities are planning a specially constructed venue to accommodate the President, award winners and nearly 1,000 guests.

A release issued by the Narmada district administration on Monday stated that a German aluminium structural dome will be erected in the Bus Bay area of the Statue of Unity complex for the ceremony. The district administration and the Gujarat government are coordinating preparations for what will be one of the most prominent national events organised at the Statue of Unity precinct.

The choice of Ekta Nagar marks a significant departure for the National Film Awards, which have for decades been presented in Delhi. The move also brings one of India's most important cultural ceremonies to a destination that has increasingly been positioned as a

venue for major national and international events.

The September 22 event will honour winners of the 72nd National Film Awards, recognising achievements in Indian cinema for films released in 2024. The winners were announced by the Union Ministry of Information and Broadcasting in July. *Article 370* won the Best Feature Film award, while Yami Gautam was named Best Actress in a Leading Role for her performance in the film. Mammooty and Kartik Aaryan shared the Best Actor in a Leading Role award for *Bramayugam* and *Chandu Champion*, respectively.

Among other major honours, *Bhangaar* was named Best Non-Feature Film and *Ram-Nami* won the award for Best Documentary. Randeep Hooda received the Best Debut Director award for *Swatantrya Veer Savarkar*, while several commercially successful films, including *Kalki 2898 AD*, *Adaman*, *Pushpa: The Rule Part-02* and *Street 2*, were also among those recognised across categories.

For Gujarat, however, the ceremony carries significance beyond the awards themselves. Hosting the event gives the SoU a new cultural role. Officials say the ceremony will "pave the way for bigger events in the future as suggested by PM Modi during his visit to Vadodara a few months ago."

22 teachers hold classes for 663 children across relief camps

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 7

At 8 am on Monday, 10-year-old Ayan put on his school uniform, picked up his bag and walked into his classroom at the Government Primary School in Varanasi's Saraiya.

For the past four days, the school building has also been Ayan's home. He, his parents and his six siblings are among 10 families who moved into the school after floods in the district drove them from their house.

That morning, he joined 11 other children for a lesson taught by principal Bhaiya Lal Singh and two other teachers. "There's excitement every day getting ready for class — we play games and study too. I love staying here," Ayan said.

Inside the classroom, desks and benches have given way to white sheets spread across the floor, where barefoot children sit cross-legged in front of Principal Singh who occupied a red plastic chair.

Mothers in dupattas sit near the windows. Stainless steel cooking pots and food provisions are stacked in open wall alcoves, while personal belongings line the walls beneath



Mohammad Sayeed teaches children aged six to ten. EXPRESS

faded educational charts.

"The school is home to 10 flood-displaced families, said Principal Singh said. "Classes are running at the scheduled time."

The school is one of 22 relief camps running across Varanasi since August 29, where the administration has made arrangements for children to continue studying. Together, the camps are sheltering 2,675 people, including 663 children, with the Basic Education Department deploying a teacher to each camp.

Another teacher, Shiksha Mitra Aftab Alam, has been travelling about a kilometre from the Government Primary School in Saraiya, where he is posted, to teach eight children at a madrasa turned relief camp.

The children, aged between seven and 10, attend class from 8 am to 2 pm. "These children aren't from the school where

I'm posted. Many fled to the shelter without their books or copies, so we're arranging those for them as well," said Alam, 40, who has been working as a Shiksha Mitra since 2007.

At a camp housing families from flood-hit Nakhi Ghat, Mohammad Sayeed, 51, has been teaching 11 children aged six to 10 for the past two days.

"I'm enjoying how this teacher teaches us — it's different from how we're taught in school. I'd like to stay a few more days at the camp because the facilities here are good," said 12-year-old Aisha.

Sayeed, a primary school teacher from Chohara who is posted at City Girls Inter College in Alipur, said the children are all from different schools.

The Ganga was flowing at 70.12 metres at 4 pm on Sunday, below its warning level of 70.26 metres, according to the Cen-

tral Water Commission.

Around 11 localities in the district have been partially affected by the flooding, officials said, with families displaced by the swollen Varuna river being moved to safer locations as needed.

Among those sheltering at the relief camps are 23 pregnant women and 107 elderly persons. A doctor has been stationed round the clock at each camp, while police personnel, including women officers, have been deployed for security.

"Different government departments have been assigned specific responsibilities at the relief camps. We are taking all possible steps to ensure that people staying there have access to proper facilities," said Additional District Magistrate, Varanasi, Dr Sadanand Gupta.

The Revenue Department is overseeing food supply and general upkeep at the camps, while the Municipal Corporation is responsible for fogging and cleanliness.

Each camp has a community kitchen serving breakfast, lunch and dinner, with milk and fruits additionally provided for children, according to an official.

Camp capacities range from 50 to 350 people. Pregnant women are given separate rooms, while no more than two families are housed in a room.

Police are patrolling the affected areas to guard the belongings residents left behind.

SC suspends life sentence of Naga insurgent in 2009 Manipur triple murder

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 7

THE SUPREME COURT Monday suspended the life sentence of a self-styled lieutenant colonel in the National Socialist Council of Nagaland (Isak-Muivah) or NSCN-IM, convicted in the 2009 abduction and killing of three government officials in Manipur.

Noting that Hopeson Ningshen has spent more than 17 years in custody and that his appeal against conviction is awaiting final hearing, the bench of Justices M M Sundaresh and P B Varale suspended his sentence.

The bench directed that Ningshen must remain in Delhi and not leave the city until his appeal is decided.

Ningshen was convicted for the abduction and murder of Dr Thingnam Kishan Singh, Kasom Khullen Sub-Divisional Officer (SDO), Y Token Singh, and A Rajen Sarma.

A special Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) court sentenced him to life imprisonment in 2014, along with a separate finding of theft for looting the victims' belongings, and imposed a fine of Rs. 35,000.

According to CBI, the bodies of the deceased were recovered from the banks of the Tuphau Kuki River.

The Delhi High Court upheld that sentence in 2019, saying that "having regard to the nature of the offence and the manner in which it was executed, we concur [with the lower court findings]... we are of the view that the appellant needs no leniency and deserves a stricter punishment."

The killings had raised communal tensions. Amid the possibility of an attack on the accused during the proceedings, the case was transferred from Manipur to Delhi in 2010.

Malaysia Airlines flight diverted to Chennai after technical issue

Press Trust of India
Chennai, September 7

A MALAYSIA Airlines flight from Kuala Lumpur to Jeddah was diverted to Chennai on Monday following an engine-related technical issue, prompting a full emergency declaration, an official said.

Malaysia Airlines MH 156 with 186 persons on board landed safely, and appropriate emergency response arrangements were activated at the airport here, he said.

"There was a technical issue involving Engine No. 2. The airline and relevant technical teams are carrying out further assessment of the aircraft and the issue," a spokesperson said, adding that operations are normal.

The aircraft was towed to the parking bay, and passengers were provided temporary accommodation at the airport before being shifted to a nearby hotel. The flight is expected to resume its journey once engineers address the technical fault, sources said.

Separately, an Air India Express flight from Tiruchirappalli to Singapore was diverted to Chennai International Airport due to a technical issue.

●AN MBA GRADUATE FROM KOLLAM IN KERALAM, 64-YEAR-OLD SAM ANTONY WAS ARRESTED ON SEPTEMBER 1 BY THE MANGALURU CITY POLICE IN A 2019 CASE

Conman kept police in pursuit for three decades — changing identities and locations

Kiran Parashar
Bengaluru, September 7

FOR NEARLY three decades, he conned people across states as Sam Peter, Rahul Peter, Rajesh Robinson, Anthony Francis and Daniel Tharakan. At least the police know about only these five identities until now.

Sometimes he was an NIA official, other times, a Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) man — carrying fake passports, Aadhaar and PAN cards to match the identities he assumed.

The accused had managed to stay ahead of the police by moving from one state to another and changing identities along the way. However, on September 1, Sam Antony, 64, was arrested by the Mangaluru City Police from Kerala's Kannur in a 2019

case when he was living as Daniel Tharakan.

"He is fluent in English and his authority over the law is remarkable. He can make someone believe that he is some elite businessman or an officer of a central agency in 10 minutes," says Inspector Anantha Padmanabha, who questioned him after his arrest this time.

An MBA graduate from Kollam, Antony is married and has two children. However, he doesn't stay with them, say police.

According to police, Antony's 'method' was simple — approach businessmen entangled in financial disputes involving Central agencies, and offer help in exchange for a 'fee'.

Many fell for the ruse; some did not even complain. "Wherever there was a dispute...

Antony *haazir tha* (Antony was present)," says a cop.

Police cite the case of a businessman, Abdul Sharif, whose brother was being questioned by the DRI in connection with the seizure of gold in 2018. "Antony somehow found out about this. He approached Sharif, claiming he was a senior NCIB officer, and offered a deal — he would get the case closed against his brother in exchange for a bribe," the officer says. Over the next 10 months, the officer says, Antony allegedly extorted Rs 1.13 crore in instalments from Sharif.

By the time Sharif grew wise to the con, it was too late. Sharif filed a complaint and an FIR was registered in August 2019, at Karnataka's Konaje police station.

When police began tracing his records, they found the trail



The accused, Sam Antony

as far back as 1997. "The first was a cheating case registered at Khairagarh in Chhattisgarh," another police officer reveals. In 1998, his first case in Karnataka was registered at Kushalnagar Town police station.

But police believe that this case may not have been the beginning of his activities in the

state. "There could have been other cases that never made it into the records," the officer says.

The last time police had caught him was on August 16, 2019, when police officer Maruthi S V received information that a 'senior NCIB officer' was staying at a lodge in Mangaluru "for an important investigation". Maruthi sensed something amiss and went to the lodge, where he found Antony — who was posing as Sam Peter then. Police arrested Antony and his seven associates and recovered firearms, fake ID cards, cash, two vehicles, mobile phones, etc. from them. Antony was booked for impersonation, criminal conspiracy, Arms Act charges, and misuse of the State Emblem.

The police eventually realised that they had caught a serial

offenders. There was even an Interpol Red Corner notice against him issued in 2007, they learnt.

"He would commit crimes in one place and start afresh in another state. After committing crimes in Chhattisgarh, he came to Karnataka, then went to Bihar, and then to Chennai, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh and so on," a police officer says.

He also took care not to leave a digital or financial trail. He never bought a SIM card in his name and also never used his bank accounts for monetary transactions. In 2023, police say, Antony secured bail and the police struggled to locate him for the next three years.

Three months ago, Mangaluru City police came across Antony's file and formed three special teams. "We did not have

any clue about his whereabouts. We only knew that he is from Kerala and has spent most of his time in Chennai," a police officer recalls. "Thus, we started searching for him in both these states. We started by establishing contact with his associates," he says.

Then the police found something they did not expect. Antony had allegedly cosied up to a Keralam politician and was attending events as a chief guest. "He recently attended a media event as a chief guest in Keralam. We got photos of this event. That's how we finally nabbed him," the officer says.

Inspector Rafeek K M says the accused was carrying fake documents and living under a different name when arrested. "He was now Daniel Tharakan, a retired senior officer from the

NCIB," he says.

The Mangaluru City Police has now compiled a list of 17 cases in which Antony is possibly involved. "We have written to police across the country to ascertain if there are cases pending against him," says Mangaluru City Police Commissioner Sudheer Kumar Reddy.

But even after Antony's arrest, his deceptive tactics didn't stop. A senior police officer in Karnataka began receiving calls from Keralam, insisting that the person arrested was an "upright man, wrongly picked up".

"I got a call from a lawyer, a businessman and another influential person... They said Daniel (Antony) was an upright person," the officer says. "I had to share his history to convince them," he says.

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• GLOBAL

AfD’s rise: How Germany’s far right party went mainstream

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, September 7

THE FAR-RIGHT Alternative for Germany (AfD) came within three seats of a majority in Saxony-Anhalt on Sunday, winning 43.8% of the vote and 39 of 83 seats — its strongest-ever state election performance.

The result was a blow to Chancellor Friedrich Merz’s Christian Democratic Union (CDU), which had governed the state since 2002. Whether the AfD can form a government remains unclear, as other key parties have refused to work with it.

Who are the AfD?

The party was founded in 2013 as a Eurosceptic party (critical of the European Union). It opposed Germany’s handling of the eurozone financial crisis and later shifted sharply to the right amid the 2015 refugee influx. It rode anti-immigrant sentiment to enter the Bundestag or German legislature in 2017.

The party has found particularly fertile ground in the former communist east, where economic development has lagged behind western Germany and voters have expressed frustration with mainstream parties.

Gurjit Singh, who served as India’s Ambassador to Germany, said the reasons for AfD support had broadened beyond immigration.

“The basic life of a German is no longer as good as it used to be,” Singh told *The Indian Express*, pointing to frustrations over public infrastructure and the strain on the welfare system. He said social anxiety and poor economic performance were now important drivers of AfD support. In September 2024, the AfD became the first

far-right party since World War II to win a state election.

So why is this significant?

The Saxony-Anhalt result more than doubled the AfD’s vote share from 20.8% in 2021. Nationally, it is already the largest Opposition party in the Bundestag.

The result also reinforces a broader pattern in eastern Germany. Eastern voters have tended to switch political allegiances more frequently, creating space for newer parties, and have been more sceptical of sanctions on Russia and military support for Ukraine.

Can the AfD govern?

Given Germany’s Nazi past, mainstream parties have maintained a “firewall” — a commitment not to cooperate with far-right parties such as the AfD.

This has kept the AfD out of government even after electoral victories. But the firewall came under strain in January 2025, when Merz relied on AfD support to pass a non-binding parliamentary motion calling for tougher immigration rules.

Saxony-Anhalt now presents a difficult political equation. The AfD has 39 seats, while the CDU has 15, the Social Democrats, Greens and Left have eight each, and the Sahara Wagenknecht Alliance has five. With major parties ruling out cooperation, forming a stable government could prove difficult.

Singh said AfD’s growth could eventually force other parties to reconsider the firewall. “If AfD is going to keep getting popular, other parties need to learn to work with it rather than ignore it,” he said.

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• CULTURE

Fading alphabet to fresh paint: Dogri scripts a comeback on Jammu signboards

Arun Sharma
Jammu, September 7

LAST WEEK, several new public signboards came up in Jammu carrying area names in a third script, alongside the usual Devanagari for Hindi and Roman for English.

This was “Namey Dogra Akhar” — the script of the Dogri language, primarily spoken in Jammu. Dogri has long been written in Devanagari, with its own script falling into disuse. Now, civic authorities in Jammu are attempting to revive it by putting up signboards at prominent locations and institutions.

Dogri’s history

Dogri is an Indo-Aryan language, a major branch of the Indo-European language family that includes Hindi, Bengali and Punjabi, and belongs to the Western Pahari group, a cluster of related languages found mainly in the western Himalayas.

Dogri is primarily spoken by the Dogras,

who have historically inhabited Jammu and Kashmir’s Jammu division, besides smaller groups in Punjab and Himachal Pradesh, and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir.

According to the 2011 Census, Dogri was the primary language of nearly 2.6 million Indians. It was recognised as one of the 22 scheduled languages under the Eighth Schedule in 2003 and declared one of the official languages of the Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir in 2020.

Namey Dogra Akhar as new script

Namey Dogra Akhar is a modified version of Takri, the original Dogri language script used until the reign of Maharaja Gulab Singh. He was the first Dogra ruler of Jammu and Kashmir. As he devoted his energies to expanding his empire up to Tibet, he found little time to promote and develop Takri.

Gulab Singh’s son, Ranbir Singh, who ascended the throne in 1856, was a scholar of Sanskrit and Persian. Known for his cor-



A signboard featuring the new script in Jammu. ARUN SHARMA

dial relations with the British, he introduced several reforms, including compiling the civil and criminal laws into the famous Ranbir Penal Code.

During his rule, it was felt that transcription of official orders and documents in Takri script was not possible owing to the absence of vowel signs. To rectify this, he

asked writers to borrow the vowels from Devanagari.

This led to the emergence of the Namey Dogra Akhar — literally, new Dogri script — in administrative work, apart from Persian, which was already in use, said Archana Kesar, former dean of Research Studies and of the Arts Faculty of Jammu University. Kesar has also headed the university’s postgraduate departments of Dogri and Punjabi.

Decline in official use

After the death of Maharaja Ranbir Singh in 1885, his son Pratap Singh came to power. He would take a fateful decision that heralded the decline of the script. To simplify administrative work, he replaced Persian with Urdu as the official language as it was widely used among the local population. The Dogri script continued to be used by many locals for several years.

Maharaja Pratap Singh died issueless, and his nephew Hari Singh became the next ruler in 1926. Hari Singh, too, intro-

duced reforms, such as creating a written constitution for the state, making primary education compulsory and opening up places of worship to marginalised castes.

Amid these reforms, the British pushed for English in official work, while people in the Dogra heartland wanted Hindi to be used. Hari Singh sought to balance these demands by promoting the Devanagari and Roman scripts alongside the Perso-Arabic script for Urdu.

Revival of language, not script

In 1944, the Dogri Sanstha, a literary organisation, adopted the Devanagari script to popularise Dogri literature. While this helped Dogri gain recognition from the Sahitya Akademi in 1969, it also contributed to the eventual decline of Namey Dogra Akhar.

Subsequent years saw efforts to popularise the language, but not the script.

In 1971, the University of Jammu established a Dogri Research Cell, which later got upgraded into a full-fledged department.

An ICMR study of 159,336 patients has found that antibiotic-resistant bacteria infections are more likely to be fatal and more expensive to treat

• HEALTH

Antibiotic-resistant infections: Risks, costs



RINKU GHOSH

A MAJOR study of hospitalised patients across India has found that infections caused by antibiotic-resistant bacteria are more likely to be fatal and more expensive to treat than infections caused by drug-susceptible strains (infections where antibiotics still work). This becomes concerning as they are no longer affected by carbapenems, the powerful, broad-spectrum antibiotics that doctors often keep in reserve for serious infections, especially when other antibiotics may not work.

These bacteria survive and reproduce despite the use of antibiotics meant to kill them. Not only that, they pass resistance genes to their offspring and sometimes to other bacteria through exchange of DNA. They cause infections in different parts of the body, including the lungs, urinary tract, wounds and bloodstream.

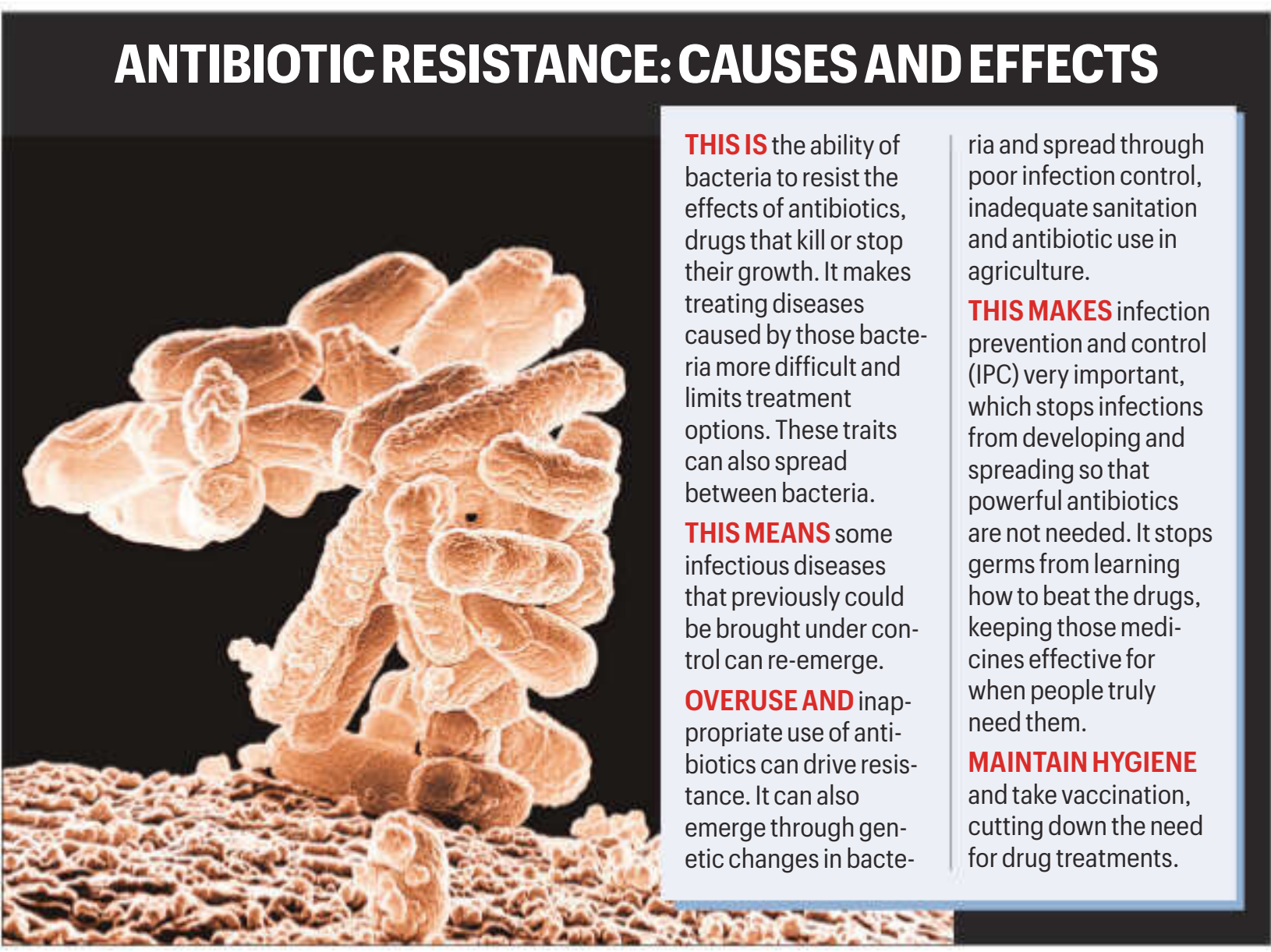
The latest study was conducted by the Indian Council of Medical Research’s antimicrobial resistance (AMR) surveillance network across 20 tertiary-care hospitals between April 2022 and April 2025, using data from 159,336 hospitalised patients.

“Carbapenem resistance should be regarded as a major threat to patient survival, particularly in severe and blood infections. Our study showed that resistant infections are linked to higher deaths, longer hospital stays and greater antibiotic costs across different hospitals in India,” Dr Kamini Walia, co-author of study and senior scientist at the Division of Epidemiology and Communicable Diseases, Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), New Delhi, told *The Indian Express*.

The major bacteria

Researchers looked at four major bacteria: *Escherichia coli* (causes urinary tract infections), *Klebsiella pneumoniae* (triggers both urinary and lung infections), *Acinetobacter baumannii* (ventilator-associated pneumonia; bloodstream infections; wound/surgical-site infections; urinary tract infections; sometimes meningitis) and *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* (bloodstream, eye and ear infections).

Almost 61.1% patients had these infections that were resistant to carba-



penem antibiotics.

More likely to be fatal

The difference in mortality was seen across all four bacteria. Among patients with *E. coli* infections, 24.4% of those with carbapenem-resistant infections died, compared with 17.3% among those with drug susceptible infections.

For *K. pneumoniae*, mortality was 31.2% in the resistant group versus 23.5% in the susceptible group. The gap was 37.9% versus 32.8% for *A. baumannii*, and 28.9% versus 20.2% for *P. aeruginosa*. In relative terms, patients with carbapenem-resistant *E. coli* had a 41% higher risk of death than those with susceptible *E. coli*. The corresponding increase was 33% for *K. pneumoniae*, 16% for *A. baumannii* and 43% for *P. aeruginosa*.

Among bloodstream infections, mortality among patients with carbapenem-resistant bacteria ranged from 39.3% for *E. coli* to 50.8% for *A. baumannii*. For *K. pneumoniae*, mortality was 44.8%, while it was 46.4% for *P. aeruginosa*.

“More than 85% of bloodstream infections across the four bacteria were classified as healthcare-associated, highlighting the importance of infection prevention and

Expensive to treat

Carbapenems are powerful, broad-spectrum antibiotics that doctors often keep in reserve for serious infections, especially when other antibiotics may not work.

The study found that antibiotic treatment was more expensive when the bacteria were resistant to carbapenems.

control in hospitals,” said Dr Walia.

Resistant infections also cost more

The study found that antibiotic treatment was more expensive when the bacteria were resistant to carbapenems. For *E. coli*, the average antibiotic cost was approximately Rs 39,846 per patient for resistant infections, compared with Rs 20,034 for susceptible infections. For *K. pneumoniae*, the corresponding figures were Rs 55,688 and Rs 47,918, respectively. For *A. baumannii*, treatment costs were approximately Rs 62,150 for resistant infections compared with Rs 41,372 for susceptible infections, while treatment for *P. aeruginosa* cost approximately Rs 66,599 for resistant infections compared with Rs 48,392 for susceptible infections.

“The figures in this study are conservative. We deliberately looked only at the cost of antibiotics available under the Jan Aushadhi scheme. We did not include ICU costs, bed and room charges, diagnostic investigations, procedures, supportive care or consultation costs. The real economic burden on patients, families and the healthcare system is therefore likely to be substantially greater,” said Dr Walia.

Concerns

These were tertiary-care hospitals managing referred and often critically ill patients. At the same time, the magnitude of resistance in this hospital population is a warning. “The study points particularly towards the importance of healthcare-associated transmission, invasive devices, recent surgery and gaps in infection prevention and timely diagnosis. We should not reduce this to a single problem of antibiotic overuse,” said Dr Walia.

Alongside better infection-control practices, she said hospitals need timely diagnostics so that doctors can identify resistant bacteria and select appropriate, targeted antibiotics rather than relying unnecessarily on broad-spectrum drugs. “Carbapenems are important antibiotics used to treat serious bacterial infections. When bacteria become resistant to them, doctors have fewer effective treatment options,” she said.

The study did not have patient-level information on several factors that can strongly influence outcomes, including how sick the patient was, how quickly appropriate treatment was started, the source of infection and the specific resistance mechanism. “Therefore, these results are better understood as reflecting real-world treatment patterns in India rather than proving that one drug is universally superior to another,” said Dr Walia.

Right cure, wrong problem?

“We need to recognise that antibiotics cannot compensate for failures in infection prevention. Hospitals need to put infection prevention and control at the centre of their antimicrobial resistance response—hand hygiene, device-associated infection prevention, appropriate insertion and early removal of invasive devices, environmental cleaning, surgical infection prevention and surveillance of healthcare-associated infections,” she added.

She called for an integrated surveillance that connects laboratory results with patient outcomes, mortality and treatment. “Our study demonstrates the value of having this patient-level information. Infection prevention must receive as much attention as antibiotic prescribing, particularly because such a large proportion of these infections are healthcare-associated. AMR cannot be solved by discovering another antibiotic every time an old one fails. We have to prevent infections, diagnose them early and preserve the antibiotics we still have,” said Dr Walia.

A status quo

Some have alleged that the ongoing stay conveniently suits the ruling faction of the SAD(B), which currently controls the SGPC, because it lets the 2011-elected House continue indefinitely.

Lakhvir Singh, who describes himself as an “independent Sikh activist”, has approached the Punjab and Haryana HC demanding fresh SGPC elections or at least hold byelections on some 34 seats that lie vacant. According to his advocate, the Act contains provisions to fill these vacancies using the existing (2011-era) electoral rolls — without touching, delaying, or needing to wait for resolution of the Baldev Singh case.

Baldev Singh Mianpur, an existing SGPC member and Shiromani Akali Dal (Badal), or SAD(B), leader, told *The Indian Express* that his plea is that Sikh voters in Haryana should not be denied a vote or the right to contest merely because of the newer state-level body carved out in 2014. He denied allegations that the plea was meant to delay SGPC elections.

Counting five years from 2016, that Board’s ordinary term ended in 2021. Because Section 51 allows an existing House to continue “until constitution of a new Board”, the House has continued to function well past that, since no fresh general election has since been held or completed.

When the issue of a timeline for SGPC elections came up in Lok Sabha in August 2025, the government replied that although it had already appointed a Chief Commissioner to begin preparing fresh electoral rolls, “several cases filed in the Punjab and Haryana High Court challenging the preparation of these rolls have resulted in a stay”. At the heart of the stay is the matter of *Baldev Singh and Anr. v. Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee and Anr.*, which has restrained the Gurdwara Election Commission from finalising the fresh electoral rolls until the case is decided.

IN SIX MONTHS OF WEST ASIA WAR

US share in India's LPG imports surged to over 50% from under 10%

Sukalp Sharma

New Delhi, September 7

THE STIFLED supply of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) from West Asia due to the regional conflict there has led to a surge in US's share in India's LPG imports to over 50% in the six months since the conflict began, up from less than 10% in the preceding six months, as per an analysis of LPG shipping data of the past 12 months.

The West Asia war, which started with the US and Israel striking Iran late February, has upended India's LPG import pie, which was traditionally dominated by Gulf suppliers like the UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, and Saudi Arabia. Amid the supply crunch, India's overall LPG imports fell over 40% sequentially in the March-August period, while imports from the US nearly quadrupled as India scrambled to find alternative supply sources not constrained by geopolitical conflict.

The West Asia war led to an effective halt in vessel movements through the critical chokepoint of the Strait of Hormuz, which accounted for a fifth of global oil and liquefied

natural gas (LNG) flows. The strait is a narrow waterway that connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea, and is the primary route to evacuate energy supplies from the broader Gulf region. The disruption in energy supplies through the strait has caused a headache for various energy importing countries, including India. While the country's crude oil and LNG supplies have also been impacted, LPG supplies have been hit the most.

Around 40% of India's crude oil imports, 60% of its LNG imports, and a whopping 90% of its LPG imports regularly came from West Asia through the Strait of Hormuz. The country's dependence on energy stands at over 88% for oil, 60% for LPG, and about 50% for natural gas. This means that the Strait of Hormuz effectively saw the movement of around 54% of India's LPG consumption.

An analysis of tanker data from commodity market analytics firm Kpler shows that India's overall LPG imports in the six months to August declined 43.1% from the previous six

• Top sources of LPG for India

Supplier	MARCH-AUGUST LPG IMPORTS		SEPTEMBER-FEBRUARY LPG IMPORTS	
	Volume (mn tn)	Share (%)	Volume (mn tn)	Share (%)
US	3.78	53	0.99	7.9
UAE	0.96	13.4	4.74	37.8
Saudi Arabia	0.42	5.9	1.77	14.1
Qatar	0.41	5.7	2.65	21.1
Kuwait	0.35	4.9	1.89	15.1

SOURCE: KPLER

months (September-February) to 7.14 million tonnes. Supplies from the US surged 281.1% to 3.78 million tonnes, accounting for 53% of India's LPG imports for March-August. In September-February, Washington supplied about 993,000 tonnes of LPG, making up 7.9% of New Delhi's LPG imports.

Share of the UAE, which was the biggest source of LPG for India before the war, contracted to 13.4% in the six months to August from 37.8% in September-February. Import volumes crashed 79.8% to about 958,000 tonnes. Similarly, import volumes from Qatar plummeted

by 84.7% to about 405,000 tonnes in March-August; its share in India's LPG import pie shrunk to 5.7% from 21.1% in the previous six months.

Kuwait, which had a 15.1% share in India's LPG imports in September-February, saw it contract to 4.9% in March-August as volumes were down 81.7% to about 346,300 tonnes. LPG import volumes from Saudi Arabia in the six months to August were down 76.1% sequentially to about 423,700 tonnes. In September-February, Riyadh had a share of 14.1% in New Delhi's LPG import basket, which shrunk to a mere 5.9% in

the following six months.

"This growth (in LPG imports from the US) is particularly due to the constrained supply from the Middle East. US is a major LPG supplier globally and became a readily available option for India. This LPG is accessible in this constrained supply environment. This is similar to Russian (oil) barrels flocking to India (amid the West Asia supply disruption)," said Nikhil Dubey, lead analyst-refining at Kpler.

According to experts, American LPG flows to India are expected to remain strong till the time West Asian supply normalises, on which there is no clarity at present.

"Washington has been the biggest LPG exporter worldwide even before the crisis, and US propane was already cheaper than Asian supplies before the war. Once the shortage hit, and with no other option nearby, India was willing to pay more to bring it from further away because keeping cooking gas available was the priority," said Abu Dhabi-based energy analyst Natalia Katona.

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Why SEBI is reassessing derivatives settlement in the wake of CAS debut

Akash Mandal

Mumbai, September 7

AFTER THE swiftly implemented Closing Auction Session (CAS) thinned volumes and faced industry pushback, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) last week finally announced that it may propose changes to the settlement method for the derivatives segment. "Among the issues raised, a significant area of feedback relates to the determination of settlement prices of derivative contracts on expiry based on the closing price determined through CAS," the markets regulator noted in its press release on Thursday.

Consequently, the regulator "may be proposing certain changes in the methodology for determination of settlement prices of derivative contracts for which a consultation paper will be issued in about a week," it added.

Root cause of the issue

Currently, trading in the CAS ends at 3:30 PM, while trading in the derivatives segment extends for 10 more minutes. This mismatch in the end times of the sessions is among the biggest causes of concern for the trading industry.

Institutional investors — which include corporates, foreign investors, mutual funds, and proprietary traders with complex algorithms — together account for around 60-65% of the turnover in the derivatives market.

Derivatives are financial instruments that allow traders to buy or sell an underlying security at a predetermined date and price in the future. These institutional investors, who have a wide range of bets spread across the market, use derivatives to either hedge their bets or look for arbitrage opportunities. In

• TIMING TENSIONS

CURRENTLY, TRADING in the CAS ends at 3:30 PM, while trading in the derivatives segment extends for 10 more minutes

THIS MISMATCH in the end times of the sessions is among the biggest causes of concern for the trading industry

fact, hedging is essential for such traders due to the vast amounts of money they handle on a daily basis.

For example, if a trader owns a significant amount of a stock in the cash market, which is the regular trading session from 9:15 AM to 3:30 PM, then the trader will often sell the stock in the derivatives market to hedge their risks and protect capital, irrespective of whichever way the price moves. The vice-versa can also be true when the trader first sells a stock in the derivatives market and then buys it in the cash market.

Earlier, when the cash and derivatives markets ended at the same time, traders had price visibility and minimal uncertainty while planning such hedges. However, with the advent of CAS and the extended derivatives session, traders cannot safely predict what may happen in the derivatives market once the CAS ends.

Other issues such as time pressure during the CAS and limited price visibility have also compounded this problem, leading most institutional traders to sit out of both the CAS and derivatives segments to avoid the risk.

This risk is even higher on days when the derivatives contracts of the Nifty 50 and Sensex expire — a time when every trader is desperately trying to maximise their profits or

minimise their losses ahead of the payday.

As the big players sit out of the CAS, the thin volumes lead to high volatility, with a handful of big orders capable of significantly swaying prices. This volatility in the CAS, in turn, leads to volatility in derivatives, which are linked to CAS-determined prices of underlying securities. Thus, the bigger players are avoiding both for now.

The data also shows the same. The National Stock Exchange's (NSE) total turnover in the derivatives segment for August was Rs 34.48 lakh crore — lowest since November 2023.

"Average daily options turnover (of NSE) also fell by 20% month-on-month in August. Therefore, the 18-20% decline should be viewed as the overall market-volume impact observed after CAS was introduced, rather than a measure of the volume decline specifically within the CAS window," said Shweta Rajani, head of mutual funds at Anand Rathil Wealth.

Will aligning F&O and CAS help?

Market participants thus want the derivatives and CAS session ends to be aligned, and the settlement prices of derivative contracts to be de-linked from the settlement prices in the CAS, particularly on expiry days. If the regulator does so, it will not solve the caution and the lukewarm response to the CAS overnight. However, what it might do is cut down a significant part of the uncertainty in traders' minds.

Institutional traders do not like to trade without proper hedges, and an aligned closure of both sessions and de-linking of CAS and derivatives prices may provide a vital hedging avenue for such traders, pumping much-needed liquidity into the CAS.

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Gold loans, durables drive NBFC retail credit growth to 21.4% in Jul

George Mathew

Mumbai, September 7

RETAIL CREDIT extended by non-banking financial companies (NBFCs), including housing finance companies (HFCs), rose sharply in July 2026, with loans against gold jewellery and financing for consumer durables emerging as the fastest-growing segments, according to data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

Outstanding retail loans of NBFCs rose 21.4% year-on-year to Rs 26.06 lakh crore in July 2026, from Rs 21.46 lakh crore a year earlier. This was significantly faster than the 13.7% growth recorded in July 2025 over July 2024.

Within retail credit, loans against gold jewellery recorded the steepest expansion. Outstanding gold loans surged 68.5% year-on-year to Rs 3.54 lakh crore in July 2026, compared with Rs 2.10 lakh crore in

July 2025. The segment had already grown 43.9% in July 2025 over the year-earlier period, RBI data shows.

According to the data, consumer durable loans also registered a strong increase, rising 51.5% to Rs 74,644 crore in July 2026 from Rs 49,283 crore a year earlier. This followed an 18.8% year-on-year rise in July 2025.

The sharp growth in these two categories comes against a broader acceleration in NBFC lending. Total outstanding credit of NBFCs, including HFCs, stood at Rs 59.89 lakh crore in July 2026, up 14.9% from Rs 52.10 lakh crore in July 2025. In comparison, total NBFC credit had expanded 10.6% in July 2025 over July 2024.

The data shows that retail loans now account for a substantial portion of NBFC credit. Housing loans grew 11.9% year-on-year to Rs 8.55 lakh crore in July 2026, while vehicle loans increased 15.1% to Rs 6.29 lakh

crore. Both segments, however, expanded at a much slower pace than gold loans and consumer durable financing.

The acceleration in gold loans also comes amid a period of elevated gold prices, which have increased the value of jewellery available as collateral and enabled borrowers to raise larger amounts against existing assets. Gold-backed lending can also provide quick access to funds, particularly for borrowers with limited access to conventional unsecured credit.

Meanwhile, consumer durable financing points to stronger demand for credit-linked purchases of household and personal goods. The 51.5% annual increase in outstanding credit in this category far outpaced overall retail loan growth. India's economy grew 7.8% year-on-year in Q1 FY27, supported by resilient consumer demand.

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Safety top priority for Air India, says incoming CEO



Air India Chairman N Chandrasekaran (centre), incoming CEO Tewolde Gebremariam (right) and outgoing CEO Campbell Wilson during an Air India town hall on Monday. X/AIRINDIA_NEWS

Sukalp Sharma

New Delhi, September 7

INCOMING AIR India chief executive Tewolde Gebremariam and Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran on Monday identified safety as a key priority for the airline going forward, with Gebremariam seeking support of the airline staff to "make Air India great again", borrowing from US President Donald Trump's 'MAGA' or 'Make America Great Again' slogan. The comments were made at an Air India townhall meeting addressed by Gebremariam, Chandrasekaran, and outgoing CEO and MD Campbell Wilson.

"I am coming from the US so allow me to borrow a phrase, MAGA. We will Make Air India Great Again...A safety-first culture has to be our number one priority. It is not enough to say it. We must live it every day," Gebremariam said, calling on all Air India employees to actively contribute to a stronger safety culture. A former group CEO of Ethiopian Airlines, Gebremariam will assume the role of the airline's CEO and MD after his security clearance from the government comes

through, which is expected in a few weeks.

"If something is not right, stop. Every employee should feel empowered to raise concerns, and I will support that culture," Gebremariam said in his first address to the airline's staff. "I need your support and co-operation. We cannot bring about meaningful change without the commitment of our people...Together, we can build a safer, stronger and truly world-class Air India," he added.

Gebremariam oversaw one of aviation's most successful long-term transformations, turning Ethiopian Airlines into a global airline and the largest carrier in Africa, and turned Addis Ababa into a major aviation hub. He also has a track record of driving sustained profitability while navigating complex economic cycles and dynamic and challenging global markets.

He is taking over the reins at Air India at a crucial juncture for the airline — in the aftermath of the deadly AI 171 crash in June last year and intensified scrutiny of the carrier's operational safety.

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

FM Sitharaman meets IMF Dy MD Nigel Clarke

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and International Monetary Fund (IMF) Deputy Managing Director Nigel Clarke on Monday met and discussed the outlook for India and the global economy, including India's evolving growth trajectory and the implications of ongoing shifts in the global economic environment. "Both sides emphasised the importance of continued India-IMF engagement in strengthening macroeconomic cooperation, supporting sound policies and contributing to greater regional and global economic resilience," the Finance Ministry said in a post on 'X'. They also discussed India's trade agenda and developments.

Clarke acknowledged India's economic performance, resilience and growth track record in the current global scenario, as well as the Government of India's efforts towards fiscal consolidation and support measures, it said. FE

• BRIEFLY

CII Business Confidence Index surges to 66.0 in Q2FY27

New Delhi: The CII Business Confidence Index (BCI) surged to 66.0 in Q2FY27 from 60.8 in Q1FY27, as Indian industry remained optimistic amid signs that disruptions from the West Asia crisis are gradually easing. "The optimism shown by businesses, as reflected in the BCI, is a clear testament to the inherent resilience of the Indian economy even as geopolitical uncertainty continues," said Chandrajit Banerjee, Director General, CII. The share of firms expecting demand growth above 20% rose from 12.9% in Q1FY27 to 16% in Q2FY27, signalling stronger optimism. ENS

UK's Jaguar Land Rover to cut 4,000 jobs

London: British luxury car-maker Jaguar Land Rover said on Monday it would cut around 4,000 jobs globally over the next two years as part of a broader plan to reduce costs and improve competitiveness. The manufacturer said it was targeting 1.7 billion pounds (\$2.30 billion) of savings, lowering its break-even point towards 300,000 vehicles. JLR employs about 30,000 in the UK out of a global workforce of about 40,000. REUTERS

• MARKETS

 Sensex 76,132.81 -382.62 -0.50%	 NIFTY 23,779.15 -118.55 -0.50%	 Gold ▼ ₹1,52,703	 US Dollar ■ ₹94.49
 Silver ▼ ₹2,31,650	 Oil ▲ \$101.07		

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 4, 2026

• TAIWAN HAS SIGNALLED A WILLINGNESS TO SHARE THE BENEFITS WITH LIKE-MINDED PARTNERS

Taiwan flexes chip diplomacy muscles

Reuters

Taipei, September 7

TAIWAN FLEXED its chip diplomacy muscles at a major trade show last week, portraying itself as a democratic and reliable supplier for the AI revolution, while signalling a willingness to share the benefits of its semiconductor prowess with like-minded partners.

Home to companies like TSMC whose chips power AI applications, diplomatically isolated Taiwan has long sought to leverage its tech prowess to garner international support, something Beijing routinely seeks to block saying the island is merely one of its provinces. But Taiwan also faces pressure from the US, its most important international backer and arms supplier, to shift more chip manufac-

turing there. That comes as TSMC is investing \$265 billion in factories in the state of Arizona.

President Lai Ching-te, who, unusually, spoke at two separate events on the same day at the SEMICON Taiwan trade show, said Taiwanese companies were expanding globally to "let resilience create shared prosperity", and that the island's chip strength was based on democracy and rule of law.

Economy Minister Kung Ming-hsin, opening the US pavilion at the show, said Taiwanese companies were planning an additional \$20 billion of investment in the country.

Taiwan struck a deal with Washington earlier this year to increase investment in the US in exchange for reduced export tariffs, but uncertainty remains.

US Commerce Secretary Ho-



Taiwanese firms acknowledge the need to expand chipmaking overseas. REUTERS

ward Lutnick told CNBC last week that semiconductor tariffs were coming for companies that do not make chips in the US.

Still, Bill Frauenhofer, the Commerce Department official overseeing the tariff agreement

with Taiwan, struck an upbeat tone during SEMICON.

"The phenomenal partnership" between Taiwan and the US was working, he said. "And we really, both of us, have vested interests in terms of making this successful."

Taiwanese firms acknowledge the need to expand manufacturing beyond the island.

Young Liu, chairman of Foxconn, Nvidia's largest AI server maker, said companies now had to "think about how to make with Taiwan, not in Taiwan; make with Taiwan in the country where the market is".

Responding to Liu during the panel discussion, Tien Wu, chief operating officer of ASE, the world's largest chip packaging and testing provider, said he agreed. "Politically it is the right thing," Wu said.

VJTI MUMBAI
वीजमता विज्ञानाई तकनीक संस्था
Veeramata Jijabai Technological Institute
(Autonomous Institute of Govt. of Maharashtra)
H. R. Keshavnagar Road, Matunga (East), Mumbai - 400 019
Phone: +91 22 24198101/102 - Fax: +91 22 24102874, www.vjti.ac.in

Notice Inviting Tender
E-tenders are invited for the work of "Providing and maintaining temporary barricading along the boundary of M P A Complex (2nd Call)" having an estimated cost of Rs. 20.17,004/- from eligible contractors having experience of this type of work.
The blank tender forms are available on the Maha Tender website: <https://mahatenders.gov.in>
The interested tenders are requested to download the entire tender document from the MahaTenders website. Last date of submission of E-Tender document duly filled in shall be 19th September 2026 upto 5.00 p.m.
The right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof will be with the competent authority of VJTI.

Registrar, VJTI

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	02261951A	Set of Emergency Lighting Unit	1358 Set	28.09.2026
02	19260708	Aluminium Impeller for Oil cooling Blower	295 Nos	05.10.2026
03	06261139A	M.S.Flat Size 50X6MM X Standard	1577250 KG	06.10.2026
04	12260863	ISI Marked, Size 2 X 10 SQ MM	121000 MTR	07.10.2026
05	07261324A	8" X 3-3/4" Brake Cylinder 'JSL' with Handbrake	699 Nos	20.10.2026
06	07261079	Rubber Spring Plate For Outer End	8953 Nos	04.11.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice No. 40/2026-2027 Dated: 07.09.2026 3069/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), Email- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Domana, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mohd Jamil S/O Abdul Ramzan R/O Kogh Mandli Billawar Kathua is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 209/2004 U/S 420/201 RPC, of P/S Domana, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Mohd Jamil
S/O : Abdul Ramzan
Address : Kogh Mandli Billawar Kathua

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP Rural : 0191-2605949
5. SDPO Domana : 0191-2604220
6. P/S Domana : 0191-2604214
No. Date:- .08.2026
DIP/J-9706/26 – DATE 07 SEP 2026

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), Email- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mamnzoor Ahmed S/O Mohd Sabar Caste Muslim R/O Punjieuu Bhaderwah District Doda is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 267/2000 U/S 381 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/ efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Mamnzoor Ahmed
S/O : Mohd Sabar
Caste : Muslim
Address : Punjieuu Bhaderwah District Doda
Age : 50-55 years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East : 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133
No. Date:- .08.2026
DIP/J-9681/26 – DATE 07 SEP 2026

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), Email- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Sanjay Kumar S/O Harbans Lal R/O Merihama Ahmedpass Dhumka Jharkhand is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 116/2007 U/S 363/376 RPC of P/S Nagrota, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Sanjay Kumar
S/O : Harbans Lal
Address : Merihama Ahmedpass Dhumka Jharkhand
Age : 49 years
Height : 5' 7"
Complexion : Wheatish
Eyes : Brown

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP Rural Jammu : 0191-2605949
5. SDPO Nagrota : 0191-2673666
6. SHO P/S Nagrota : 0191-2673025
No. Date:- .08.2026
DIP/J-9654/26 – DATE 07 SEP 2026

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

महा मेट्रो
MAHARASHTRA METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.
(A joint venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Maharashtra)
PUNE METRO RAIL PROJECT
Metro Bhavan, Premises of District Court Interchange Metro Station, Nyaymurti Ranade Path, Shivajinagar, Pune - 411005. | Tel.: 020-26051074
e-mail: tenders.pmrp@mahametro.org | Website: www.punemetrorail.org

Tender Notice No.: P1-O&M-24/2026 Date: 07/09/2026

Name of Work: Annual Civil Maintenance of 28 Nos of Elevated & Underground Stations, 12.15 kms of Tunnel and 2 Depots of Pune Metro Project for a period of One Year.

Interested bidders may visit the e-Tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra i.e. <https://mahatenders.gov.in> OR PMRP website www.punemetrorail.org to view this tender notice (NIT) and can download the Tender documents and obtain further details regarding the Tender from e-tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from 16.00 hrs. 15.09.2026 to 16.00 Hrs. On 28.09.2026.

Additional General Manager (Procurement & Contracts)
Pune Metro Rail Project,
Maharashtra Metro Rail Corporation Ltd.

Pune Metro : City's Transport Solution

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Vinod Chauhan S/o Deepchand Chauhan R/o H. No. K-310, Swami Dayanand Colony Near, PS Sarai Rohilla Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR 233/2020 U/s 188 IPC/33/38 Delhi Excise Act/52 D.M. Act 2025 PS Mundka, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vinod Chauhan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vinod Chauhan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vinod Chauhan** accused of **FIR 233/2020 U/s 188 IPC/33/38 Delhi Excise Act/52 D.M. Act 2025 PS Mundka, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Gaurav Singal
JMFC-06, Room No. 355
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Md. Shamsad S/o Md. Gannaur R/o F-108 JJ Colony Bawana Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 168/2022 U/s 33 Delhi Ex. Act PS Bawana Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Md. Shamsad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Md. Shamsad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Md. Shamsad** accused of **FIR No. 168/2022 U/s 33 Delhi Ex. Act PS Bawana Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
JMFC-05, Room No. 114
Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2)(ii)Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Atulya Kumar S/o Sidhnath Tiwari, R/o: D-52, MCD Flat, 1st Floor New Usmanpur, Delhi** (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 263/2018, U/s: 174A IPC**, registered at P.S.: Jagatpuri, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Atulya Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Atulya Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Atulya Kumar** accused **FIR No. 263/2018, U/s: 174A IPC**, registered at P.S.: Jagatpuri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava, LD.
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,
Room No. 07, Second Floor,
Shahdara Distt., Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12631/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, KARNAL	WORK OF 6 NOS ROADS (1 WDG. AND STG. WITH WBM PLUS NEW CCB ON SHERGARH TAPU TO YAMUNA BANDH (885) IN KM 0-0.60 (3 STG. WITH 50M WBM PLUS 20MM PC ON ABOLAPUR ROAD (725) KM 0-0.92 (3 STG. WITH WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC, NEW CCB DANIALPUR ROAD (723) KM 1-0.197/4 STG WITH WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC UMARPUR ROAD (7204) KM 0-1.100 (5 STG. WITH WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON BADHERI ROAD (7310) KM 0.00 TO 0.550 (6 WDG. AND STG. WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON KALKI-KALKI JAGRIR (12280) KM 0-1.22 IN INDRI CNSTY. IN KNL DIST. (WP 2026-27) + 1 WORKS	04.09.2026 17.09.2026	657.28 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eeepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF DISTRICT HEADQUARTER OFFICE FOR THE EXCISE AND TAXATION DEPARTMENT (JIND) (PROVIDING LIFTS ONLY) + 3 WORKS	02.09.2026 09.09.2026	135.12 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwcdeedrohtak1@gmail.com
3	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	RENOVATION OF MAIN BLOCK, EXTENSION BLOCK, ANCILLARY BLOCK AND BEAUTIFICATION OF EXTERNAL AREA OF HARYANA BHAWAN, NEW DELHI.	CLOSING DATE 17.09.2026	817.14 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeepd1-gurgaon@gmail.com
4	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	CONSTRUCTION OF RAIN WATER HARVESTING SYSTEM IN THE CAMPUS OF MINI SECTT. AT GURUGRAM	CLOSING DATE 10.09.2026	19.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeepd1-gurgaon@gmail.com
5	PANCHAYATI RAJ, BHIWANI	CONSTRUCTION OF BLOCK OFFICE BUILDING AT TOSHAM DISTT. BHIWANI	31.08.2026 10.09.2026	494.96 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664243927 prexeeng.bhw@bhyr.nic.in
6	PANCHAYATI RAJ, SONIPAT	CONSTRUCTION OF BOEP RASTA FROM F/O KRISHAN S/O TARACHAND TO F/O MAHENDER S/O BHOOP NAMBARDAR IN VILLAGE SARAGTHAL (HGYI) + 4 WORKS	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	125.50 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416391006 prexeeng.snp@gmail.com
7	FOREST DEPARTMENT, SIRSA	DEVELOPMENT OF LANDSCAPING WORK ON BOTH SIDE OF 4 LANNING ROAD OF BHUMAN SHAH CHOWK TO PANCHAYAT BHAWAN IN CITY PORTION	CLOSING DATE 14.09.2026	32.83 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416067122 forest_srsa@yahoo.com
8	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, JIND	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE GATAULI, JALAIWANTI AND NANDGARH BLOCK JULANA, JIND.	02.09.2026 15.09.2026	800.63 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813066477 ascojind@gmail.com
9	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME FOR WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - SHAHPUR, ARYA NAGER AND HINDWAN BLOCK - HISAR - II, DISTT. - HISAR	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	352.41 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
10	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME FOR WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - KHARAR / ALIPUR BLOCK - HISAR - I, DISTT. - HISAR	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	318.31 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
11	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME FOR WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - GANGWA (HISAR-I) DEWAN, AND TOKAS BLOCK - HISAR - II, DISTT. HISAR	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	323.06 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
12	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - SHIKARPUR / RAIPUR, BLOCK - HISAR - I, DIST - HISAR	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	132.06 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
13	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME FOR RECLAMATION OF SALINE AND WATERLOGGED AREAS THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - BHATLA, BLOCK - HANSI-II DISTT. - HANSI	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	207.54 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
14	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME OF WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE - DAROLI, BLOCK - ADAMPUR DISTT. HISAR	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	278.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
15	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, HISAR	LAND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME FOR WATER LOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT AT VILLAGE MEHANDA, BLOCK - HANSI - I, DISTT. HANSI	03.09.2026 14.09.2026	280.18 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813562162 ascohisar@gmail.com
16	CIVIL HOSPITAL, PANCHKULA	OUTSOURCING OF PEST AND RODENT SERVICES	08.09.2026 19.09.2026	EMD 50000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2562199 ghgpk@gmail.com
17	HORTICULTURE DEPARTMENT C.E.V. GHARAUNDA, KARNAL	SHORT TERM E-TENDER OF REPAIRING STRUCTURE AT CEV GHARAUNDA (KARNAL)	04.09.2026 17.09.2026	EMD 12000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9729303303 sdh.cev@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 49007/HRY

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, AYEZA FAISAL S/O MOHD. FAISAL, RZ-160, PLOT No. 48/1, SAYED NANGLOI, PASCHIM VIHAR, DELHI-110087, I have changed my name from AYEZA FAISAL TO KHADIJAH FAISAL for all future purposes.

0040877089-1

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Gorav Kumar S/o Om Prakash R/o H. No. 20/177, Near Deep Sweets, JJ Colony, Dakshinipuri, Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 164/25 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Gorav Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Gorav Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Gorav Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 164/25 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.10.2026**.

By Order: Shri Divyam Leela,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
South-East Distt., Room No 508,
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi.

DP/12654/SE/2026

IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI
(ORDINARY ORIGINAL CIVIL JURISDICTION)
(Under Order V Rule 20 r/w Section 151 CPC)
I.A. 20708/2026 in CS(COMM) 35/2026

Mankind Consumer Products Private Limited PLAINTIFF(S)
Vs
Bharat Health & Anr. DEFENDANT(S)

To,
Bharat Health
Address: B 118, Nanhik Park, Matiala Bindu
Pur Road, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi- 110059
Email: ayurvedicbharat@outlook.com

...Defendant No. 1
WHEREAS the above named plaintiffs have instituted the captioned suit against you, the above named Defendant No. 1, and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of this Court that it is not possible to serve you, the above named Defendant No. 1, in the ordinary way, therefore, this notice is given by way of publication directing you, the above named Defendant No. 1, to make appearance before the Hon'ble Court on 09th day of September, 2026 at 10:30 A.M. and before Joint Registrar (Judicial) of this Court on 22nd day of September, 2026 at 11:00 A.M.

Take further notice that in default of appearance of you, the above named Defendant No. 1, on the date(s) fixed in the captioned suit, the suit will be heard and determined ex parte in the absence of you, the above named Defendant No. 1:
Given under my hand and the seal of this Court, this 18th Day of August, 2026.

Lokpal Singh
ASSISTANT REGISTRAR (IPD)
For REGISTRAR GENERAL

POOMPUHAR SHIPPING CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Tamilnadu Enterprise)
692, Anna Salai, IVth Floor, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035, India
Telephone No. : 044 - 24330505 / 807; Fax : 91-44-24344593 / 24335706,
E-mail : pscship@gmail.com CIN : U63090TN1974PLC006596

GLOBAL E-TENDER INVITING NOTICE

Notice inviting E-tender for long term time chartering of one self trimming Kamsarmax/ Pamamax gearless (or with gears considered as gearless) bulk carrier of about 68,000 – 86,000 MT DWT on NTECL account.

E-tender bids are invited from the Ship owners / disponent owners for the following specification:

Tender Number	Lay Days	Period	Tender Download start date	Bid Submission end date	Tender Opening date
PSC/CHARTERING/001/2026-27, Dt. 25.08.2026	28.10.2026 to 12.11.2026	12 Months + 3 Months +/- 10 days choption	08.09.2026 at 1500 hours	12.10.2026 at 1200 hours	12.10.2026 at 1400 hours

Tender document is available in e-tendering web portal <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app> and www.tamilship.com at free of cost. Prospective bidders are advised to refer for <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app> specific important details and upload their bid. The conditions / requirement mentioned in the website shall be met out by the bidders. This advertisement is an invitation for bid only. The details given in the website are comprehensive.

Tender Opening Venue: Poompuhar Shipping Corporation Limited, Head Office, No. 692, Anna Salai, MHU Complex - 4th Floor, Nandanam, Chennai - 600 035.

Further, all communications / corrigendum will be updated through <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app> only.

DIPR/2766/TENDER/2026

GENERAL MANAGER (OPNS)

कार्यालय अधिष्ठाता
पर्यावरण विज्ञान एवं पर्यावरण महाविद्यालय, मद्रास
ई-निविदा सूचना
ई-निविदा सूचना क्र. : 4558/Pur./Tender/ET-02/2026-27. दिनांक: 02.09.2026
पर्यावरण विज्ञान एवं पर्यावरण महाविद्यालय, मद्रास (म.प्र.) द्वारा निम्न कार्य हेतु खरीदक पत्रों / संस्थाओं से खुली निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाती है। निम्नलिखित ई-निविदा पोर्टल www.mptenders.gov.in पर देखी व परी जा संकेती ई-निविदा प्रक्रान उपरान्त निविदा में कोई संशोधन या परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उल्लेखित ई-निविदा पोर्टल पर ही उपलब्ध रहेगा। कार्यों का विवरण निम्नानुसार है:-

क्र.	कार्य का नाम
01.	पर्यावरण विज्ञान एवं पर्यावरण महाविद्यालय, मद्रास (म.प्र.) पर्यावरण, इंजीनियरिंग, हाईवेयर, ध्वनि सामग्री, सेक्टरों एवं औजार व अन्य वास्तुओं हेतु दर निर्धारण।

निविदा अर्जित करने वाले को प्रारंभिक तिथि 03/09/2026 से एवं अंतिम तिथि 25/09/2026
निविदा को हार्ड कॉपी मोडर लिफाफे में कार्यालय में पहुंचने को अंतिम तिथि 25/10/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sheikh Sajan, S/o: Ishrafi, R/o: N-38, B-367, CD Park, Jhuggi, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 566/2020, U/s: 380/411/457/34 IPC, Police Station Swaroop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Lalita Yadav W/o No 14439131L Rank Ex NK Sunil Kumar R/o H- No-157 Hanspur Pur Ganv Hasan Pur, Ujwa Delhi -110073 have changed my name to Lalita vide affidavit date 3-9-26 before Delhi. 0071059293-1

I, KAMINI GOYEL W/O SUMIT GOEL, R/O RADHEY LAL JAIPRAKASH OLD ANAJ MANDI, NYADER GANJ DADRI GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR UTTAR PRADESH- 203207, have changed my name to KAMINI GOEL. 0040877068-7

I, Preeti, W/o-Narendra Singh, R/o-flat no.302, Tower B-4, palm Grove Heights Ardee City Sector-52, Wazirabad, Gurgaon Haryana-122003, Have changed my name to Preeti Chhillar for all purposes 0040877080-5

I Abdul S/O Nevaji Nadaf, R/O. A-964, J.J.Colony Bawana, Delhi-110039, Have changed my name to Rafik for all purposes 0040877069-1

I, PRACHI TEWARI, W/O- PRASHANT TEWARI, R/O-FLAT-NO-1502 TOWER 11, ORANGE COUNTY AHINSA KHAND 1 INDIRAPURAM GHAZIABAD U.P. 201014, HAVE CHANGED, MY NAME, TO PRACHI KAUSHIK FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040877066-4

I, Shyam Kumar S/O Dev Kumar R/O G-7, C-Block, I.P. Colony, Burari, Delhi-110084, declare that Shyam Kumar and Shyam Kumar both are same person. 0040877067-3

I, MONISHA PATRA, W/o-DEB KUMAR PATRA, R/O-J-290, Gali No-7, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi-110059, have changed my name to MANISHA PATRA. 0040877075-5

I Himanshu Mehta D/o Rajesh Mehta R/O A-24, Gali No-01, Hardev Nagar, Jharoda Mazra Burari, Delhi-110084, have changed my name to Himanshi Mehta 0071059380-1

I, TASLIMA KHATOON W/o MD Naseem R/O Kharsa No.277/176, Gali No.5, Opp Ram Ghat Wazirabad Burari Delhi-110084, have changed my name to JANNATI KHATOON 0040877069-10

I, KUSHAL KUMAR, S/o OM PRAKASH SINGH, R/O-C-102, Gali-No.20, Main-Market, Khajoori Khas, North-East, Delhi-110094, hereby declare that my daughter's name PRIYANSHI mentioned in the Ladli Scheme Registration Form/Receipt is the same person as VANI, her correct name recorded in Aadhaar-Card and Birth-Certificate. Henceforth she shall be known as VANI for all purposes. 0040876923-1

I, Prava Devi M/o No 14414389N Rank Ex HAV Vinay Kumar Sharma R/o Plot No -22 First Floor, 35A, Near Barwale Shiv Mandir, Vipin Garden Extension, Mohan Garden Delhi- 110059 have changed my name to Prbha Sharma vide affidavit date 3-9-26 before Delhi. 0071059295-1

I, FARHA HUSAIN, W/O-SHARAFAT HUSSAIN, R/O-D-808, THIRD FLOOR, NEW FRIENDS COLONY, SOUTH EAST DELHI- 110025, I have changed my name to FARHA HUSSAIN. 0040877068-9

I, MONIKA RANI W/O Mr. Devi Ram Gupta R/O Flat.No.0212, Tower-F12, Amrapali Centurian Park, Tropical Garden, Plot No.GH-05, Sector-Tech Zone-4, Greater Noida West, G.B.Nagar, U.P.-201306 have changed my name after marriage MONIKA RANI to MONIKA GUPTA for all future purposes. 0071059376-1

I, MADAN PURI ALIES MADAN LAL PURI, S/O-SHRI RAM, R/O-686-1-A, GALI NO.3, PUNJIABI BASTI, MILITARY ROAD, ANAND PARBAT, KAROL BAGH, NEW DELHI-110005, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MADAN LAL PERMANENTLY. 0040877066-6

I, NISHANT JATINDER SONDHII S/O JATINDER SONDHII R/o E-1079, Saraswati Vihar, Delhi-110034, have changed my name to NISHANT SONDHII for all future purposes. 0040877068-2

I Vipul S/O Babu Bhai R/o N-33/112, Mool Chand Colony, Adarsh Nagar, Delhi-110033, have changed my name to Vipul Babubhai Makwana 0071059347-1

I, RAMANJEET S/O DALJEET SINGH R/O B-71-A TILAK VIHAR TILAK NAGAR DELHI-110018, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAMANJEET SINGH. 0040877075-7

I, PARAMJEET S/O AMAR SINGH, R/O WZ-L-3, STREET NO.7, NEW MAHAVIR NAGAR NEW DELHI-18 have changed my name from PARAMJEET to PARAMJEET SINGH for all future purposes. 0040876983-1

I, Sharmistha Dubey, W/o- Chandra Bhushan Mani, H.NO-602 E/2 WARD -3 Meharauli New-Delhi, have changed My name to Sharmistha kumari for all future purposes. 0040877069-12

I hitherto known as Chotu khamakaratti S/o Sanjay Laxman khamakaratti residing at #81, Patli Gali, VTC-Nilagi, PO-Nelagi, Sub Distt-Hukkeri, Distt-Belgaum, Karnataka-591124, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Swapnil Sanjay khamakaratti. 0071059338-1

I, Goutam Maya W/OShri Surendra Kumar Gupta R/O-23A Pocket D, SFS Flat MAYUR VIHAR Phase III, Delhi-110096 have changed my name to Gautam Maya. 0040877157-1

I Harsh S/o Hansraj R/o 581/210, Laxman Vihar Phase-02, Near Radhe Sweets Gali No.06, Gurugram Haryana-122001 have changed my name to Harsh Soni for all purposes. 0040876924-2

Preeti Bhati & Merkanto Moral Both name are mine. For all future purposes- I, shall be known as Merkanto Moral W/o Sandeep Bhati R/O. Village-Sakipur Tehsil & Distt. G.B. Nagar. 0071059301-1

I, Gaurav Gupta S/o Rakesh Mohan Gupta R/o Flat No.11136, Tower-10, Arocon Golf Ville, GH-07, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016 have changed my son's name from Athary to Atharv Gupta for all future purposes. 0040876828-1

I, ANITHA SHENOY, W/O RITWICK DUTTA, R/O D-199, Sector-47, Noida, UP -201301, have changed my name from ANITHA DINANATH SHENOY to ANITHA SHENOY, for all future purposes. 0040876931-4

I, Kamal Jeet Kaur J Neer W/o Mr.Jasbir Singh Neer R/o,F-159, Mansarovar-Garden, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to Kamaljeet Kaur Neer. 0040877069-5

I, SANJEEV CHAUDHARY, S/O-INDERPAL SINGH, R/O-B-3, Fire Station, Sector-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201010 have changed my name to SANJEEV KUMAR for all future purposes. 0040877066-8

I, SAVITA JATINDER SONDHII W/o JATINDER SONDHII R/o D-908, Kribhco Nagar, Limla(ct)Surat Gujrat,394515, have changed my name to SAVITA SONDHII for all future purposes. 0040877066-8

I Nirmala Bai W/o Hardal Singh R/o Vill-Nawrangpur, Naurangpur, Mungeli, Chhattisgarh-495115, have changed my name to Nirmala Dhruw 0071059354-1

I, Sonali Thakur, W/o-Umesh Dobriyal Sharma, R/o.C-32, Trinity Towers, DLF Phase -5, Near Golf Course Raod, Sector -53, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122003, have changed my name to Sonali Thakur Dobriyal, for all Purposes. 0040877080-2

I, NIKITA, D/o-Vijay Pal Singh, R/o-Flat No -139, Block-B, Prayag Apartment, Vasundhara Enclave, Delhi-110096, have changed my name from NIKITA TO NIKITA RAWAT for all future purposes. 0040877066-5

I, KM SUJATA BHATI, W/O-PRINCE DEVDHAR, R/O-HOUSE NO-49 JALAM MOHALLA TUGHLAKABAD VILLAGE NEW DELHI 110044, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUJATA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE

I, Prava Devi M/o No 14414389N Rank Ex HAV Vinay Kumar Sharma R/o Plot No -22 First Floor, 35A, Near Barwale Shiv Mandir, Vipin Garden Extension, Mohan Garden Delhi- 110059 have changed my name to Prbha Sharma vide affidavit date 3-9-26 before Delhi. 0071059342-1

I, JYOTI, W/O-AMIT KUMAR MEENA, R/O-R 202 Hyde Park Sector 78 Noida Uttar Pradesh -201301 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO JYOTI RAWAT 0040877075-2

I, Vidhya Devi W/o Manoj Kumar R/o Tower-E-1, Flat-No.705, Amrapali Leisure Park, Tech-Zone-4, Greater Noida-West, G.B.Nagar (U.P) have changed my name to Vidha Kumari for all purposes. 0040876996-1

I, Anupama W/o Sh. Ashok Kumar Satija R/o M-74, Second-Floor, Vikas Puri, New Delhi-110018, have changed my name to Anupama Satija. 0040877069-7

I, SAHDEV, S/O-Vinod Kumar, R/O-JF 10 A Flat No 11, Gupta Colony, Mother Dairy, Malviya Nagar South Delhi-110017, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME, TO SAHDEV KUMAR PERMANENTLY. 0040877066-6

I, Nishant Jatinder SONDHI S/O JATINDER SONDHII R/o E-1079, Saraswati Vihar, Delhi-110034, have changed my name to Devender Kumar. 0071059364-1

I, Ved Pal, S/o-Chiranji Lal Sharma, R/o-Pilana (116), Rohtak (Haryana)-124202, have changed my name to Vedpal Sharma for all Purposes. 0040877080-4

I, KM SALONI, D/O-DEV DUTT SINGH, R/O, LG-PLOT NO.50, KH NO.77 SWARN ENCLAVE HAIBATPUR GAUTAM BUDHA-NAGAR UP-201009, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME, TO SALONI CHAUHAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040877066-3

I, Purushottam Dutt Sharma S/O Maman Chand Sharma R/O Flat No.4&5, 2nd Floor, Pocket-19, Sector-24, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Purushottam Dutt Sharma. 0040877067-2

I Chaitanya S/O Pankaj Gupta R/O 27/3, Daksh Road, Vishwas Nagar, shahdara, Delhi-110032 Have Changed my Name to Chaitanya Gupta 0040877075-4

I hitherto known as Sourabh Dixit alias Anil Dixit son of Sh. Suresh Chand Dixit residing at House No. 234, G/F, Kh.No.60, Gali No.1, Near Nagar Nigam Primary School, New Sabhapur Gujran, Karawal Nagar, North East Delhi, Delhi-110094 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Anil Dixit. 0071059378-1

I, Akshay Mittal R/O D-157, Block-D, Sarita Vihar, New Delhi 110076 have changed my minor daughter's name from Mishita Mittal to Aavya Mittal. 0040876961-1

I, Shazia Khatoon, W/o-Rashid Azimur Rahman, R/o-H.No.455, Third-Floor, Flat-No.301, Main Zakir Nagar West, Jamia Nagar, South Delhi, Delhi-110025, declare that my minor daughter Khadija Rashid's date-of-birth 08.11.2012 is wrongly mentioned in her some documents, but her correct date-of-birth is 08.11.2011. 0040877069-9

I, Rishi Kumar Tayal S/o Lilu Ram Gupta R/o 15/61, West Punjabi Bagh, Delhi, have changed my name to Rishi Kumar Gupta permanently. 0040876925-1

I, SHASHI TOMAR w/o Ravinder Singh Chauhan r/o D- 406, Gali No-9, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad, UP- 201013, have changed my name to SHASHI CHAUHAN for all future purposes. 0071059294-1

I, SUMIT GOYEL, S/O-SATY PRAKASH GOYEL, R/O-NYADER GANJ RADHEY LAL JAIPRAKASH OLD ANAJ MANDI, DADRI GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH- 203207, I have changed my name to SUMIT GOEL. 0040877068-8

I, MOHAMMED SARFAZ, s/o Wasuillah, a resident of KICHHAUCHHA AMBEDKAR NAGAR U.P. 224155 have changed my minor son's name from MOHD RUHAN MOHAMMAD HASSAN to MOHAMMAD HASSAN vide affidavit dated 01/09/2026 at Ambedkar nagar. 0050297145-1

I, Gurpreet Kaur Dhir, w/o-Satinder Singh, R/o-B-215, Dr.Ram Lal Verma Marg, Near Krishna Market, Lajpat Nagar-1, Delhi-110024, have changed my name to GURPREET KAUR permanently 0040877080-6

I, Nasim S/o Manga R/o H.No.884, Kasrewa, Muzaffarnagar, U.P., have changed my name to Naseem. 0040877069-3

I, KM MEENAKSHI DEVI, W/O-DHARMENDRA SAROHI, R/O-641, 1ST FLOOR SURYA NAGAR PH 2 SEC 91 FARIDABAD-121003, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MINAKSHI SAROHI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040877069-2

I, PRANAV TIWARI, S/O- PRASHANT TEWARI, R/O-FLAT NO-1502 TOWER 11 ORANGE COUNTY AHINSA KHAND 1 INDIRAPURAM GHAZIABAD U.P.201014, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME, TO PRANAV TEWARI, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040877066-5

I, Vimmi, W/O-Dhanesh Mehta, R/O-B-359 First* Floor Prashant vihar Near PVR cinema Sector -14 Rohini New Delhi -110085 have changed my name to VIMMI MEHTA Permanently. 0040877068-1

I hitherto known as Bibi Nasrin W/o Ayyub residing at 81, D Sector, Bhel, Bhopal, Bhel, Madhya Pradesh-462022, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Kazma. 0071059342-1

I, SACHIN PRABHAKAR S/o OM PRAKASH PRABHAKAR R/O HOUSE NO-73, BFH-BLOCK, SHALIMAR BAGH, SHALIMAR BAGH, PO: SHALIMAR BAGH, DIST: NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI - 110088 have changed the name of my minor Son from VARRANYA PRABHAKAR to VARRANNY S PRABHAKAR. 0071059387-1

I, Lata Lal W/o Samuel Lal R/o 491, Sunlight Colony, No-2, Hari Nagar Ashram, New Delhi, Jungpura 110014, have change my name Lata to Lata Lal for all Purposes 0040877075-6

I, MADHUKRA OHRI S/o Harkishan Lal R/O B-293, Block-QU, DDA Flats, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, have changed my name to MADHUKRA OHRI 0040877069-11

I Hemant S/o Hansraj R/o 581/210, Laxman Vihar Phase-02, Near Radhe Sweets Gali No.06, Gurugram Haryana-122001 have changed my name to Hemant Soni for all purposes. 0040876924-1

I, Rohit, R/o H.No. 4/1/2, R.K. Puram, Sector-13, South West Delhi-110066, declare that my father's name has been wrongly written as RAJU SUNAR in my 10th/12th Marksheets, the actual name is SHABIR. Both names belong to the same person. 0071059298-1

I, Shamsuddin, S/o Mohd Umerdin, R/o FA-31, Abul Fazel Enclave, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohamed Shamsuddin. 0040877068-10

I, karan deep Singh Kapoor, S/o Varinder Singh Kapoor, R/o-H.N-A14, Sheelal Apartment, Sector-14, Rohani, P.O.-prashant vihar, north-west Delhi-110085, have changed my minor Daughter's name Rabani Kapoor to Rabani kaur Kapoor, for all purposes. 0040876932-1

I, Kamal Kishore S/o Sh.Nagin Chand, R/o H.N.O.C-6, First-Floor, Near-Handa Nursing-Home, Raja-Garden, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to Kamal Kishore Arora for all future purposes. 0040877069-4

I, Jyoti Verma W/o Sh. Harish Dhunna R/o, RZ-C-24, Block-C, West Sagar-Pur, New Delhi-110046, have changed my name to Jyoti Harish Dhunna for all purposes. 0040877069-6

I, Umesh Sharma, S/o-Daya Shankar Sharma, R/O.C-32, Trinity Towers, DLF Phase -5, Near Golf Course Raod, Sector -53, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122003, have changed my name to Umesh Dobriyal Sharma for all Purposes. 0040877080-3

I, SAMI ULLA alias SHAMI ULLAH, S/O-Azimullah Khan, R/O-C-1/21, Raju Park, Devli Road Khanpur, Delhi-110062, have changed my name to SAMI ULLAH KHAN. 0040877066-7

I, JATINDER JAGJITBHAI SONDHII S/O JAGJIT SINGH SONDHII R/O E-1079, Saraswati Vihar, Delhi-110034, have changed my name to JATINDER SONDHII for all future purposes. 0040877068-3

I Md Equebal Ansari S/o Abul Barkat Ansari R/o Village-Damodarapur, Post Damodarapur, P.S-Kanti, District Muzaffarpur, Bihar-843113, have changed my name to Md Eqbal 0071059349-1

I, Umesh Dobriyal Sharma, R/o.C-32, Trinity Towers, DLF Phase -5, Near Golf Course Raod, Sector -53, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122003, have changed my Minor Son name from Aarav Sharma to Aarav Thakur Dobriyal, for all Purposes. 0040877080-1

I, RADHA RANI ALIAS RADHA MITTAL D/o FIROZI LAL W/o RAJEEV MITTAL R/O M-103 (UPPER GROUND FLOOR), BLOCK -M, PREM NAGAR, UTTAM NAGAR, PO: D.K MOHAN GARDEN, DELHI, 110059 have changed my name to RADHA MITTAL for all purposes. 0071059320-1

I, Jyoti Rawat, W/o-Amit Kumar Meena, R/o-R 202, Hyde Park Sector-78 Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301 have changed my minor Daughter name from Maanvi to Maanvi Meena. 0040877075-1

I, SHAHZAD S/O MOHD YAZUB R/o Bahorpur, Alipur Morna, Meerut, U.P.-250401 have changed my name to MOHAMMAD SAHJAD. 0040877066-9

I, Deepak Kumar, S/o-Kishan Lal, R/o-790, Prem Gali No-3E, Multani Mohalla, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi-110031 have changed my name to Deepak Tuteja for all purposes. 0040877068-5

I, GAURAV S/O Parma Saini, 1273, Gali No. 4, New Baselwa Colony, Kheri Kalan(113), Old Faridabad, Haryana-121002, have changed my name to GAURAV SAINI. 0071059362-1

I, GAURAV KUMAR, S/O-MANOJ DHIMAN, R/O-A-108, SECOND-FLOOR CHANDER NAGAR GHAZIABAD U.P.201011, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GAURAV DHIMAN FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040877066-2

I, Mohd Azam Ali Alias Mohdazam Ali Alias Azam Ali S/O Abdul Gani R/O E-16/635, Bapa Nagar, Karol Bagh, Delhi-110005, have changed my name to Azam Ali. 0040877067-1

I, AMIT, S/O-BRIJ MOHAN MEENA, R/O-R 202, Hyde Park Sector-78, Noida, Uttar Pradesh -201301 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AMIT KUMAR MEENA 0040877075-3

I, Meena W/o-Monu Kumar, R/o-Ward No-6, Shamsabad, Palwal, Haryana-121102, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Meena Devi. 0040877030-1

I, Sushma Aggarwal, W/o-Ram Avtar Aggarwal, R/o-H.No.RZ-46/338, Gali-No.03, Jagdamba-Vihar, Sagarpur, South-West Delhi, Delhi-110046, declare that Sushma Aggarwal and S D Aggarwal both names are of one and same person. 0040877069-8

I, hitherto known as ARWAJ, S/O RIZWAN, R/o 425/5, Gujjar Dairy, Gautam Nagar, Andrewganj, South Delhi, Delhi-110049, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as ARWAJ ANSARI. 0040876926-1

I Rishabh S/o Ramesh R/o 18/295, SBI Bank, Kalyan Puri, East Delhi-110091 have changed my name to Rishabh Gawande for all purposes. 0040876924-3

I, Shamsuddin, S/o Mohd Umerdin, R/o FA-31, Abul Fazel Enclave, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohamed Shamsuddin. 0040877068-10

I, Rohit, R/o H.No. 4/1/2, R.K. Puram, Sector-13, South West Delhi-110066, declare that my father's name has been wrongly written as RAJU SUNAR in my 10th/12th Marksheets, the actual name is SHABIR. Both names belong to the same person. 0071059298-1

I, Shamsuddin, S/o Mohd Umerdin, R/o FA-31, Abul Fazel Enclave, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Mohamed Shamsuddin. 0040877068-10

I, karan deep Singh Kapoor, S/o Varinder Singh Kapoor, R/o-H.N-A14, Sheelal Apartment, Sector-14, Rohani, P.O.-prashant vihar, north-west Delhi-110085, have changed my minor Daughter's name Rabani Kapoor to Rabani kaur Kapoor, for all purposes. 0040876932-1

I, Kamal Kishore S/o Sh.Nagin Chand, R/o H.N.O.C-6, First-Floor, Near-Handa Nursing-Home, Raja-Garden, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to Kamal Kishore Arora for all future purposes. 0040877069-4

I, Jyoti Verma W/o Sh. Harish Dhunna R/o, RZ-C-24, Block-C, West Sagar-Pur, New Delhi-110046, have changed my name to Jyoti Harish Dhunna for all purposes. 0040877069-6

I, Umesh Sharma, S/o-Daya Shankar Sharma, R/O.C-32, Trinity Towers, DLF Phase -5, Near Golf Course Raod, Sector -53, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122003, have changed my name to Umesh Dobriyal Sharma for all Purposes. 0040877080-3

I, Akshay Mittal R/O D-157, Block-D, Sarita Vihar, New Delhi 110076 have changed my minor daughter's name from Mishita Mittal to Aavya Mittal. 0040876961-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Sh. Randheer S/o Sh. Sri Singh R/o H. No. 352, Khera Kalan, Delhi-110039, hereby declare that I have disintegrated and disposed of all self-acquired movable and immovable property and assets, and severed all relations with my son, Sh. Ashish, and his wife, Smt. Mansi, on account of their continuous misbehaviour, misconduct, threats, and acts contrary to my wishes and instructions. They have gone completely astray, are not acting according to my advice or wishes, and are no longer under my control. I shall not be responsible for any of their acts, omissions, debts, liabilities, or dealings with any person. The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal with them in my name or on my behalf, as I shall not be responsible for any such transaction or correspondence. Subhash Sharma (Advocate) 04/6/2015 Sh.No. 12, Basement, Ship Market, Near Sub-Registrar Office, Alipur, Delhi-36

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is for the information of General Public that my clients (1) Sh. Babu Khan, Father, Teesla Road, near both R/o RZ-5, G/F, Khushi Ram Park, On Vihar, D.K. Mohan Garden, New Delhi-110059, have disintegrated and disposed of all self-acquired movable and immovable properties, and severed all relations with my son, Sh. Saif, and his wife, Smt. Mansi, on account of their continuous misbehaviour, misconduct, threats, and acts contrary to my wishes and instructions. They have gone completely astray, are not acting according to my advice or wishes, and are no longer under my control. I shall not be responsible for any of their acts, omissions, debts, liabilities, or dealings with any person. The general public is hereby cautioned not to deal with them in my name or on my behalf, as I shall not be responsible for any such transaction or correspondence. Subhash Sharma (Advocate) 04/6/2015 Sh.No. 12, Basement, Ship Market, Near Sub-Registrar Office, Alipur, Delhi-36

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PUBLIC NOTICE REGARDING UGIF

Flat No. 1, Building No. 21, A2 Block, Chhatrapur Extension, Near Tiwari Garden, New Delhi 110074

ATTENTION! ATTENTION! ATTENTION! TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN

Know all that the immovable property at UGIF Flat No. 1, Building No. 21, A2 Block, Chhatrapur Extension, Near Tiwari Garden, New Delhi 110074 (Property) is the subject matter of disputes between the members of the Pawar family, specifically the legal heirs/dependents of Late Sri Pratap Pawar. The title of the said Property vested solely in Late Sri Pratap Pawar. Unfortunately, Sri Pratap Pawar passed away on 20/03/2025.

Following the demise, using the same as an opportunity for unjust enrichment, it has come to the knowledge of the undersigned that certain third parties are seeking to surreptitiously usurp the property. Further, the persons claiming to hold title/authority to alienate the same have no authority in law to do so. Please take note that the Property is subject to impending numerous civil and criminal litigation. Any person claiming title to the same as a result of any testamentary or non-testamentary document is doing so without disclosing that the same are fraudulent or at the very least, disputed by the legal heirs of Late Sri Pratap Pawar. Any person attempting to purchase or acquire the said Property may do so at his or her own risk and consequences. The undersigned would, in such circumstances, be constrained to be implicated/implicated/sue such persons) in any of the litigations (criminal and civil) relating to the family dispute of which any or may be required.

If any person is aware of any sale, alienation or creation of any interests in the Property, please contact the undersigned or their lawyers. Any assistance or cooperation would be appreciated.

Anand Pawar, Daughter 982474551 Ravilochan Daliparthi, Advocate 9811021218 Yukta Batra, Advocate 8800625193

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, hereby inform to the Public at large that my clients (1) SHRI RAM GOPAL Sh. Late Sai Ram & (2) MRS. BHAGWATI W/o. Sri Ram Gopal both R/o D-507, Mangolpuri, Delhi-110083, presently at T-1/1, Budh Vihar, Phase-1, Delhi, have severed off/disconnected their all relations/connections with their son SHRI RAJ KUMAR and his wife MRS. SONAM and their children and have debarred/disowned them from their all moveable & immovable Properties, for all intents and purposes. If anybody deals with them he/she shall be fully responsible for all future consequences.

NIRANJAN SINGH TOMAR (Advocate) Enrol No.-1543/2006 Flat No.163, Pikt-13, Sec-24

PUBLIC NOTICE

IT IS HEREBY INFORMED THAT Smt. Sandeep Kaur, who has applied for a loan from ICICI BANKING LIMITED (ICICI BANK), has reported the death of Smt

Former skipper Pietersen named mentor for Eng white-ball teams



Kevin Pietersen . PTI

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 7

FORMER ENGLAND captain Kevin Pietersen is set to return to the national team set-up after more than a decade, joining Brendon McCullum's coaching staff as a Specialist Mentor for the white-ball sides in the build-up to next year's ODI World Cup.

Pietersen will begin his new role later this month during England's white-ball series against Sri Lanka, which comprises three T20Is and three ODIs. The appointment marks his first substantial involvement with the England set-up since his international career ended in 2014.

The 46-year-old has some previous mentoring experience, having worked with Delhi Capitals in the Indian Premier League. He also had a brief stint working with England's batsmen during their ODI series in South Africa in 2023. Pietersen said returning to the England dressing room was particularly significant for him, with the 50-over World Cup in South Africa the primary target. "I am immensely proud to have been asked to help this team on their journey to win a World Cup in South Africa," Pietersen was quoted in an ECB statement.

"Putting on the England uniform again for the first time since 2014 is a profound honour and a deeply special moment. "We have an incredibly talented white-ball squad, and I am excited to get in the trenches and work relentlessly hard with these players to maximise their potential. To be a part of Brendon's think-tank over the next 12 months is a fantastic opportunity, and I cannot wait to get started," he added.

McCullum welcomed Pietersen's appointment and said his experience at international level could prove particularly useful to England's batting group. "I've got immense respect for KP and what he's achieved in the game. He's had an amazing impact on English cricket, so for someone with his experience, knowledge and stature to want to play a role with this team is a fantastic result," McCullum said. "I'm particularly excited for our batters to get the opportunity to work with him. KP has a unique understanding of what it takes to perform at the highest level, which will be hugely valuable to our players. We've always respected each other and had a strong appreciation for what the other brings to the game, so I'm really looking forward to working together."

DULEEP TROPHY FINAL DAY 2

In Chennai heat, Ishan & Co turn up the temperature vs South Zone

Marathon effort by skipper puts East Zone in control of the Duleep Trophy final against SZ

Ventaka Krishna B
Chennai, September 7

OFF HIS 301st delivery, Ishan Kishan defended Ricky Bhui and called for the physio before walking off retired hurt with 250 to his name. Chennai's heat managed to do what South Zone couldn't - to end Ishan's stay in the middle, albeit temporarily. One could see it coming in the few overs before he walked away, when he was cramping badly in the heat, denying singles and choosing to go for the big hits. It was the second battle the left-hander faced apart from overcoming the boredom of swatting a hapless South Zone attack. He would later return to finish with 270, by which time South were down on their knees as East Zone ended Day Two with a whopping 708 all out on board.

In the 163 overs they sent down across the first innings, spread over two days, it would be hard even for the broadcast production team to cull out a phase or spell where they consistently challenged the East batsmen. Apart from the deliveries that took wickets, they didn't create any chances. Having conceded 385/4 on the opening day, they were made to chase leather again, with Ishan and Kumar Kushagra (101 off 132b, 8x4, 5x6) batting them into submission. The 230-run partnership between the two Jharkhand wicketkeepers meant East have one hand on the Duleep Trophy, which they last won in 2012.

There are reasons why Jharkhand are emerging as a



Ishan Kishan and Kumar Kushagra (R) added 230 runs for the fifth wicket. PTI

domestic force; one of them is their batsmen. After Shikhar Mohan's 85 set the tone on Day 1, Ishan and Kushagra took over on Day 2. Having already put on 144 off 162 deliveries in the second half of Day 1 at a rapid pace, on Monday it was all about consolidation. Kushagra, like Ishan, is known for his aggressive brand of cricket. By aggression, he isn't reckless, but one who prefers to play the shots if the opportunity presents itself. Given the attack he faced, he didn't have to play anything extraordinary. Play the merit of the ball, and the runs were there for the taking. But it was Ishan who grabbed the headlines again during his 522 minutes-stay, where he faced 334 deliveries for his 270, which included 30 boundaries and seven sixes. Having taken the lime-light on Sunday with a wonderfully paced innings, he had the chance to show his hungry side.

There were moments where

South threw the bait at him, setting up a packed field on the leg-side with their pacers testing him to play the pulls and hooks. Ishan not only restrained but also found ways to score with control. At one point on the second day, off-spinner Tripurana Vijay even operated with just two fielders on the off-side, tempting Ishan to play a reverse-sweep or anything out of the box. A young Ishan may have fallen to the trap, but he is a batsman who intends to show he wants to play red ball cricket at the highest level.

At 28, Ishan is not just a different batsman, but a different individual, one who prefers to make the most of the opportunity he gets. Over the past 12 months, he has already shown that no door is impossible to breach. Thanks to extraordinary knocks in the white-ball game, which include a batting evolution where he now even uses large pockets of the off-side field

to score off spinners, he has already emerged as the first-choice wicketkeeper ahead of Sanju Samson in T20Is and is threatening to dislodge KL Rahul in ODIs.

Test ambition

In Tests, the spot still appears a distance away with Rishabh Pant ahead of him. Then there is Dhruv Jurel, who is playing as a specialist batsman. In India A, N Jagadeesan is ahead in the pecking order. But how long that remains unchanged would depend on how Ishan stays consistent in red-ball cricket.

His presence in India's white-ball teams may not give him enough opportunities to play in the Ranji Trophy and stake a claim for a recall in the Test squad. Hence, he has no choice but to make the most of the limited red-ball chances that come his way.

To dislodge two set wicket-keepers in the Test side, it needs

The curious case of Karun Nair

ON DAY 1 of the Duleep Trophy, Karun Nair left to Bengaluru. Having been included in the South Zone squad, the 34-year-old couldn't find a spot in the XI in the semifinal and final. Despite the presence of a fragile batting line-up, the South Zone didn't include Karun for the title clash. When asked about his absence, their coach Vikram Verma said, "he went (home) with the personal reasons. So he left for his home, he mailed and took the permission. Due to personal and family reasons, he left." He then revealed that due to the presence of left-arm spinners in East Zone they preferred a left-handed batsman in his place. But after heading home for personal reasons as mentioned by the South Zone coach, Karun turned up for KSCA in a multi-day warmup fixture against Chhattisgarh on Monday, going on to make a century. **ENS**

special knocks. Or rather, big scores that grab the selectors' attention. So even if one keeps South's timid attack aside, how Ishan managed the 250 deserves appreciation.

After retiring hurt at 250, and after spending enough time hydrating, during which time Kounain Quraishi and Mohammed Shami frustrated them further with a 54-run stand after Anukul Roy scored 45, Ishan returned. The fluency was missing, but he was prepared to fight it out, in the hope of taking it to the third morning, but a tired hit down the ground could only reach the fielder at long-on.

BRIEF SCORES: East Zone 708 all out in 163 overs (Ishan Kishan 270, Kumar Kushagra 101; Tripurana Vijay 4/180, Chama Milind 2/88, Shreyas Gopal 2/165) vs South Zone.

'Playing for India, sometimes your growth stagnates'

Ventaka Krishna B
Chennai, September 7

ISHAN KISHAN doesn't even pause for a second when asked about the phase where he was dropped from the India team, was told to go back to the domestic grind and fight his way up again. "*Mujhe maza aagaya*," he says. The two years that he spent in the wilderness has ensured India has got to see the best version of Ishan, one who is not just adventurous and daring, but responsible with the bat to the extent that he shows no mercy in the middle.

Having missed out in the two previous outings in the Duleep Trophy, the East Zone skipper scored 270 against South Zone in the final at the MA Chidambaram Stadium on Monday. The attack didn't test him much, the pitch was on the flatter side, and Ishan ensured he would get the job done for his side after his top-order failed to capitalise on the start. Having made a comeback into India's white-ball set-up, Ishan revealed it was the domestic circuit that helped him evolve as a different batsman.

"I genuinely enjoyed it," Ishan said off his time with Jharkhand. "I went back, had to grind and work hard for about two years. But sometimes, what happens is, when we play regularly for the Indian team, you just keep playing in a flow. I mean, yes, you might be a very good player which is why you're playing for India, but your growth stagnates at a certain point. So when you take one step back and go back to domestic cricket, you start from zero again. You start thinking, 'I need to get even better,' because today, there are so many players scoring runs. To get back into the team, your only option is to perform much better than them," the 28-year-old said.

Noticeable change

While there is noticeable change in the way Ishan approaches the innings, the wicketkeeper said, more than the batting it is the mindset tweak that has helped him. "You get time to reflect on what you missed earlier, why you couldn't convert your starts into big scores. I mean, the batting doesn't change that much; it's just the mindset that changes over time. When you process these things and keep working hard,

"Mujhe maza aagaya. I genuinely enjoyed it. I went back, had to grind and work hard for about two years."

ISHAN KISHAN,
ON GRIND OF RED BALL CRICKET

and then when you make a comeback, you rarely think about things like 'I will smash this, I will hit him like that.' Those thoughts change. You just start staying in the moment, taking it one over at a time, or one ball at a time. You remain relaxed and just play," Ishan added.

From the time Ishan walked into the middle, South Zone attack tried different ways to frustrate him. First up, they laid a short-ball trap then bowled with a heavy leg-side field and on Monday, when Tripurana Vijay bowled, there were just two fielders on the off-side. But Ishan didn't try to manufacture runs. With plenty of time left, he was prepared to grind it out. "I was extremely focused because I knew that when they were trying something different to get me out, I couldn't afford to gift them my wicket. If it's a genuine good ball that gets me out, that's completely fine. But when they are trying tactics because the pitch isn't offering much, trying to bait me into doing something rash, that is where I refuse to make mistakes. The longer we drag them out and tire them, the easier it will be for us to score runs later on. That was our plan throughout," Ishan said.

With 708 runs on board, East Zone are firmly in the control of the final. With the red soil pitch starting to take turn, South have an uphill task to come anywhere close to overhauling the total for the first innings lead. While East have the option of taking 20 wickets and getting an outright result, Ishan said this will be a fight for one spot.

"Look, we batted for roughly two days, right? Now, as a unit, we know this is essentially a first-innings shootout. It's a one-innings game. So our primary task is to take those first 10 wickets. After that, as a captain, I'll probably enforce the follow-on and tell them we are batting again! (laughs) Why would I want to step back out in the blazing heat!" he said.



Ishan Kishan scored 270 as East Zone finished with 708 runs. PTI

Pak cricket mess deepens as disciplinary probe ordered

Two players also had data from their mobile phones captured by PCB security officials, a report said

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 7

AFTER THE bizarre and unprecedented recall of seven Pakistan players from the England tour, the Pakistan Cricket Board (PCB) has announced an "internal disciplinary inquiry" into the team. While PCB has not made it clear what the inquiry will be looking at, it did mention that it was regarding "media reports concerning discipline and conduct".

With one Test left to play against England, Pakistan are already 2-0 down, having lost the first Test at Headingley by

an innings and 103 runs and then the second Test at Lord's by 194 runs. Besides sending home seven players in the middle of the tour, PCB had also dismissed head coach Sarfraz Ahmed and his assistant Umar Gul with Pakistan white-ball coach Mike Hesson and former Australia seamer Ashley Noffke taking charge for the final Test.

According to a report in The Guardian, two players had data from their mobile phones captured by PCB security officials, as part of the probe. PCB media director Amir Mir announced on Monday that the board had



Md Rizwan was one of the players sent home from England. REUTERS

initiated an "internal disciplinary inquiry following media reports concerning discipline and conduct, which are currently being reviewed internally." He did not specify what the inquiry was about, but some former Pakistan players had told their TV channels ear-

lier that some incident had happened in the dressing room which led to Pakistan taking the unprecedented measure to send home seven players in the middle of a tour.

"The PCB handles such matters in accordance with its standard procedures. The pro-

cess is being conducted under PCB regulations, ensuring that all concerned individuals are given due consideration," Mir said in a statement on X.

"At this stage, any speculative reports or unverified claims circulating on certain platforms, particularly those originating from hostile external sources, should not be regarded as credible. The PCB will not comment further at this time. The Board advises stakeholders and the public to rely on official PCB communications."

Muhammad Rizwan, Imam-ul-Haq, Salman Ali Agha, Ali Usman, Khuram Shahzad, Aamir Jamal and Muhammad Awaiz Jafar were sent home to Pakistan with one final Test still left in the tour. Of these seven, the latter two did not play in any game.



Luis Enrique's PSG have won 0 games so far in Ligue One. REUTERS

quality, all of them are world class, but to win three times, you need more. You need that mentality and belief." Enrique could relate. There would be no shortage of motivation. That teams would not lose motivation to win once they become champions is a hollow

myth as old as the hills. The core of his successive title-winning seasons at PSG remains the same. None are particularly old, injured or returning from injury. Barring French players, none had excruciatingly long World Cups. Apart from a rumoured rift be-

tween Enrique and French forward Ousmane Dembele, there aren't any rumblings that threaten to disrupt the harmony in the squad. "Nothing, nothing. A perfectly happy squad," he stressed at the start of the season.

A happy side; but a stale one too in the opening games. PSG was quiet in the transfer market. The departure of Bradley Barcola headlined their window, where the incoming included Ferran Torres, Mika Godts and Maghnes Aklouché. All good players, but none that elevate their already lofty stature. None that could keep the first-choice players on their toes. A team that stayed pretty much the same over a long period brings stability and continuity, but it could, funnily enough, inject stasis too. Players in their comfort zones, over-familiar with each other, and unchallenged in their

roles. Considering that their defensive bulwark, Marquinhos, is 32, it was surprising that they didn't acquire a high-class centre back. But their biggest detriment to the holy third would be themselves, the enemy within, the subconscious ennui, the residual drain of those trophy-hoisting limbs, the heaving pressure, and Enrique himself said, "too much positive energy."

Simultaneously, their rivals on the European stage have revitalised. Rodri's acquisition has made Barcelona fearful. Barcelona, who PSG duel in the group stages and potentially later in the tournament, have rolled off to a shellacking start, pumping 17 goals in four league games. Real Madrid could find their groove in Champions League, under Jose Mourinho, less theatrical but more resolved in his demeanour. Last edition's finalist Arsenal have steered their mid-

field, but without adding attacking reinforcements. Nonetheless, they remain a side capable of mounting a serious title challenge. Manchester City's last-dash shopping has stacked their midfield with glittering riches. If Enzo Maresca could beat them into a soulful tune, embed them with rhythms, City could be serious title challengers. Bayern Munich could be smarting for revenge after their semifinal exit in the last instalment.

The group stage pairings look straightforward with only Barcelona and Manchester City posing considerable threat. But the real business would begin in the knockouts, where the shadow of the figure three would assume a monstrous proposition. The immediate meaning of three would be gaining full points for the first time this season. The bigger three could wait. And bigger celebrations.

UEFA CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Can PSG win three titles, or does continuity and stability render them stale?

Sandip G
New Delhi, September 7

IT WAS a night meant for celebrations. Banners of Luis Enrique, whose contract was extended that day with a staggering pay-rise that puts him in the 20-million-dollar stratosphere, rolled in the stands of Parc de Prince like a undulating wave. After all, the Spaniard was the man who brought joy into the stands, who transformed the upstarts into a continental elite.

Except the night ended mournfully, the surging Monaco upending the running five-time-champions ragged in a 2-1 win. Enrique called for calm—even though the defeat from their immediate competitors, stretching their winless streak to three games was hard for the devout to reconcile with. But Enrique's words have a magic effect on those around. "I'm happy with what

I saw. I saw a lot of positive things; for me, today, we deserved the win. But that's football, it's a wonderful sport," he said after the game. Hope and belief sprung again.

But it was not the ideal preface to their Champions League opener. The fixture, as such, carries little fear or beads of cold sweat. The two-time champions encounter Slovan Bratislava, a club fifty years older than them which bore six different names through different eras, a reflection of territorial remapping in Central Europe. Managed by the familiar face of Yaya Toure. The game would be a footnote wherein the predominant theme would be if PSG could retain their crown and match the feat only three clubs have achieved (Real Madrid twice, Bayern Munich and Ajax).

The golden number is three. As much as in the immediate context of grabbing

all three points for the first time this season as in the wider canvas of winning the Champions League for a third time on the trot. It's a spectacularly elusive feat. In the Champions League era, only a wondrously star-dusted Real Madrid have achieved it. Not multiple AC Milan iterations of grandeur; not Lionel Messi's Barcelona; not for Pep Guardiola, or Alex Ferguson. The Real Madrid squad was an ostentatiously gifted one; generational talents at their peak, shepherded by a name that breathes awe and respect in equal measure. Zinedine Zidane, whose philosophy fluxed but his commitment to winning strategies remained undimmed through his tenure.

After the third of the three titles, Zidane glorified "mentality" above other virtues that shone in them. "First, second, third... It was all about the mentality. Certainly, there was

Paes in fray to become tennis federation chief

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 7

INDIAN TENNIS legend Leander Paes is set to enter the race for the presidency of the All India Tennis Association (AITA), with the Bengal Tennis Association (BTA) deciding on Monday to back his candidature, setting up a potentially high-profile contest against Davis Cup skipper Rohit Rajpal.

The BTA took the decision on Monday but Paes first need to win the impending Sports Person of Outstanding Merit (SOM) election to stand as presidential candidate.

The election schedule is yet to be finalised. The process includes the election of four SOMs to the AITA general body before the electoral process is completed.

"The Council of members of the Bengal Tennis Association (BTA) desires Leander Paes, one of India's greatest sporting icon to take over the presidency of the All India Tennis Association (AITA)," Bengal Tennis Association (BTA) said in a statement.

Paes is now BTA president. Rajpal, who is also DLTA president, announced his candidature last week. He threw his hat into the ring, saying his experience as a player, Davis Cup captain, AITA office-bearer and sports administrator had encouraged him to take up the challenge.

"The Bengal Tennis Association believes that Indian tennis stands at an important crossroads and requires visionary, accountable and athlete-centric leadership capable of bringing together players, coaches, state associations, administrators, sponsors and other stakeholders.

"His (Paes) experience, global stature, competitive spirit and understanding of what it takes to develop champions make him uniquely placed to lead AITA into its next chapter."

Paes applied for inclusion in the AITA's Sportsperson of Outstanding Merit roster, a move that had fuelled speculation about his possible role in the forthcoming elections. With interim president Chintan Parikh also in the race, it could be a three-way battle for the top job, provided Paes wins the SOM election and is nominated by the chosen SOMs for the post.

IOA to okay changes

The Indian Olympic Association (IOA) is set to approve the changes in its constitution in line with the National Sports Governance Act 2025 at its Special General Body Meeting.

The IOA's executive committee had approved the changes made in its earlier constitution. The General House will also discuss on a possible date of the IOA election which is due in December.

Paes applied for inclusion in the AITA's Sportsperson of Outstanding Merit roster; a move that had fuelled speculation about his possible role in the elections.

CHINA MASTERS CHAMPIONS

'If we have as much fun as ever, we will be able to go deep at Asiad'

Satwik-Chirag on their bond, what makes them tick, and how they keep improving

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 7

THE MISSING Olympic medal may well have provided the strongest glue to Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty. They would, of course, trade every other achievement - there are several - for the big missing medal. But the pursuit of it has kept them going and growing together.

"There's a sense of belonging in this partnership, like we owe it to each other," Chirag says after returning from winning another Tour title - the Super 750 China Masters - in a media interaction facilitated by the Badminton Association of India (BAI).

There's no secret sauce, Satwik says.

"It's pretty open," he adds of a 10-year-bond, which wasn't initially easy, he reminds. There were cultural dissimilarities that the two talented but deeply down-to-earth men from two opposite coasts - western Mumbai and eastern Andhra - would encounter. "But there's so much to achieve, that we never thought of taking a break or splitting or playing with different partners," Satwik adds. "The thought never crossed our minds," he says, of a partnership that has weathered severe criticism for missing the Olympic medal, but is growing a loyal fanbase by the day, because they fight hard, stick together, stay elite, but grow no airs.

"We keep talking about everything even when we disagree," Satwik says, "We just want to win."

That's the underpinning emotion that's effortfully built because partnerships need that effort. "We are both vocal and



Chirag Shetty (L) and Satwiksairaj Rankireddy react during the at the China Masters Super 750 final on Sunday. BADMINTON PHOTO

discuss things. There may be disagreements. But we have conversations and hear each other's thoughts," Chirag says. Success follows. "Because we have always had the same goals," Satwik adds.

First to get to World No.1, an Asian Games gold at Hangzhou, the duo has achieved many firsts for India, a country that barely took doubles seriously at one stage.

Chirag knows the responsibility: "We owe it to Indian doubles, and Indian badminton." Both are emotional, sentimental even, in their own way, and speak their minds. But losses or sunken form, injuries or mistakes on court, Satwik-Chirag have used those down-days to resurrect together. Such as China Masters, after a quarterfinal exit at the Delhi Worlds.

The losses have backed them into unprecedented corners - working on tiny details, keeping them honest.

"There is always something to work on. Even when we were World No.1, I never thought I was a perfect badminton

“There is always something to work on. Even when we were World No.1, I never thought I was a perfect badminton player.”

CHIRAG SHETTY
WINNER, CHINA MASTERS DOUBLES

player," Chirag explains. There are no massive gaps in their game, but always plenty to keep working on, like defence. They name Seo Seung-jae and Kim Won Ho as the best defensive unit, and Chinese Liang-Wang the most attacking, besides themselves.

Keeping the rhythm

While Satwik got better on the third shot - an earlier vulnerability - the duo has also learnt they can't head into tournaments cold. Five solid matches - four of them 3-game encounters - were a good test ahead of the Asian Games.

"We need to continue playing. Otherwise after a gap, it gets tough to adjust to speed defensive structure," Satwik said.

They don't feel extra pressure to defend the Asian Games crown. "There are other top pairings who will feel more pressure," Chirag states. After two days, they'll work on their shortcomings and fly out in 10 days. Shenzhen has given them good days - in 2024 Satwik was admittedly at "less than 50 percent" and they still made the semis. On another occasion, they had lost in Round 1 at Japan, then made the final at the China Masters next week. "My favourite is India Open, then French, then China Masters in that order," Satwik says.

Chirag was running a temperature ahead of the last Asiad final, and the only thing they had, he says, was hope before they won gold. This last week was again a physical challenge. "If the body holds up. So it's one match at a time," Satwik says.

With a protective belt since February of 2025 and Satwik's

shoulder always in discussion, these are a pair of broken and patched back Terminators who keep delivering on the 'I'm back' promise.

"It was good to know that even without our 'A' weapons, we can play at the highest level," said Satwik, who openly admits he wasn't able to smash at a 100 percent.

On a typical title run, they run into Malaysians who refuse to lift, Popovs who can't stop lifting, Danes who are plain annoying, shuffled Malaysians who defend like hell and Chinese who ambush with speed.

"We were patient. Trusted our defence. And sure of which strokes to play when we got lifts," Chirag explains the dynamic. "We know we got the gold at the Asian Games three years back. But even now, if we have as much fun as ever, we will be able to go deep. Keep results aside, focus on one match at a time," Chirag says.

"We don't have a Plan B," Satwik stresses. Plan A is knowing they are a rollicking good team - together.

Djokovic to Fritz: seven top 10 seeds are already out of the US Open

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, September 7

SEVEN OF the men's top 10 seeds are gone from the US Open after eight days. Stretch that to the top 20, and it's 15.

Djokovic started it. Medvedev kept it going. Most of the upsets share a strange helplessness, players who can't quite explain what happened to them.

Djokovic "despised every moment" against Mariano Navone. Arthur Fils was up 5-2 in the second set on Stefanos Tsitsipas when his energy simply left him, no explanation, just gone, a lapse he called "almost unprofessional."

Alex de Minaur had a favourable draw on paper and lost anyway, in the second round, to Botić van de Zandschulp. "I can't really explain the reasoning of it, but it just felt like the more I tried, the more intensity, the more fired up I was getting, I just kept on making unforced errors," he said. The feel of the ball on the strings, gone, and he couldn't get it back.

Felix Auger-Aliassime got dizzy against Karen Khachanov. Started seeing spots after a set and a half. Never recovered. "I thought maybe it would pass, but it didn't," the No. 3 seed said. "I've never felt quite like that. I've had cramps before. I've felt tired towards the end of matches, but in a normal way. This was abnormal a little bit."

He finished with 47 unforced errors.

Taylor Fritz led Francisco Cerundolo by two sets and a break. Then it fell apart.

"I don't even know what to say. I don't really want to talk to anybody, see anybody," he said. "I need to get out for a couple days and then get back to work. I don't know how I let that happen today."

Packed calendar

Flavio Cobolli, fifth seed, lost to Alexander Blockx and pointed to fatigue. "I think my energy was a little bit lower than the other days," he said. "I feel a little bit more tight and maybe more tired."

He's not alone. Carlos Alcaraz, back from a four-month wrist injury, has already been vocal about how packed the calendar has become. Jannik Sinner and Casper Ruud withdrew injured before the tournament even started. The shocks at Flushing Meadows may share a root cause: an expanded ATP schedule, and a modern game that already demands more of the body than most seasons allow it to give. Blockx, the man who beat Cobolli, put it plainly. "The season is long. I think all the guys who performed well in the preparation tournaments have it more difficult here," he said. "We're all human. We're not robots. Every week is difficult. Especially at a Grand Slam where it gets even more physical. Mentally you have to really stay in it."

Open field

Credit where it's due, the players pulling off these upsets are also grinding through a brutal tour, and their run through the first four rounds has cracked the men's draw wide open. The women's side



Daniil Medvedev lost to Francis Tiafoe in the fourth round. AP

● SABALENKA, ALCAZAR IN QF

● Defending champions Aryna Sabalenka and Carlos Alcaraz are back to the quarterfinals at the US Open, and they made it look easy. The top-ranked Sabalenka solved some early struggles holding serve and overpowered Taylor Townsend 6-4 6-3 on Sunday. Alcaraz also advanced in straight sets, beating Tommy Paul 6-4 6-3 6-4 in the second match at Arthur Ashe Stadium.

● Defending champion Alcaraz may be used to adoring crowds at Flushing Meadows, but the Spanish second seed could find himself playing the villain as he navigates a potential all-American obstacle course to reach the final.

tells the opposite story: 11 of the top 16 seeds are already through to the fourth round.

Cerundolo, fresh off his comeback win over Fritz, called it a reflection of how tight the circuit has become. "It shows you how even the circuit is right now, how tight every match is, how difficult it is to win matches, because anything can happen right now," he said. "A lot of players are playing good. The level, it's super tight. It's open to everyone. Everyone can win."

Alcaraz and top seed Alexander Zverev remain the favourites, upsets or no upsets. Alcaraz is playing his first tournament back from injury and has looked confident through four rounds regardless.

He and Sinner have shared 10 of the last 11 major titles between them, a stranglehold that's tormented everyone else on tour; Zverev is the one man who broke it, and he knows exactly how hard that was to do. He's admitted nerves once kept him from sleeping or eating properly before earlier Slams, and even after finally breaking through at Roland Garros and reaching the Wimbledon final, his best tennis still wasn't enough to unsettle a fully fit Sinner.

Alcaraz looms again this time. If both he and Zverev play to their pedigree, New York could get the final it seems built for. Unless the upsets keep coming through the quarters and semis, and someone like Ben Shelton, Frances Tiafoe or Learner Tien takes the title instead.

That might not be such a bad thing for the sport.

Sindarov holds his own against Carlsen, earns praise

Mayank Chaudhary
Bengaluru, September 7

JAVOKHIR SINDAROV has been turning heads all year. The latest to be impressed? Magnus Carlsen.

Despite his team's crushing 15-3 defeat at the hands of Alpine APL Pipers at the 2026 Global Chess League, the Uzbek challenger earned rare praise from the Norwegian great after holding him to a solid draw on the Icon board.

Sindarov didn't allow Carlsen to make any inroads. "Sindarov was very good. He has a very good positional understanding, and he certainly put a lot of pressure on me early in the game," Carlsen said after the match.

Three of Sindarov's teammates lost with white pieces, leaving him stranded on the

top board. Carlsen called Sindarov a well-rounded player with no apparent weaknesses.

"I think he had more draw options that he didn't go for, because his team desperately needed him to win. And I think he understood that and because of that he was putting himself in a difficult position. Overall, he's very well rounded, doesn't have any obvious weaknesses," Carlsen said.

Carlsen hasn't had the best of starts on the individual front by his standards at GCL 4, even though his team, defending champion Pipers, are cruising. They lead the points table with nine points from three wins in four games.

"It has been a little bit underwhelming. But the team is doing fantastic; as long as they are doing well, I'm happy," the legend said.



Magnus Carlsen in action at the Global Chess League. GCL

Carlsen came to the GCL on the back of a dominant win at the Esports World Cup in Paris, where he didn't lose a single game. In the GCL too, he is yet to lose, but there have been multiple occasions when he seemed under pressure. His mastery, however, has allowed

him to wriggle out of difficult situations, with one win and three draws to his name.

He was critical of his own game. "I feel like my play with limited time is not great."

Carlsen played an odd move, 3. f6, in the opening against Sindarov, which looked like a mistake or a deep tactical line for the longest time. He revealed the idea came from a misclick from his coach during training, but they used it to good effect.

"It was originally from my coach, it was a misclick. And then he started looking at it and I like the general idea of taking a random move in the opening. With computer analysis, you can make pretty much anything work," he explained.

Carlsen flagged Viswanathan Anand in the clash between Pipers and PBG Alaskan

Knights. Anand held a slight advantage in the opening, but Carlsen used his clock well to put pressure back in the middle and endgame, eventually winning after Anand ran out of time.

When asked about the game with the Indian legend, he said: "I felt like I was outplaying a little bit in the middle game. Was pretty happy with the position from the opening and then later on. And then, again, I was a little bit shaky with little time, and I think for a period there he was defending very well, not making it any worse. And then I just obviously resigned myself to a draw, and then I randomly glanced at his clock and saw that it was out. That's how it goes sometimes."

(The writer is in Bengaluru at the invitation of Global Chess League)

● GIVING BACK

Moved by Nepal tragedy, Dutch GM Giri turns to chess to offer support

Mayank Chaudhary
Bengaluru, September 7

ANISH GIRI may be a Dutch Grandmaster, but his roots lie in Nepal — his father, Sanjay Giri, hails from the Land of the Himalayas.

After witnessing the devastation caused by the flash flood that devastated areas along the Nepal-Tibet border, Giri turned to chess to bring some relief to those affected.

On September 1, the 32-year-old hosted a two-hour, 36-minute charity stream on his YouTube channel to raise funds for the official Prime Minister's Disaster Relief Fund. He live-streamed his Titled Tuesday games, a weekly online chess event on Chess.com, using the platform to mobilise support for Nepal. Giri also made a personal donation and shared posts on his social

media handles, urging his followers to contribute and help raise more funds.

Giri also has a Russian mother, Olga, and Indian roots through his paternal grandmother.

He was a second to Viswanathan Anand during his World Championship match against Veselin Topalov in Sofia, Bulgaria, and has worked closely with GMs Adhiban Baskaran and Vidit Gujrathi, both of whom were part of Giri's team for his 2016 Candidates campaign.

Giri was born in St. Petersburg and spent the first seven years of his life there, before moving to Sapporo, Japan, with his family in 2002.

He later moved to the Netherlands in 2008 and has represented the country in chess ever since. His father, Sanjay Giri, is a research engineer

working at a Dutch organisation in Delft.

Close to home

Despite having visited Nepal only twice, Giri feels a deep connection to the country through his father.

"I've been there twice, of course, but I have a very close connection to Nepal. It's my father's home country. My grandparents are from there. Throughout my entire life, my father's friends have been coming over, and we've been going there as well," he told *The Indian Express*.

"I know all the Nepali festivities. I haven't lived there as long as I have in Russia or the Netherlands, but still, when one of your parents is from a place, it has a big impact on you. So I'm very close to Nepal," said Giri, who is currently in India playing for Alpine APL



Anish Giri's father, Sanjay (R), is from Nepal. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Pipers at the 2026 Global Chess League (GCL).

His charity stream announcement gained traction, with Indian GMs Vidit and R Vaishali spreading the word. Giri initially wanted to do something more organised on

a larger scale, but after his father suggested that immediate help was more important, he turned to his chess stream.

"My father suggested I do this small gesture. I was thinking about doing something more organised and bigger, but

“I've been there twice, of course, but I have a very close connection to Nepal. It's my father's home country. My grandparents are from there.”

ANISH GIRI
ON HIS NEPALI ROOTS

with the schedule, I had to go to the league just a couple of days later. He told me it's better to do something quick because there is immediate help needed at this moment. So I did it through the small stream. It helped, even a little bit. That's good. But again, as the son of a Nepali father, I have a very close con-

nection to Nepal," he revealed.

This isn't the first time Giri has helped Nepal. In 2015, when a deadly earthquake claimed over 9,000 lives in Nepal, he joined hands with Chess.com and organised an online fundraising simul to raise funds for the UNICEF Relief Fund.

Giri is currently World No. 11 and has been the top-ranked Dutch player for years. A three-time Candidates participant, Giri recorded his best result this year in Cyprus, finishing second behind Uzbek Javokhir Sindarov with 8.5/14.

His biggest titles include the 2025 FIDE Grand Swiss and the 2023 Tata Steel Masters, his home tournament in Wijk aan Zee. The five-time Dutch champion has represented his country at seven Chess Olympiads, with the 2026 edition in Samarkand set to be his eighth.

Giri has been giving back to the chess community for a long time. In 2022, he took part in a one-on-one deathmatch against Vidit Gujrathi, organised by ChessBase India to help promote the sport, which was gaining traction in the country at the time.

Ahead of the Mahabaliapuram Chess Olympiad, Giri travelled to Mumbai for the event and won Rs 5 lakh after defeating his good friend Vidit. He donated Rs 2 lakh from his winnings to HelpChess, a charitable initiative by ChessBase India that provides financial support to talented young chess players across the country.

The funds were used to support young Indian players Ilamparthi and Jubin Jimmy. Ilamparthi went on to become India's 90th Grandmaster, while Jimmy holds an IM title.